

The A.A. Group—Where It Begins

The Twenty-Seventh Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

1977

Final Report

**Statler Hilton Hotel
New York
April 18-23**



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Regional Map Of U.S. and Canada

Regional trustees: See presentations, pp. 15-16; Ask-It Basket question, p. 25; Nominating Committee report, p. 38; Floor Action 4, p. 43; Advisory Actions 51-55, 57, p. 46; brief biographies, pp. 54-55.

A.A. regional forums: See staff and trustees' committee reports, pp. 36-37.

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'The Conference Is Itself an A.A. Group'

Opening day

'Circle of service' stirs Conference members

Forming a living "circle of service" around 27th Conference members in the Skytop Room, 61 employees of G.S.O. (all nonalcoholics, except two assistants to the archivist) emphasized the second word of General Service Conference as its 1977 meeting began Monday morning, April 18.

After they were introduced by Conference vice-chairman Bob Pearson, general manager of G.S.O., and were loudly applauded, they trooped back to the office, and the 133 Conference members settled down to Conference business—hearing the annual General Service Board report from John L. ("Dr. Jack") Norris, M.D., nonalcoholic board and Conference chairman.

Unofficially, the six-day Conference (April 18-23) had gotten under way the day before, when 91 area delegates met informally with 42 fellow Conference members: trustees, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. and GV staff members. On that day, Panel 27 delegates also attended orientation sessions led by regional trustees.

In more gala mood, a total of 318 dressed-up Conference members and guests attended the opening dinner Sunday night, marking the start of the first General Service Conference of A.A. (U.S./Canada) held at New York's Statler Hilton Hotel. Theme was "The A.A. Group—Where It Begins." At the A.A. meeting after dinner, 16 G.S.O. and GV staff members briefly shared their initial experiences in A.A. groups, and delegate Joe Kirby (South Carolina) told his story. Lois, Bill W.'s widow and a founder of Al-Anon Family Groups, thanked A.A. for the principles of life it has given to her, and led those present in closing the meeting with the Lord's Prayer.

After the formal roll call Monday morning, retiring trustee Margaret Carlson delivered the keynote address (see next page). Conference ground rules and mechanics were reviewed. Participants in daily readings and prayers included delegates Leonard DeWitt (Northern Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan), Vern Radke (Northern Minnesota), Don Shipp (Mississippi), Nancy Thomas (Vermont), John Gillespie (Northwestern Texas), Jeronimo Reyes (Puerto Rico), Jean-Luc Bergevin (Southwestern Quebec), Maurice Haase (Southern Indiana), and Richard Foster (Southwestern Ohio/Northern Kentucky).



Highlights of past Conferences

The goal of everyone attending every Conference was and is the good of A.A. Personal and local special interests have fallen into place, with emphasis on the group conscience as shown to us by our Higher Power, with insistence that every minority, no matter how small, be heard, with agreement that action on any subject of importance be postponed unless there is substantial unanimity. There was not always complete agreement; lines at the microphones were often long. But solutions were worked out to almost everyone's satisfaction, and those who weren't entirely satisfied knew they had been given a fair hearing.

I have come away from every Conference wishing governments would function as we do in A.A.

Most of the early Conferences spent a great deal of time talking about money, to such a degree, it seemed to me, that money was spoiling our feelings about the Fellowship. Delegates went home and talked about money to the groups. Understandably, the groups did not welcome that message.

During recent years, with the increase in A.A.W.S. income, we have spent less time being concerned about having money enough to live up to our responsibilities to those who serve us and provide the services to the Fellowship. We have spent our time on the real purpose of the Conference, and delegates have had a happier story to share at home.

The First Conference (1951) had 37 delegates, sent from the areas with the most A.A. members, and it lasted three days. Trustees and staff had no vote. The board was made up of eight non-A.A.'s and seven A.A.'s. G.S.O. was described as "twelfth-stepping at the national and international level." Approval of A.A. literature by the Conference was recommended. Income from the Big Book was inadequate to keep G.S.O. going, so the first real appeal to A.A. members was written, and a contribution of \$1.00 per member per year was suggested. There was great concern about the Grapevine. It was operating at a deficit, losing \$8,500 in the last nine months.

At the 1952 Conference, it was reported that money problems were less severe, but only half the groups contributed. Bill asked to be released from routine duties so he could concen-

trate on writing. He wished to update the story section of the Big Book and write a new series on the Twelve Traditions and a series of essays on the Twelve Steps. The Literature Committee reported ten special projects had been completed, and ten more were suggested by delegates. Volunteers couldn't accomplish all of this work, so the Conference approved employment of professional writers.

Several delegates proposed a three-year term for delegates. For most of the delegates, the Conference was an exciting and rewarding experience; I thought their selfish desires would speak for a third term. But discussion emphasized that a third term would deprive other members of the opportunity, and reduce the number who could participate. So the third year was voted down. It was the group conscience in action, with the good of A.A. the deciding factor.

At the 1953 Conference, the idea of incorporation of A.A. itself was rejected, as "spiritual faith and a way of life cannot be incorporated." Finances were still a problem. Two dollars per year per member was accepted as the optimum goal. Grapevine circulation had reached 28,700 – down a little. The Conference approved the principle of paying the administrative staff at G.S.O.

Bill led a discussion on uniformity, saying, "The more we insist on conformity, the more resistance we create." I hope we never fall into the trap of insisting on conformity and legislating details. When we do, when we stop adapting to the needs of present situations and people, we become rigid and at that point begin to die. Bernard Smith, board chairman, closed the session with these words: "We, and the life we lead within the concepts of A.A., bring a message to this world: that the spirit can take hold of our material world and completely transform it."

Bill opened the 1954 Conference with: "This year marks the successful conclusion of A.A.'s great experiment in self-direction. We are now to ask ourselves whether this Service Conference ought to become a permanent part of A.A.'s life; whether we deem it capable of withstanding every strain and peril the future may bring; and lastly, whether we shall be prepared in 1955 to offer it to our Society for final adoption."

At the 1954 Conference, the delegates-only meeting was mentioned for the first time. They agreed that delegates should not come "instructed" to the Conference. It was also agreed the Reserve Fund should not exceed \$300,000, which was then two years' operating expenses. Since the word "Foundation" implied much money, the name of the Alcoholic Foundation was changed to the General Service Board, and the board reported it had turned down a bequest of \$17,000 and the publication rights of the "Twenty-Four Hours a Day" book.

In St. Louis in 1955, the Conference tabled a proposal that the ratio of eight nonalcoholics and seven alcoholics on the board of trustees be changed. At the Convention in St. Louis that year, the Fellowship accepted the Conference; the Conference accepted responsibility for A.A.; and the permanent Charter of the Conference was adopted. The new second edition of the Big Book was presented. The Grapevine was gaining, but still running a deficit.

In 1956, Bill outlined four suggested principles for the service functions: Petition, Appeal, Participation, and Decision—

principles later elaborated in the Concepts. Board and Conference had begun to work in committees, getting more work done with more careful consideration of the subjects.

In 1959, there was much concern about "outside agencies" and A.A.'s relationship to them. Many A.A. members were working in these agencies, and misunderstandings had developed. The idea of cooperation without affiliation was outlined. The Conference agreed it was proper for members as individuals to accept positions in "outside agencies."

Area Highlights were introduced at the 1960 meeting.

The Twelve Concepts were prepared for the 1962 session. A change in ratio of nonalcoholic to alcoholic trustees on the board was urged by Bill and rejected by the Conference.

In 1966, the trustees' plan for the ratio change was accepted: 14 A.A.'s and seven "nons." The Grapevine had been solvent three years, a milestone! But group contributions were down.

In 1967, for the first time, regional A.A. trustees were elected at the Conference.

In 1968, the World Service Meeting was approved, and the Concepts began to be discussed.

In 1969, World Service Meeting delegates from U.S./Canada were selected "out of the hat." A two-year moratorium was approved on applications by areas for additional delegate representation.

John L. Norris, M.D., chairman, General Service Board

Groups and members — spring 1977

	Groups	Members
United States	16,557	320,913
Canada	2,683	47,843
Overseas	7,597	134,537
Hospitals	1,285	30,792
Prisons	1,230	39,323
Lone Members		300
Internationalists		610
Totals	29,352	574,318

(Including nonreported groups and members, it is estimated that there are nearly 30,000 groups and more than 1,000,000 members, in 92 countries.)

Keynote

A.A. lives or dies in the quality of groups

Bill and Dr. Bob shared with that first man on the hospital bed the discovery that together we could do what we had not been able to do alone. That discovery led to the first A.A. group, the cornerstone of a foundation resting today on the far corners of the earth.

Bill said at A.A.'s 25th anniversary, "We are still laying down the foundation on which all coming generations of A.A.'s will have to stand, perhaps for centuries." Today, the 27th Confer-

ence directs its attention to the basic unit of our Fellowship, the A.A. group—where personal recovery, the world of A.A., and the future of A.A. all begin.

It would have been impossible to construct even the base of the triangle of Recovery, Unity, and Service, had not the group been born as the means for transmitting recovery. It is important to think of the difficulties of that birth, remembering our own misery. Each isolated group must have seemed an oasis in a desert. Think of that first tiny group in Akron, with each member clinging to the other, desperately needing to stay sober simply to live, and that other group in New York, also struggling for survival.



The growth that followed was slow—until our media friends made other alcoholics out in the darkness aware of our existence. We know about the thousands of requests for help. Those early A.A.'s alternately laughed and cried as they sifted through the letters, feeling total inability to make adequate response, and yet tremendous excitement at this opportunity to share their new way of life.

Would we be able to form ourselves into groups that could function—hang together? Scattered groups appeared to be operating in *isolated* autonomy, going in all directions at once—setting up their own admission requirements, buying properties, sponsoring products and causes. Bill said, "Growing pains and group problems were terrifying!"

Would the shaky groups accept some form of mortar to hold them together? Would they be willing to make sacrifices so the future of A.A. as a whole might be assured? The question was answered in 1950 in Cleveland, when 3,000 A.A. members adopted our Twelve Traditions. That constructed another side of the triangle and provided the framework on which, group by group, we could continue to grow. When the new wall display of the Traditions hangs in every group's meeting room, each of us can feel personal responsibility for the group and for our common welfare.

Our founders knew the group conscience must eventually replace them. No single individual should ever dominate the whole; there must be rotation. In St. Louis, after a trial period of five years, we knew that elected representatives of the groups, acting through our Conference, could indeed be a sure guide for A.A. The last piece of the framework was in place. The A.A. group is an integral part of each side of that triangle—the group, the means for transmitting personal recovery—the

group, making the sacrifices necessary for a unified A.A.—the group, assuming responsibility for our Fellowship's future.

We are privileged to represent the group conscience of over 19,000 United States and Canadian groups. The temptation is great to rest atop success and the vast numbers—but Bill cautions, "We should never be lulled into complacent self-satisfaction." It is important to look deep into the core of our being, for it is the early identification of weakness and erosion and the shoring-up of the foundation that keep any mighty edifice erect and strong.

Where it all begins—the A.A. group. Perhaps this is where our work as trusted servants should begin, not only this week, but also when we return to our areas. The health of each of our 30,000 groups will determine whether fellow alcoholics live or die.

The quality of each individual group should concern us. Each group, large or small, has equal weight in A.A. We might say, "What an order! How can I apply myself effectively to 800 or 500 or 200 groups?" The Ninth Concept provides an answer—*developing good service leadership will always be important*. In his essay on that Concept, Bill tells us there will always be skilled people in A.A. "capable of dealing with every possible service assignment. We have only to seek these folks out and trust them to serve us."

One hundred new groups mean 100 new G.S.R.'s. Bill says that G.S.R.'s "are the direct agents of the A.A. groups; these are the indispensable linkage between our Fellowship and its world service; these are the primary representatives of A.A.'s group conscience. Without their support and activity, we could not operate permanently at all."

What steps are we taking to provide these new G.S.R.'s with adequate information? Some areas have developed G.S.R. schools and workshops. One area says, "G.S.R.'s today may be young in sobriety, but they are enthusiastic and teachable." The area advises us to let them participate, saying, "Instead of lecturing them, we encourage them to talk about their group problems first, while we listen." Our goal should be a G.S.R. who feels a sponsorship type of responsibility for the welfare of the group.

With the vast number of groups, has there been a change in the quality of A.A.? Does the person walking through the doors today feel the same warmth, humanness, and sense of



being needed that Bill shared with Dr. Bob? Do groups feel threatened and overpowered by the numbers of newcomers? Is there the same excitement, the compelling desire to share sobriety felt by early A.A.'s? Do groups receive all newcomers the same way, or do we look down on those coming to us from court programs and rehab centers? Are people today attending meetings without joining groups? Are they spectators, not participants? In this era of growing alcoholism awareness, are all groups adhering to our single purpose, never allowing it to be influenced by other programs?

The shortcomings of a group will always be the defects of us, its members. If the hand of A.A. is to reach out through groups to all future generations, we need to find the courage to take fearless and continuing group inventories. The A.A. group is where it first began; the A.A. group is where it begins for that



person approaching our doors this very day; and the A.A. group is where it will always begin, as long as God has use for our Fellowship.

Margaret Carlson, general service trustee—U.S.

Well come!

If you have a feeling of personal inadequacy, everyone else feels the same way. Only the most insensitive person comes to this experience without a sense of awe. The Conference represents power that is A.A. itself. Power was described by Dr. Bob as love and service. That is what A.A. is all about. One cannot be separated from the other. How can love be valid if we do not serve?

The Conference, concerned with A.A. groups, is itself an A.A. group. Differing opinions give greater depth of understanding. Anger, fear, and distrust have no place here. If we encounter these feelings within ourselves, we can try to practice love and service. As the week progresses, our sole criterion is what is best for A.A. as a whole.

We can remain quiet within ourselves. We can listen with honesty and open-mindedness to ideas different from our own. If we participate in the proper spirit, God will express Himself through the group conscience.

The word "welcome" is made of two parts. It is important for each of us to know it is *well* that he or she has *come*.

Jim Smith (Arizona), delegate chairman

Here's a statistical group portrait of the 91 delegates.

Average age:	52	years
Oldest delegate:	71	years
Youngest delegate:	31	years
Average length of sobriety:	12.7	years
Longest sobriety:	31	years
Shortest sobriety:	5	years

Delegates' meeting

Three good presentations

"How to Spread the Word—the Delegate's Report," "Delegate's Right of Decision and Group Conscience," and "The Past Delegate—a Dropout?" were subjects of three brief talks at the delegates' meeting Tuesday evening.

Speakers were Joe Kraus Jr. (Tennessee), Stan Cameron (Saskatchewan), and Maggi Bolton (Southern New Jersey). Jim Smith (Arizona) chaired the meeting — an unofficial gathering for the elected area representatives.

Fran Polek (Washington) was elected chairman for 1978; David Aronofsky (Northeastern Texas), alternate chairman.

Hospitality for spouses

Spouses of Conference members had their own hospitality room and a program of events planned for each day. These included luncheon at Lincoln Center, fashion talk at Saks Fifth Avenue, visits to the Metropolitan, Frick, and South Street Seaport Museums, tea with a prominent interior designer in a Fifth Avenue apartment, a tour of the United Nations, a boat trip around Manhattan, and visits to the Statue of Liberty, historic sites, N.B.C., a National Arts Club studio, and the Al-Anon Family Groups World Service Office.

Thirty-six members of New York groups served as hostesses on the Hospitality Committee, chaired by Ann Rimanoczy of the Lenox Hill Group.

Closing brunch

Six farewells

Often hilarious and frequently heart-stirring, the brunch and A.A. meeting that closed the Conference Saturday morning were the occasion of the last Conference talks by six A.A. members.

Sometimes moving their hearers to tears were retiring trustees Margaret Carlson (Agawam, Mass.) and Dave Cooke (Raleigh, N.C.). Robert Macpherson (Pleasant Valley, Conn.) brought roars of laughter, and then Walter Murphy (Tomkins Cove, N.Y.) and Bruce Wight (Waukegan, Ill.) evoked deep identification in their farewells.

Robert Hitchins, chairman of General Services, who retires the end of this year and has 35 years of continuous sobriety, offered an eloquent statement on A.A.'s future. A digest of his remarks follows.

'A magical land called A.A.'

Because this is my 15th and final General Service Conference, it's sort of an emotional experience for me. This talk will be my last Conference talk.

I'm not going to refer to our Conference theme, except for one comment: Perhaps it doesn't go far enough. The A.A. group, for me, is not only where it begins, but where it ends as well.

I wish I had the time to thank individually everyone to whom I'm personally indebted. Perhaps the best I can do is to say to you all, as did the Arab in Bill's last message, "I thank you for your lives." For without your lives, I would have had none; without you, there would have been no me.

I came into A.A. in 1942. I'm glad I did, because there were giants abroad in those days. Bill and Dr. Bob were in their prime; Dr. Silkworth and Sister Ignatia were sobering up drunks by the hundreds; and Bernard Smith was showing us all how indispensable our Class A trustees are. They and most of their associates are gone now. But fortunately, two of these remarkable men remain — Dr. Jack and Austin MacCormick. They've been towers of strength in A.A. for many years. They have seen more A.A. history made than the rest of us put together. We can only read about A.A.'s past; these two lived it, helped to make it. Cherish them as an irreplaceable Fellowship asset. We will not see their like again.

The other person I simply have to thank by name is Bob Pearson. Thanks to his patience, tolerance, and understanding, our personal relationship has been almost entirely free of strain. Pearse has given me a precious gift — peace of mind about G.S.O. This makes it easy for me to sign off. I know I could not leave G.S.O.'s affairs in better hands.

A few years ago, our Conference had as its theme "Service — the Heart of A.A." Our staff members are the heart of service. Working with these wonderful women has been the greatest pleasure, the most unique privilege of my A.A. life. I will always be grateful to them for having taught me so much, and for so much help and A.A. love. Nor can I let this opportunity pass without thanking our nonalcoholic friends and co-workers, Kleina and Madeline and Dennis and all the others. Their contributions largely unrecognized, they have played an indispensable role in our office and our Fellowship. They have given me the great gift of their friendship and love.

I've had the privilege of knowing, meeting, seeing, or hearing 104 of the 115 trustees who have served our Fellowship. I have known about 90 of them well, having worked with them. I have not known a single trustee who has not made a significant contribution to our common welfare. The best friends I have in this world are, or have been, trustees.

Over the years, I've known and worked with some 500 delegates. You're the cornerstone of the whole service structure — not just here in this room, of course, but back in your areas, where the day-to-day work lies. Actually, neither credit nor

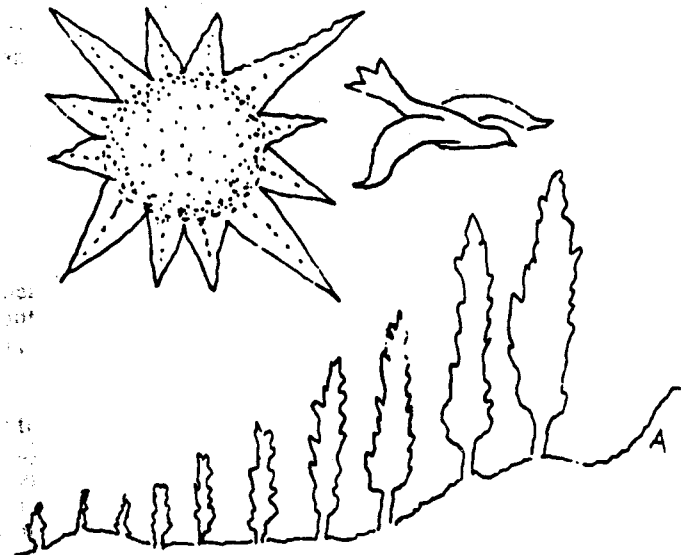
gratitude can be apportioned amongst service workers. All are essential, regardless of rank or title. The most important title in A.A. is one we rarely think of at all. And that, of course, is "A.A. member."

Sometimes, the whole is greater than the sum of its parts. All of us in this room — delegates, trustees, staff, and directors — are more than just the sum of ourselves. We speak for ourselves, but we also represent those who have gone before, and speak for them as well. They have passed the torch to us, as we shall pass it to service workers yet to come. So, in a larger sense, we symbolize the future, too. What we have done this week reflects the actions of many past Conferences, and what we did will affect what future Conference members do. Thus all of us are a part of the continuum of A.A. history.

Some of us, sometimes, are fearful of the future. We fear this development or that problem may destroy us. Fear not, my friends. If this Fellowship ever falters, it won't be because of A.A.'s working as professionals in the field, nor "Rand type" reports, nor members with "other" problems. It will be simply because of us — because we can't control our own egos, nor get along well enough with each other, because we're just not wise nor good enough to hold this thing together, because we think too much about our "rights," and too little about our obligations and responsibilities. But I don't think we're going to fall apart. We are going to stick together, and keep A.A. strong and growing.

One time at a Conference, Bill asked, "Could we survive in a hostile and perilous world — should such a world some day confront us? Could we, for example, continue to function in a dictatorship?" I think we need have no fear. Let cold winds blow, if they must, and the night darken. You and I know a land where the light is bright, and there's a stillness for the spirit. A land we can live in for as long as we wish, for it exists only in our own hearts. It's a magical land called A.A. The Lord, I believe, created A.A. for us. May it be His will that we keep it safe.

Robert Hitchins, chairman, General Services



Third Legacy Activity and Grapevine Growth

Discussions aroused keen interest at the Conference, and digests of the material presented follow.

Importance of rotation throughout the Fellowship

The first presentation, on Monday afternoon, was moderated by trustee Ed Small.

'A step into humility'

We who have been in service work must place a very high priority on rotation, both at the group level and in general service as a whole. Rotation means any member can become involved in our primary purpose. All jobs in A.A. were made to go around.

"The A.A. Group" says rotation "can be a real step forward in growth—a step into the humility which is, for some people, the spiritual essence of anonymity." Anonymity means we forgo personal prestige in A.A. work. Rotation brings spiritual rewards more enduring than fame. With no A.A. "status" at stake, we have complete freedom to serve as we are needed. We don't have to compete for titles or praise.

New people have new knowledge and capabilities that can do much for A.A. Rotation at group level begins when the new member decides we have what he wants and is ready to assume duties such as making coffee or cleaning up after meetings. Rotation gives each member the feeling of being a vital part of the group. I will never forget my own feeling of belonging the first time I was asked to be responsible for a group job. People trusted me! Another treasured memory is when my fellow A.A.'s elected me state secretary. I cried tears of happiness. For someone who had learned to hide emotions, it was real growth. The only tears I ever shed before were in hate and contempt for society, when iron doors clanged shut on me.

We have the responsibility to see that power never becomes an invading force in A.A. We have the experiences of those who have gone before to help us. Rotating helps keep oldtimers from feeling they own some particular A.A. position. It insures that chances for service get shared among many of us, not just a self-selected few. Service committees should rotate regularly, so that every member gets a chance to perform all the duties.

When my term as delegate is up, I will support my successor, and remain active wherever my service is needed.

Joan Ullom (South Dakota)

Is the alternate an active partner?

I am of the opinion that the alternate's role in the service structure is the most important. He is the one on whom we rely for the chain of service to continue.

Alternates should not sit back; they should question and question until they get answers; they should inform fellow members when the need arises. The alternate should work in a team with the person he is alternate to, and should share in decisions, because the alternate must be ready to fill his partner's role.

When I was asked to serve as a replacement delegate on Panel 24, I felt desperate. I was not informed. I had not participated

in any activities, special meetings, or decisions. It is very important that alternates be furnished with all information given to the people for whom they are alternates. Last year, an alternate delegate, with three hours' notice before plane time on the opening day of the Conference, was called to serve as a replacement delegate. He was not equipped with necessary information. Alternate G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s and alternates on committees, such as institutions or public information, say to me, "I am there *on paper* in case something happens to the person I am alternate to."

One alternate G.S.R. was not given the opportunity to share with his G.S.R., because when this G.S.R. was an alternate, *he* was never counseled on the value of sharing. So the alternate, on being elected to serve as G.S.R., felt his only function was to read news bulletins to the group if he was in the mood. Fortunately, when this person learned it was part of his duties to attend district meetings and other special meetings, he returned to where he thought he could be of better service, that is, as coffee-maker. But he determined to return to the service structure later, with a wider knowledge of requirements, so he could function responsibly in any role he was asked to fill.

The role of the alternate should be better defined and brought into the chain of structure, not as a spare tire, but as a role with importance. Literature should be prepared to explain these functions. I believe "The A.A. Service Manual" includes little attaching importance to the alternate's role.

I have made it a personal goal to place more emphasis on the role of the alternate and to inform alternates how they can participate. When they are given this sense of direction, I think they will be better prepared to serve in any role. With this progress, I am sure our service structure will become stronger, so the message will be carried to more alcoholics who still suffer, and we will receive them and guide them in a more responsible manner in our Fellowship.

George McKerral (Northeastern Quebec)

Advisory Action related to this topic: 12 (p. 43)

Is rotation possible in business?

Bill discusses this aspect of Concept Eleven on pp. 60-61 of "Twelve Concepts for World Service." But let me make some personal observations as a member of the A.A.W.S. board. Except for the two paid G.S.O. staff members and the two out-of-town Class B trustees on this board, A.A.W.S. directors rotate every four years. However, an in-town director who is elected a trustee on the General Service Board continues to serve on the A.A.W.S. board, as its trustee representative, until the time comes to rotate off the "big board."

But what of rotation among the paid staff workers? In "Twelve Concepts for World Service," Bill says (in part):

"We have found it impractical and unfair to set any fixed term of employment. A staff member has to have several years' training. Are we then to throw her out, just as she is getting top grade? If she realized she could serve for only a fixed period, could we have hired her in the first place? Probably not. These posts are hard to fill. They require just the right personality,

ability, stability, and business and A.A. experience. If we insisted on a fixed term of service, we would often engage A.A.'s really not qualified. This would be both harmful and unfair."

As a businesswoman, I agree wholeheartedly. G.S.O. is a business office. I cannot imagine trying to run a business office where I threw out my most valuable employees every four years. I certainly would not relish trying to *hire* good staff members if they were to be unemployed after a few years of giving their best to A.A. I believe the greatest asset of G.S.O. is the accumulated, collective experience and wisdom of the staff. We should avail ourselves of this storehouse of experience as long as possible.

There are now nine staff assignments, and the women rotate through them on more or less a two-year basis. So it would take 18 years for a staff member to know every job! My personal concern is not that they might hang on too long, but that we are losing valuable and beloved staff members too rapidly—having just said farewell to Waneta New.

The general manager of G.S.O., of course, does not rotate the same way staff members do, but general managers rotate nevertheless. The first paid manager of the office was hired in 1953; in 24 years since then, G.S.O. has had four.

In conclusion, then, the spirit and practice of rotation are maintained by members of the A.A.W.S. board and—insofar as possible, consistent with efficient operations and Concept Eleven—by paid staff members and administrators at G.S.O.

Jacquelyn Solomon, director, A.A.W.S.

'Pry them loose gently'

It says on the agenda this talk is called "The Letter of the Law," the sort of title only an alcoholic would think up. First, we don't have any "laws," and even if we did, we'd never be able to enforce them to the letter.

But we do have Traditions. We also have principles and customs. Rotation is both. It is based on an ethical principle, and it is a long-standing A.A. custom. Sometimes, obeying "the letter of the law" isn't enough. Especially in A.A., conforming to the *spirit* of the law is even more important.

So what do we do about the occasional trusted servant who is rotated out of a service job but can't or won't let go? Such "reluctant" servants are the exception, but we do see them once in a while, at every service level. We had a group in New York, named (let's say) the "700 E. 70th Street Group." But nobody called it that. For 20-some years, everyone called it the "Spencer Group," on account of "Bill and Clara Spencer" always ran that group. They rotated out of their group offices cheerfully, but *never* stopped running that group.

At the other end of the spectrum, I knew a past trustee who retained control over his area. Years after he rotated off the board, candidates for delegate and trustee had to be "cleared" with him in advance.

You've seen examples of this "vested interest" in your own areas, I expect. We all have proprietary rights in the Fellowship itself. But none of us has such rights in any specific service job.

I don't mean this is a common problem; it isn't. Most of our service folk step down gracefully, often very gladly. My talk is concerned only with those few who cannot.

Sometimes, an ex-servant sincerely feels his successor simply isn't doing the job right. Naturally—for the good of the Fellowship, of course—he feels it is his duty to straighten the new person out. Sometimes, he realizes he knows more than less experienced members. Is it his fault if he's wiser than they? Why, it's practically his *duty* to run things from behind the scenes.

Don't let them do it! It's almost always bad for you, bad for them, and bad for Alcoholics Anonymous. Seek their advice, but don't feel you must act on it. Listen to their opinions, but listen harder when they answer your questions.

When they rotate out of office, they're obeying "the letter of the law," but are they obeying its spirit if they still try to run the show? Inability to let go can become something close to an illness. Sometimes, these unfortunate folk need help in learning to *really* step down. We may even have to pry their hands from the helm, figuratively. But whatever needs doing to make them let go—do it! You'll be doing everyone concerned a favor—including the reluctant ex-servant.

One note of caution: Let's remember the vast majority of our past service people were tireless workers. They rendered very real services to the Fellowship. So let's sever them from their obsession with compassion and gratitude. Let's pry them loose gently if we can; but if we can't, pry them loose *any* way.

Robert E. Hitchins, chairman, General Services

Rotation and the Conference Charter and Warranties were subjects of workshop sessions for which area delegates and other Conference members met in ten sections. Each section decided for itself whether to take up a list of suggested topics, or to hold a completely unstructured gathering—a sort of informal sharing session. Later, reports were made to the full Conference.

Workshop report-back on rotation included these points.

1 Benefits of rotation are:

- a To the group — keeping it alive and active, developing leadership, and providing action and attraction.
- b To the Fellowship — making people aware of, and contributing ideas to, A.A. as a whole.
- c To the individual — offering opportunities for personal growth and for humility, and developing a sense of responsibility.

2 Do trusted servants have trouble rotating?

On the whole, no. But rural areas experience more problems than urban and suburban because of insufficient people.

3 Is there more rotation in the Third Legacy structure than in the A.A. group?

Yes, most agreed, because the rotation is built into our service structure.

4 What are spiritual aspects of rotation?

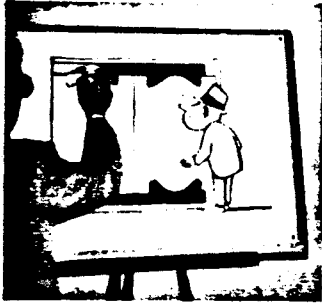
"It is an exercise in humility and an opportunity for greater personal growth. It exemplifies the Twelfth Tradition of placing

principles before personalities, and underscores the fact that our leaders are but trusted servants who do not govern."

5 In general discussion, it was agreed rotation is a key principle of service. "It teaches us to trust, and trust is the beginning of faith."

Grapevine

Given on Tuesday afternoon, this presentation was moderated by Chuck Hanson, who also gave the first report. A sixth (unlisted) participant put in an appearance when Jack Morley added an informal postscript to the editor's report by turning to an easel and sketching Victor E. With the July issue, Jack announced, the GV cartoon character will be 15 nervous years away from his last drink, though the poor fellow doesn't seem to have progressed past the First Step.



Circulation peaks, but ...

Directors' report: In December 1976, circulation reached a record high of 88,800, and early in 1977 it climbed over the 90,000 mark. Sounds good — and it is — *but* even now, only about ten percent of A.A.'s around the world subscribe to the Grapevine.

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., is a nonprofit corporation owned by the General Service Board. Bill W., in "Twelve Concepts for World Service," wrote: "... because the Grapevine is such a dissimilar operation and because we ought not concentrate too much money and executive authority in a single entity, there should be no merger of A.A. World Services and the A.A. Grapevine." So the Grapevine board and staff have, along with responsibility for putting out our monthly journal, "the needed authority, funds, personnel, and equipment to carry it out." Nine directors meet every three months to conduct corporation business. They oversee publication, insure adherence to the Traditions, and approve the budget. They are also available to the staff any business day.

Responsibility for day-to-day operation and editorial decisions is vested in the staff: a full-time editor, a full-time associate editor, a new full-time staff assistant, a part-time copy editor and proofreader—all four of whom are A.A. members—and a non-A.A. editorial secretary. An A.A. circulation manager has a staff of six hardworking non-A.A.'s.

An editorial board meets five times a year to advise the editors, help originate editorial ideas, and carry out some writing and art assignments. It has 13 members, all with special skills in communications.

Income also increased in 1976, and the Grapevine contributed \$40,000 to the General Service Board.

Charles Hanson, chairman

A shot with a twist

I'm the editor of an A.A. newsletter, so I thought I had a plan to increase Grapevine circulation substantially in a short period. I wrote all Panel 25 and 26 delegates, asking them to urge more people to subscribe to the Grapevine *and* to send me the names of all A.A. newsletters in their areas.

As each delegate responded, I wrote to the newsletters. I said we had set our sights on a 100,000-circulation figure by the end of April 1977. I told them a lot of A.A. members miss out on a tremendous tool to improve the quality of their sobriety, and I asked for their help in spreading the Grapevine story in the newsletters. In follow-up letters, I continued my quest for names of newsletters into March, getting good response from Panel 27 delegates in areas that had not responded earlier. In January, I thanked newsletters for their cooperation, but asked for one more plug. I sent a copy of a page from the Greater Seattle Intergroup newsletter, which had given the Grapevine an excellent spread.

I believe this is our best means of reaching nonsubscribers. Many newsletters have reproduced the Grapevine subscription blank, and several have written articles on the magazine.

It's necessary to make subscribing easy. My own procrastinating is probably typical. I bought my copy at our club regularly, but in Denver in 1975, the Grapevine display table was so well positioned I could no longer avoid subscribing—ten years after joining A.A.!

My wife and I sold 15 subscriptions in about 30 minutes, just standing by the registration table during the second day of a regional conference. I think the chairman of every conference, roundup, or convention of any kind should have a Grapevine display as part of the registration setup. And we delegates can help them. A display kit is available from the Grapevine, and I wrote the chairman of every event listed in the Grapevine, suggesting the kit be used.

It's been a pleasant experience for me to have taken a job and given it my best shot—a new twist from trying to do a lot of jobs while half-shot.

Bud Grondahl (North Dakota), chairman, Conference Grapevine Committee

More subscribers mean more problems

I can report an all-time high in Grapevine circulation. And the increase between 1976 and 1977 is greater than any previous one-year increase. Circulation rose in just about every state and province.

We in the business office would be happiest if we could personally address and mail your Grapevine the minute we receive your order. But that is physically impossible. The only way we can handle subscriptions is by computer. Most of the time, computers work efficiently, and we are quite comfortable with them by now.

But disadvantages accompany the benefits. For example, the first issue of a subscription sometimes arrives long after an order is sent. If an order misses the computer cutoff date by

In addition to the magazine, we distribute sets of slogans, the book "Best Cartoons from the Grapevine," and other materials. These are sent from our own mail room — as were the 27,500 orders for the 1977 Grapevine Calendar. Our mail room also sends back issues of the Grapevine at no charge to hospitals and correctional institutions. Correspondence makes it clear the Grapevine is thoroughly read in institutions. We don't handle

One area over which we have no control is the post office. This winter, severe cold and fuel shortages played havoc with our mailing schedules, and we ask all subscribers to forgive any delays and inconveniences. If you receive Grapevines in damaged condition, let us know. We'll be delighted to send duplicate copies.

Kitty Kiernan, circulation manager

Circulation 4/1/77 - 91,225; circulation 4/1/76 - 84,842; increase for period-6,383

United States	Circulation 4/1/77	Circulation 4/1/76		Circulation 4/1/77	Circulation 4/1/76		Circulation 4/1/77	Circulation 4/1/76
Alabama	708	649	Montana	460	450	Puerto Rico	201	125
Alaska	274	238	Nebraska	910	789	U.S. Possessions	<u>125</u>	<u>158</u>
Arizona	877	798	Nevada	302	284		77,711	73,033
Arkansas	638	591	New Hampshire	599	506			
California	8,158	7,492	New Jersey	2,610	2,546		Increase for period -	4,678
Colorado	1,016	998	New Mexico	435	408			
Connecticut	1,686	1,550	New York	6,471	6,319	Canada		
Delaware	300	308	North Carolina	1,735	1,624			
District of Columbia	520	586	North Dakota	588	464	Alberta	1,730	1,001
Florida	3,114	2,976	Ohio	2,605	2,511	British Columbia	1,840	1,580
Georgia	1,598	1,342	Oklahoma	1,245	1,210	Manitoba	1,014	850
Hawaii	170	202	Oregon	762	750	New Brunswick	445	327
Idaho	288	210	Pennsylvania	2,662	2,501	Newfoundland	155	128
Illinois	3,462	3,270	Rhode Island	503	427	Northwest Territories	53	43
Indiana	1,324	1,283	South Carolina	805	742	Nova Scotia	750	608
Iowa	1,200	1,153	South Dakota	576	535	Ontario	4,906	4,485
Kansas	1,345	1,283	Tennessee	895	803	Prince Edward Island	15	170
Kentucky	749	688	Texas	3,522	3,372	Quebec	390	561
Louisiana	798	658	Utah	288	287	Saskatchewan	1,040	845
Maine	500	443	Vermont	352	310	Yukon	<u>10</u>	<u>5</u>
Maryland	1,543	1,412	Virginia	1,808	1,678		12,348	10,603
Massachusetts	3,970	3,944	Washington	2,024	1,924			
Michigan	2,869	2,767	West Virginia	475	454		Increase for period -	1,745
Minnesota	3,419	3,049	Wisconsin	2,146	2,038			
Mississippi	506	538	Wyoming	<u>174</u>	<u>154</u>	Foreign	1,166	1,206
Missouri	1,401	1,236		77,385	72,750			
							Decrease for period -	40

When I came to the staff, I thought the Grapevine was a great little magazine. Readable, attractive, handy pocket size, helpful in emergencies, and soothing at bedtime.

My first few months, I spent a lot of time reading manuscripts, and woke up to the fact that I was being twelfth-stepped by the entire Fellowship! An A.A. in California wrote about an experience that helped me solve a problem; a member in Ohio shed new light on a phrase I'd heard at a meeting the night before; people in Maine and Alabama and Wisconsin and Texas were speaking directly to me, in manuscript pages that would become Grapevine pages.

1944, largely to communicate with members in the armed forces overseas, who couldn't get to meetings. Soon, groups around the country asked that it be the national A.A. magazine, and in 1948, the newspaper-size format was changed to the present size.

In the 1940's, A.A. news ranged from reports of new groups being formed to an article about A.A.'s tenth-anniversary celebration in 1945, when 2,500 members from 36 states gathered in Cleveland with Bill and Dr. Bob. The Grapevine was already talking about pill problems, and Bill W. wrote an article on "Those Goof Balls." Then there was the article by an A.A. who urged that a special group be formed for "older members" – those with one or two months of sobriety. Bill loved the Grapevine and used it as a means of keeping in touch with the groups. The Traditions were born and grew to their present form in Bill's articles entitled "Twelve Points to Assure Our Future."

In the December 1950 Grapevine, Bill and Dr. Bob issued a call for their successors. The co-founders suggested that the A.A. membership as a whole should take over, through a General Service Conference, the worldwide service jobs performed for so long by the older members. Then in 1955, in St. Louis, the Conference became the permanent embodiment of A.A. service. A.A. had come of age.

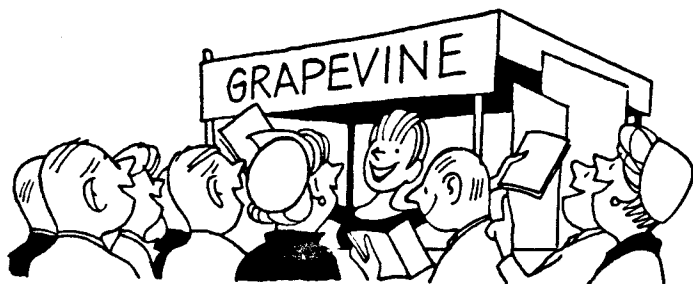
The seventh Grapevine carried Lois W.'s story, telling how she came to live by A.A. principles for herself, not just for Bill. In that same issue, teenage children of A.A.'s talked about how A.A. had changed their lives. Later, Al-Anon and Alateen groups were started. We try to publish at least one Al-Anon piece each year.

Maturity has growing pains as well as rewards, reflected today in the Grapevine — from major trends in the Fellowship to problems like smoking and bad language at meetings.

Ann Warner, associate editor

Our magazine now stresses sobriety

Bill wrote that the Grapevine "is a chief means of communication among us." Communication is the lodestar that guides the Grapevine staff. The Grapevine tries to reflect the thinking of A.A. members as it is today. It shares individual experience, and it reports both the inner growth of A.A. members and the outward growth of the A.A. Fellowship.



It is a forum for debate; we do not shy away from the thinking of some who differ from others. It would be a dull magazine if there were never any differences. Our "Closed Meeting Topics" are being used more and more for group discussion. The Grapevine reports some general service activities, thus building interest in A.A.'s world services. Through humor and inspirational material, we try to communicate the joy of living the A.A. way of life.

By now, I have been associated with the Grapevine for 18 years. In all these years, there has been but one sad note. We fail, and continue to fail, in communicating with a small but important number of folks within the Fellowship. For instance, every morning the staff goes over the day's mail, letters that are moving, provocative, hilarious, or shocking, and sometimes, a really splendid piece of writing for the magazine. Every letter is answered. But what do you do with a communication that asks for a reply and is signed "Anonymous"? It is not an anonymity break to give us your full name. There is nothing about A.A. on our envelope. But we are still unable to communicate this idea to many members.

We do not publish poetry, personal prayers, tributes to departed beloved sponsors, or pieces that proselyte for a particular religion. But every day we receive loads of such material. How we wish we could talk over the valid reasons for this with each of you!

If we look at our circulation figures, we conclude we *are* communicating with a great many A.A.'s. For the last several years, every month has hit a new all-time high in circulation. Also, we receive more and better manuscripts than ever before. Practically everything that is published in the Grapevine comes to us, unsolicited, through the mail.

The Grapevine has grown in philosophy as well as in circulation. In early years, there was a great deal about drinking in our pages. Today, the Grapevine concentrates on sobriety, coping with reality, inner spiritual growth, and the strength and joy of living the A.A. life. We hope you make people at home aware that the Grapevine is available to enlighten and strengthen their-sobriety.

Jack Morley, editor

Advisory Actions related to the Grapevine: 24, 25, 26 (p. 44)

Cooperation and communication among all levels of service

The second Tuesday presentation was a well-received exhortation for unity among all A.A. units. Trustee Robert Macpherson moderated.

They begin with the group and its G.S.R.

Could we recovered alcoholics hold together? Could we function as groups, as a whole? . . . These thoughts ran through Bill's and Dr. Bob's minds as they looked through the window of Dr. Bob's living room back in 1937. Today, these same thoughts run through my mind.

Since then, we have been given the Traditions, forged out of 20 years of trial and error. However, the Traditions, like the Concepts—both so very necessary for good cooperation and communication—are read and understood by very few. "The group (or the club) is the only thing I need. Who gives a damn about New York? Central office is the only one I support. I don't need whatever you call it—area, district, whatever." Sound familiar? Are these statements the result of cooperation and communication?

Workshops and panel discussions, I feel, are the best vehicle for better communication, and eventually cooperation. They offer a casual setting, where everyone may express views. The format can be altered to cover just about any subject. Workshops have now become a must at every assembly in my area. The topic is usually chosen by the area chairman, with G.S.R.'s and groups submitting suggestions beforehand.

Open-to-the-public meetings are now conducted regularly, with our first Spanish open-to-the-public meeting scheduled next month. Last year, our central office had its first Rio Grande Rally, scheduled to be an annual affair. None of this would have been possible if we did not have cooperation and communication among all levels of service.

If you note our service structure chart, at the very top are the group and G.S.R.'s. Cooperation and communication begin at this point. If the G.S.R. is active, you can just feel the activity and good this group generates. The G.S.R. should attend meetings and functions of other service committees—such as hospitals and institutions, intergroup, or central office—not as a participant, but as an observer. It is vital that all groups and all service committees complement one another, rather than compete. Rivalry among organizations is productive in the business world, but I don't think it has any place in A.A. And I don't feel any A.A. service committee should consider itself autonomous. Every action it takes affects A.A. as a whole. A.A. is judged by the A.A. individual that the public is in contact with.

Here are some suggestions:

- 1 Set up a workshop or two. Call it a panel, seminar, sharing session—it doesn't matter. Start with the group servants, then district and area. Invite all A.A.'s.
- 2 Stress the study of the Traditions and the Concepts.
- 3 Review the service structure with your area. Explain how groups fit into it.
- 4 Include some type of workshop at all assemblies.
- 5 Involve the Fellowship. Many times, we assume they know what we are talking about. It is our responsibility to see that they do.

Larry Kloepfel (New Mexico)

Information spreads cooperation

In our early days, our general service area committee met once every two years to elect a Conference delegate. That was the extent of our service. As time went on, some members realized the need for someone to take A.A. into institutions, and this was done on an individual basis. Older members took along new people and thus perpetuated a sense of responsibility to carry the message at this level. When the persons responsible for taking A.A. into institutions were unable to do so, no more meetings were available for those confined. Eventually, one inmate wrote a letter to intergroup, asking for members to come in. The need for an institutions committee was recognized, if the message was to be carried at this level on a continuing basis. So that committee was formed and worked so well, it set an example for other areas.

As groups began to develop, it was apparent an intergroup would be necessary to keep groups informed, in order (1) to coordinate A.A. activities among groups, (2) to help weaker groups, (3) to suggest ways to remedy defects in group procedure, (4) to maintain friendly feelings among groups, (5) to conduct meetings so each group visits and is visited at least once a month, and (6) to act upon any suggestion that would be of potential benefit to the whole. It was made clear that intergroup was not interested in trying to run any group's affairs.

Recently, a committee was formed to consider the advisability of opening an intergroup office. Now, the Intergroup Committee updates meeting schedules every six months and publishes a monthly newsletter, useful to any A.A. service unit and mak-

ing more information available to everyone. Another service provided by intergroup is 24-hour telephone coverage.



In our area, all committees—General Service, Intergroup, Institutions, and Public Information combined with C.P.C.—meet once a month. The chairman of each committee attends every service meeting, sharing all activities of his committee. Everyone knows what's going on and can cooperate with one another. For example, the P.I. Committee and the Institutions Committee work together to carry the message to staffs and those confined in hospitals and jails.

Groups are being formed by new people not familiar with our Traditions and not cognizant of any service structure. We believe those members will not attend service meetings. Therefore, we should take service to them. Each group needs to be well informed to make good decisions.

Attending service meetings can give G.S.R.'s an opportunity to become well-informed about all problems affecting the area or A.A. as a whole.

Colette Ross (Western Massachusetts)

Advisory Action related to this topic: 16 (p. 44)

The role of the regional trustee

Bruce Wight, himself a regional trustee (East Central U.S.), moderated this session on Tuesday afternoon.

Steps Four and Five again

I found out very soon as regional trustee that there was much more to be learned about our structure than I had realized as G.S.R., area committee member, and delegate. I realized Steps Four and Five were in order again regarding my new assignment in service. I have come to know the regional trustee has to be well acquainted with "The A.A. Service Manual," the Twelve Traditions, the Twelve Steps, "Twelve Concepts for World Service," and the Conference Charter, for questions and opinions at assemblies usually involve these tools.

The Conference delegates a liberal administrative authority to the board so trustees may act freely and effectively in the absence of the Conference. Why are trustees given such wide latitude? The answer is that the Fellowship holds all the trustees responsible for our service activities: A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. Much of the regional trustee's work is involved with these two entities and with his service on trustees' committees.

No trustee represents a particular geographical section of the country, since all trustees represent the Fellowship as a whole. However, the regional trustee does bring to the board a regional point of view that is invaluable. A large part of the regional trustee's time is devoted to the region from which he is elected. He or she is invited to many A.A. conventions and conferences. Sometimes, the regional trustee is expected to be all things to all members of the Fellowship.

Bill W. said, "Somewhere in our literature there is a statement to this effect: 'Our leaders do not drive by mandate, they lead by example.' In effect, we are saying to them, 'Act for us, but don't boss us.'" I believe a regional trustee has to put principles, plans, and policies into such dedicated and effective action that the rest of us want to back up the trustee and help with the job.

I believe it is the responsibility of the regional trustee to be of service to all functions in our Fellowship, regardless of location. Advice should always be based on principles rather than personalities, and all activities should be done in the spirit of love and service.

Dave Cooke, regional trustee (Southeastern U.S.)

'Loyalty, sincerity, enthusiasm'

In few A.A. service jobs, if any, is ability alone sufficient. Needed also are loyalty, sincerity, enthusiasm, and cooperativeness—all necessary for the regional trustee.

Until an A.A. member really gets involved in service work, it's hard to understand our service structure. I have heard questions about the power of the General Service Board. It would be impossible for A.A. to operate if every problem had to be taken to the members for decision. So it is necessary to have our structure. But our trustees are not people in power. They are all trusted servants.

The regional trustee can give you a feeling of belonging by showing up at your area's conference and keeping your region informed on some of the problems the board is working on. A lot of unnecessary faultfinding happens simply because people are not informed. I feel the local trustee should take part in local affairs as much as possible, not as an officer, but so the group can benefit from experience and leadership.

Six regional trustees from the U.S. and two from Canada give us a good cross section. They are appointed to board committees. As we see, the role of regional trustee is one of work and responsibility that almost boggle the mind. But I don't think we have to worry about too much power in one area, unless we rank-and-file members do not see that we get good people into service work.

I suggest you get to know these trustees, and you will be really convinced that they have ability, loyalty, sincerity, enthusiasm, and cooperativeness. Getting to know them has made me a little better.

Earle McNutt (Northern Illinois)

Floor Action related to this topic: 4 (p. 43)
Advisory Actions: 51 to 55, 57 (p. 46)

The Conference Charter and Warranties

The last presentation of the week was moderated by trustee John Waterfield on Thursday afternoon.

'The almost perfect democracy'

I knew the late attorney Bernard Smith was always available to Bill for consultation, but I didn't know until recently that Bern was actually author of the Charter and Warranties. The Charter was adopted by the International Convention in St. Louis in 1955. I came into A.A. in 1946, when the only leadership we knew about was Bill W., in a small office in New York with one secretary and a few volunteers. We could look to him for answers to all our questions, and he would help us solve many of our problems. We did not know that Bill had surrounded himself with tremendous talent—men with fine educational background and varied business experience.

The Charter is brief and to the point. Through it, we have been given the almost perfect democracy, in which responsibilities, opportunities, and privileges are shared. Some things that appeal to me in the Charter are these:

We are told the Conference shall be *a service body only, never a government for A.A.* The Conference is a method by which A.A.'s collective group conscience can speak. It insures that the full voice of A.A. will be heard, whether it represents the great majority or a minority.

Our method of voting works exceedingly well. For instance, the two-thirds vote majority eliminates hard feelings that can follow close elections, and assures the person elected the support of those voting.

Except in a great emergency, neither the board nor any of its related entities ought ever take any action likely to greatly affect A.A. as a whole without first consulting the Conference.

Finally, the General Warranties of the Conference Charter provide protection for us all, and give a sense of strength, continuity, and dependability to the Fellowship.

In closing, I quote from Bill's Miami Beach talk in 1970. If we carefully and prayerfully follow the guidelines laid out in the Conference Charter, then "A.A. will surely live for 1,000 years, if it be God's will."

Mike Rainbolt, regional trustee (Southwest U.S.)

Tradition's power, plus leeway for change

By the mid-1940's, it became apparent to Bill and to Dr. Bob that their position as guardians of A.A. policy was at best temporary. Both knew our Society required some positive procedure to replace their personal leadership. The terminal nature of Dr. Bob's illness made formulation of such an instrumental imperative. The idea and the specifics for the General Service Conference gradually took shape.

Upon adoption of the Charter in 1955, it became the blueprint for operation of our Fellowship. While the Conference Charter has no *legal* weight, adherence to its principles falls into the

area of tradition, which, in the experience of A.A. through the years, is probably more binding than strict legality. Laws can be changed by the stroke of a pen, or by the vote of a group of people; but tradition, drawing its strength from long periods of successful use, really packs power. We disregard or break it at our peril.

I'll not go into individual provisions. They are right there in "The A.A. Service Manual" for us all to read (beginning on p. 23). Rather, I prefer to deal with the sense and the feeling of the Charter. It grants privilege and establishes responsibility, but at the same time, stipulates that privilege or responsibility shall not be misused. Talk about "checks and balances"—the Charter epitomizes these. Relationships are specifically spelled out—between the Conference and the board (and *its* functioning corporations); between the Conference and A.A. as a whole; between the Conference and regions and assemblies; between the Conference and districts, groups, and individual members.

The members who wrote the Charter, however, took into account that time does not stand still, that new circumstances appear, and that modification of any code may be necessary. The Charter makes provision for needed changes in itself. But, recognizing that any far-reaching change must be determined by the group conscience of the Fellowship as a whole, rather than of a small segment of it, changes may not be accomplished frivolously. There must be a majority of sufficient size to represent the conscience of a large portion of the membership.

Article 12 of the Charter, the Warranties, states the basic principles of the entire Charter.

We delegates ought to be conscious of the provisions of the Charter, and make them known. We ought to resist the tendency to bludgeon our areas with these principles, but rather insinuate them with a delicate touch into situations where they seem to apply. Perhaps time and frequency of mention, and occasionally a workshop, may overcome apathy, so we may some time discuss the Charter and Warranties as freely as we now discuss the Steps and the Traditions.

Henry F. Cleaveland (Maine)

'We work together as equals'

The General Warranties of the Conference are:

"In all its proceedings, the General Service Conference shall observe the spirit of the A.A. Tradition, taking great care that the Conference never becomes the seat of perilous wealth or power; that sufficient operating funds, plus an ample reserve, be its prudent financial principle; that none of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others; that all important decisions be reached by discussion, vote, and, whenever possible, by substantial unanimity; that no Conference action ever be personally punitive or an incitement to public controversy; that, though the Conference may act for the service of Alcoholics Anonymous, it shall never perform any acts of government; and that, like the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous which it serves, the Conference itself will always remain democratic in thought and action."

These Warranties are beautiful to me. They are a clear, ringing affirmation of the A.A. spirit.

I started to work at G.S.O. one week before the 1959 Conference, and have attended each one since. My first reaction was gratitude to be a part of A.A. In the past, detailed staff, board, and committee reports were made. This gave every Conference member an opportunity to ask questions and offer suggestions about G.S.O. services. Written reports are still available in your Conference Manual. But I wonder if a better job would be done if more time was given to them. The A.A. groups delegated to the Conference complete authority for the maintenance of A.A.'s world services. But can the Conference do this without knowing what is done at G.S.O.?



Periodically, questions come up about the right of various Conference members (staff, trustees) to vote in Conference matters. From long experience, we have learned much about the concept of participation. It is wonderful to give trustees, directors, and staff, as well as delegates, the right of participation *in proportion to the responsibility that each carries*. All Conference members have the same purpose, though we all have different functions. We have a structure that enables me to be a sincere, active Conference member. It boils down to this: We work together as equals. Our structure confirms this concept.

When the time comes for staff to make a decision on any matter, it is not made on a personal, self-centered basis, but on experience shared at G.S.O. and on actions of the Conference.

Beth Kuhlmann, G.S.O. staff

Workshop report-back: Discussions centered on the following questions and produced useful ideas on each.

1 How does the Charter apply to . . .

a Delegates? It provides a sense of responsibility and a sense of direction without authority. It emphasizes the spiritual values in our structure by helping us maintain a proper proportion in interrelationships of the various entities, through use of the group conscience, and it encourages democratic communication.

b Trustees? It insures the practical authority of the Conference. Both Conference and trustees (as part of it) have custodial responsibility for the Steps and Traditions.

c G.S.O.? The Charter reminds the service office that it is to serve the Fellowship, not direct it. It gives the staffs of G.S.O. and the Grapevine the same rights of participation and responsibility that other Conference members have.

d A.A. groups? The Charter gives the same guarantees to groups that it gives to Conference members, providing continuity of group form, type, and/or service throughout the U.S. and

Canada. But groups can apply Charter principles only if they are familiar with these principles.

It was emphasized that the Charter is a spiritual document, reminding us that we do not govern, but are governed by the group conscience.

2 How can an A.A. group use the Warranties?

Substituting the word "group" for "Conference" illustrates their

applicability to groups.

3 How can we familiarize service committees and A.A. groups with the Charter and Warranties?

Suggestions included using them as problem-solvers and workshop topics and discussing them through service sponsors, delegate reports, and articles in *Box 4-5-9*.

Advisory Action related to this subject: 21 (p. 44)

A.A. Publications and the Group Conscience

A.A. directories

Where do we go from here?

Even within our talkative Fellowship, few things beget more discussion than listing in the directories. Ask any of the staff. It beats the weather by a long shot.

It might be good to remind ourselves that the directories are merely by-products of necessary record-keeping. They serve to remind us of our shortcomings. And to keep us humble, maybe. If we elected not to continue the directories, the failings of our record-keeping would persist.

A look back—or where we've been

In September 1940, a letter from the Headquarters Office carried a listing of nine groups considered "secure and can be depended upon": Akron, Chicago, Cleveland, Detroit, Houston, Los Angeles, New York, Philadelphia, and Washington, D.C. Thus, our first "directory" came into being. In November 1940, the first "A.A. bulletin" appeared, listing 13 groups in addition to the "secure" nine.

The 1941 list, on three legal-sized sheets, reported 60 white-star groups (at least one meeting per week), 24 red-star (those just beginning to form), and 30 green-star (Loners). The explosion had begun. That summer, Ruth Hock, the office's lone (nonalcoholic) secretary, wrote Dr. Bob: "I'm still trying to get the damn bulletin together with the addresses, etc., but it all ways seems to me more important to get the letters answered."

Now—or where we're at

Growth is still with us. During 1977, we will publish six separate directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S., Canada, Correctional Facilities, Hospitals and Rehabilitation Centers, and International. These will represent 29,352 individual groups and reflect a membership of more than 1,000,000. Over 2,155 new groups were reported in just the U.S. and Canada during 1976.

Sometimes, it appears nothing's right about the directories.

Still, some 50,000 were distributed in 1976, at a total cost of \$63,500. In a 1972 poll, 513 (86%) of the 600 respondents reported the usefulness of the directories in traveling and moving.



Here are some improvements currently being used:

1 We are providing each delegate with copies of group information we have on file for each area—useful or outdated. Consequently, you know *what* we have.

2 Acquisition of our own computer reduces reliance on outside facilities. We hope in-house hardware and custom design systems will facilitate corrections and proofing, simplify the entire procedure, and shorten required lead times for changes and new listings.

A look ahead—or where do we go from here?

Mary Ellen recently invited each of the delegates to provide his or her own experiences and suggestions on the subject of directories. Some 34 (40%) of the 91 took her up on it. I have consolidated your replies, with comments from the staff and general membership, into three categories.

The first, Data Collection, concerns composition of the directories:

- 1 Should we list *only* the central offices in areas where these are located, and list individual groups and Loners *only* in areas that have no central offices?
- 2 If G.S.R.'s were offered a workshop on record-keeping, would improvement in the quality of listed information result?
- 3 Should we delete groups not heard from for two consecutive years?
- 4 Should annual printouts be sent directly to G.S.R.'s for updating and correction, rather than to the delegate?

The second category, Organization and Format, relates to content and presentation of material:

- 1 Since the group meeting place and time are usually changed less often than the G.S.R.'s address, should we consider listing the former only?
- 2 Should we organize the directories by states and provinces, alphabetically, rather than retain the present method (by regions)?
- 3 Should we, when requested, list local entities collectively within states—for example, Martha's Vineyard or Cape Cod?
4. Should we consider returning to one U.S. directory, rather than two?
- 5 Should we consider offering a toll-free (800) wide-area telephone service, instead of printed directories?

The third category, Uses and Abuses, considers protection of our lists from commercial misuse:

- 1 Should we publish only the first name and telephone number of the G.S.R. and group contact, to reduce the commercial advantage of the directories?
- 2 Should G.S.O. retain the G.S.R. mailing list, for protection, and handle intra-Fellowship mailings directly, at cost?

Present production schedules for the 1977 directories preclude action now on any of the above suggestions. Rather, these considerations should be carried to the groups and the group conscience of U.S. and Canada A.A., for possible action at the Conference next year.

Frank Mauser, administrative assistant, G.S.O.

Floor Action related to this topic: 6 (p. 43)

Box 4-5-9

What would be the ideal Box 4-5-9 be like?

Box 4-5-9, our A.A. newsletter, mailed every other month to almost 40,000, is our primary communication tool. We would like it to reflect a wide A.A. experience and meet the needs and wishes of the entire Fellowship. If *Box 4-5-9* could become exactly the kind of bulletin you want it to be, what would it be like?

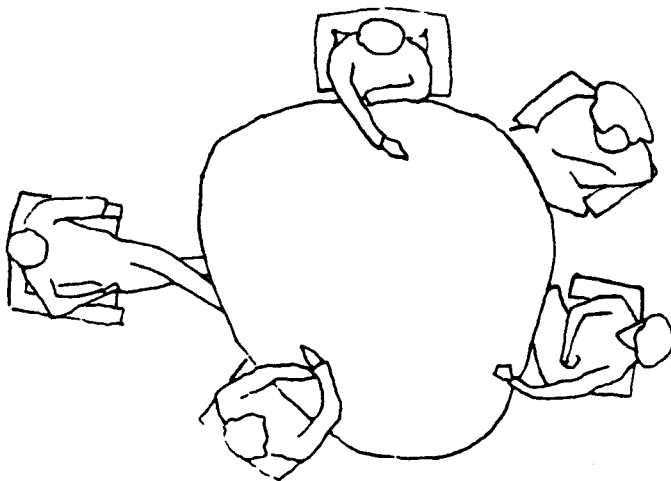
From its inception, its purpose has been to improve communication between groups and G.S.O. In November 1940, it first appeared as a one-sheet newsletter called *The A.A. Bulletin*. In September 1952, it was renamed *The Group Secretary*, sub-headed "News and Notes for the Entire Membership from General Service Headquarters of A.A." In 1955, the name was changed to *General Service Bulletin*. In 1956, its new masthead said *The A.A. Exchange Bulletin*, and it was a four-page newsletter. The name *Box 4-5-9* was adopted in 1967.

In 1940, Bill wrote in the very first issue: "This bulletin is an effort to develop a mutual idea-exchange sheet to establish a closer feeling of friendship between A.A. groups from the East Coast to the West, and we hope it will prevent the secession from the A.A. ranks of our San Francisco group who threatened to call themselves 'Dipsomaniacs Incognito' unless they heard from us more frequently. A bulletin has been contemplated for some time, but delayed due to lack of sufficient personnel and office facilities. We now at least have the equipment and hope to be able to make this bulletin a periodical spree (not alcoholic!)."

Almost 40,000 people now receive *Box 4-5-9* every two months. We wonder how many people actually read it. Among those, how many share it with their group or other A.A. friends? Certain A.A. information in *Box 4-5-9* is not really available to members in any other way. For instance:

- 1 The Conference issue is the most complete report of General Service Conference activities that most groups and members ever see.
- 2 The availability of all new A.A. publications is first announced in *Box 4-5-9*.
- 3 Announcement of upcoming trustee elections is first made in *Box 4-5-9*.
- 4 Many individual, group, area, and even international A.A. problems and solutions are shared from the G.S.O. mail.

All of the foregoing concern the Fellowship as a whole. But how many groups use *Box 4-5-9* for meeting topics? How many



G.S.R.'s report to the group on articles in *Box 4-5-9*? How can groups and members become better acquainted with A.A.'s primary communication tool?

Cora Louise Belford, G.S.O. staff

Experiment tried with *Box 4-5-9*

Chiefly because of a two-week delay at the post office, questionnaires for our *Box 4-5-9* experiment were late getting out, and final results are not available. But clear indications of a trend are appearing.

As *Box 4-5-9* is our Fellowship's primary communication tool, it is desirable to obtain the widest possible readership of each issue. Too often, however, the copy mailed to the group G.S.R. goes no farther. Not infrequently, the group officers and the other members are not in touch with *Box 4-5-9* on any regular basis. And since, in these groups, the *next* G.S.R. has never seen a copy in circulation, he or she doesn't think to bring it to the meeting to pass along.

Trying to break this cycle, we have had available both individual and bulk subscriptions. However, subscribers constitute but a small fraction of our total membership: only 1,000 single and 612 bulk subscriptions (that is, ten or more copies).

To reach more members, this idea was developed: We offered 300 selected groups, on a test basis, ten copies each of two consecutive issues of *Box 4-5-9*. A letter accompanied each mailing. The first suggested these copies be taken to the meeting and distributed by hand to group members.

The second mailing carried a questionnaire designed to gauge overall reaction, to seek information on methods of distribution (whether the issues received were given out by hand or left on the literature table), to determine the extent of any pass-along readership, and to invite suggestions for future *Box 4-5-9* articles.

Test groups were selected on a "first 100 groups" basis in California, Eastern Ontario, and Kansas, providing the full range of A.A. group types—urban/rural, new/established, open/closed, large/small.

Judging from the small sample return (about 30 completed questionnaires, or 10%), the groups answering want these mailings to continue and find them useful. There have been no negative responses so far. Only groups returning the questionnaire will be sent further bulk copies. We assume those not returning it either do not want bulk copies or never received the samples.

We could offer *Box 4-5-9* in bulk to all A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada starting in 1978, if that is the pleasure of the Conference. Two consecutive issues would be mailed in bulk as a sample, the second carrying the questionnaire and a return envelope. This would assure that only the groups desiring additional copies would receive them, and would keep waste circulation to a minimum. Regularly, perhaps yearly, we would offer nonrespondents another opportunity to receive the bulk mailings.

Frank Mauser, administrative assistant, G.S.O.



Should non-A.A. literature be sold by A.A. groups?

An area survey produces a surprise

While having read several non-A.A. books and many non-A.A. articles and pamphlets, I had always relied on Conference-approved literature as a source of information, guidance, and inspiration. Copies of communications from several members against the sale of non-A.A. material by groups were sent to me. Fine, I thought; we are all of the same opinion. And I began to assemble some thoughts based on the Fifth and Sixth Traditions.

Tradition Five: "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." Surely, I reasoned, "its message" could be found only in Conference-approved literature, and we had no business showing favoritism to anyone else's program. Next thing, the Gideons would want space on our shelves.

Tradition Six: "An A.A. group ought never endorse, finance or lend the A.A. name to any related facility or outside enterprise, lest problems of money, . . ." etc. Most certainly, a book order sent to Hazelden accompanied by a money order from group funds constituted an endorsement of an outside facility. We were probably in trouble with the "finance" part of this Tradition as well.

While I was searching the rest of the Traditions for more ammunition for my cause, my conscience was tweaked a bit by a phrase that said something about "trusted servants" and "group conscience." So I dashed off letters to the eight D.C.M.'s in my area. I asked for their experience and opinions. With this input from my area, the actual picture looks like this:

- 1 Groups have not experienced any trouble caused by selling non-A.A. literature.
- 2 A number of members regularly use non-A.A. literature and appreciate being able to buy it within the group.
- 3 This material is not supplied free of charge at group expense in most cases. Group funds simply enable members to obtain it conveniently, as happens with coffee, pop, doughnuts, etc.
- 4 The decision by groups to sell this literature was obtained by group conscience—and groups are "autonomous except in matters affecting other groups or A.A. as a whole."

Confronted with this actual experience, I looked again at the

Traditions. First, Tradition Five reminds us that our primary purpose is to carry our message to alcoholics. Our message is carried in many ways: by Conference-approved literature; by example, which is attraction; and by relating our experience, strength, and hope to one another, both at meetings and on Twelfth Step calls. Many speakers at meetings, including me, begin by saying that their remarks are their own opinions and not necessarily the opinions of A.A. Assuming that most non-A.A. literature on sale at meetings is written by A.A. members, what is the difference between providing members with this literature and providing a special speaker on occasion, or recommending any speaker as one having a good message?

The Sixth Tradition, when cautioning a group against endorsing or financing an outside enterprise, goes on to explain why: because the group will get hung up with problems of money, property, and prestige and get sidetracked from its primary purpose. If the purchase and selling of non-A.A. literature by a group mean endorsing an outside enterprise, then we endorse many outside enterprises—Chase and Sanborn, Coca-Cola, and Pepsi, to name a few. Second, the sale of this literature has caused no apparent problems of money, property, and prestige in New Brunswick and Prince Edward Island.

In our area, A.A. Conference-approved literature is to be found in every group. However, non-A.A. literature, in particular the “24-Hour Book,” can also be found in nearly all A.A. rooms as well. The groups feel they are helping their members by making this material available. It is definitely not regarded as a Tradition break.

Many members in my area think the “24-Hour Book” is an A.A. publication. When told the difference, they are not really impressed. They are interested in sobriety and in spiritual improvement, and they apparently find what they need in this book. They recommend it to newcomers. Many groups use it in their meetings.

Not all districts were in favor. Some, like me, feel concern that no special emphasis is being given to our own literature. Some are concerned because non-A.A. material is having a strong influence on our meetings.

It is perhaps late to suggest that we do not approve of groups’ selling this material. This would be interpreted as disapproval of the material, not of the practice of selling it. Our policy has been that the absence of Conference approval does not necessarily denote disapproval. To my knowledge, we have never officially disapproved of any literature. I think it would be a backward step to start now.

Should non-A.A. literature be sold by A.A. groups? If the demand for this material is widespread and if the Fellowship has not yet provided literature that fulfills this need, our suggestion is “yes.”

Ken Dunphy (New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island)

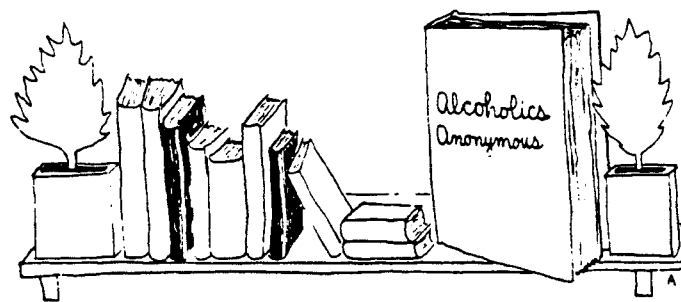
Give newcomers confidence — not confusion

Have you visited a doctor, a dentist, a lawyer, or a tax consultant lately? What did you find to pass the time in the waiting room? If you visited a doctor, more than likely some type of

medical journal. If it was a lawyer, probably copies of *The Barrister*.

Professionals display literature about their profession for a couple of reasons. First, they subscribe to these magazines to keep abreast of the latest trends in their profession. Second, this practice builds your confidence in them without your even thinking about it. If you had to choose between two lawyers, and one had the *National Geographic* in his waiting room, and the other had *The Barrister*, which would you pick to represent you? With everything else being equal, you would pick the one that displayed *The Barrister*. One may seem well-read, but you would want the one interested in the law.

Don’t these same considerations hold true when it comes to what literature A.A. groups have at their meetings? There is a tremendous amount of literature about alcoholism. I find it useful in many different ways; but when I am working with a new prospect, the only literature I give him is Conference-approved. When a newcomer finds only A.A. literature at a



meeting, he is going to think these people have got it all together. They know exactly what they are talking about and have answers written down for him. Without thinking about it, he finds his confidence in A.A. going up, and he is much more likely to come back.

But when a newcomer finds many other types of literature, he wonders what is lacking in A.A. that they need this other stuff. You and I know that many books can be useful tools for sobriety, but the newcomer’s thought is that we need this other stuff because our own program isn’t strong enough by itself. How is he supposed to have confidence in us if we don’t have that much in ourselves?

The newcomer is likely to see at a glance what many groups may have lost sight of: By selling non-A.A. books, we are actually endorsing the other program that published them. Which message is the A.A. message?

When I drop money in the collection basket, I intend it to be used to support A.A. But if a group uses that donation to buy non-A.A. literature, then some Loner or some inmate or some serviceman may not get the support that G.S.O. could have provided, and some drunk may not get the A.A. message.

I don’t mean to say that non-A.A. literature isn’t any good or that as individuals we should not buy and read it. But let’s not mix our individual preference in literature with what A.A. offers in our meeting places. If an individual wants a particular book, he can buy it *as an individual*. Let’s make sure that *as*

A.A. groups we stick to sharing our A.A. experience, strength, and hope with each other by buying only A.A. literature for our meeting places.

Percy Rogers (Kentucky)

Floor Action related to this topic: 9 (p. 43)

How the A.A. group conscience operates

Minorities must be heard

To arrive at a decision satisfactory to everyone is sometimes difficult and time-consuming. I do not believe A.A. has any emergencies that require rushing decisions. If there is a dissatisfied minority, the matter should be deferred for more thought and discussion. Rigid adherence to Roberts' Rules of Order can sometimes frustrate the group conscience. Complicated motions amended two or three times, and voted on before everyone understands the issue, can destroy the true expression of group conscience.

All available information on a given subject should be presented to the group, so everyone understands. Every person should then be given the opportunity to express an opinion. When this has been done, a true expression of group conscience may be arrived at, though not always.

Sometimes, people presenting information are gifted speakers who can sway the majority and create a happy but misinformed majority. Therefore, the voice of the minority must always be listened to. This can be illustrated by what happened at an Alberta assembly. A person presented information on a subject affecting all A.A. in Alberta. His presentation was good, well explained, and to the point. After two or three questions from the floor, an eager beaver made a motion and received a second, and the chairman asked for a show of hands of those in favor. It appeared that all hands went up. The chairman then asked if anyone was opposed. One woman raised her hand and spoke up. She said she would be opposed to the motion until she had an answer to one question that was bothering her. When she asked the question, everyone in the room realized the importance of the answer.

The person making the presentation could not answer the question. He would get the answer in his home city, he said, and forward it to the secretary to be added to the minutes; he thought, though, the answer would not affect the motion and it should be carried. But the person who made the motion asked if he could withdraw it. After much discussion, it was tabled until the next assembly, six months hence. At the next meeting, the answer to the question was given; the motion was reworded to accommodate the answer; and then it was carried by the whole group.

If all the facts have been presented and enough time has been allowed for open-minded discussion and thought, any group can reach the right decision on any given issue. But a decision is of little value unless it is implemented. The group, through its collective conscience, maps the road in the direction it wants to go. They give the map to their trusted servants, then trust the servants to do the driving. Without this trust, little or nothing could be accomplished. Each trusted servant should be

granted authority to act in direct relation with responsibility.

If the ultimate wisdom of the group conscience is the guidance we follow, A.A. will continue to grow and carry its message for so long as God may need us.

Gordon Matkin (Alberta)

Chairing service meetings is a delicate job

People think of parliamentary procedure as a tool for manipulating meetings to approve *their* ideas, rather than as a method of reaching a group conscience. The two basic principles of parliamentary law most commonly ignored are:

- 1 Parliamentary rules exist to facilitate the transaction of business and to promote harmony.
- 2 Full discussion of every proposition presented is an established right.

The chairman is to endeavor to keep the *principles* of parliamentary procedure at work, as well as the *mechanics*. He should keep the meeting moving as quickly and smoothly as possible, *and* be ever alert to members' rights.

But to effectively guarantee one principle, it may be necessary to restrict the other. If the chairman tries to move the meeting too quickly, he may restrict the speaking rights of members. Yet if he gives every member full speaking rights, the meeting becomes so long that nothing is accomplished.

The chairman's job is easier if he has the full confidence of the members. It is given only when everyone believes he is impartial. Members need to feel sure he seeks only the group conscience. A good chairman has no opinion. He is a servant. The chairman must also give the assembly what information he possesses, to insure an educated vote.

He should discourage complicated parliamentary procedures, if necessary, and point out the easier, simpler way. Confusion as to what motion is on the floor is a major problem at many meetings. The chairman should keep members informed as to the motion on the floor and its status at the moment.

The group conscience can never be reached in an atmosphere of anger or bickering. Calm and reasonable presentation of ideas is imperative. The chairman can be a good example of calm and reasoned demeanor; he can keep a firm hold on the meeting, not tolerating angry or abusive behavior. It is a basic responsibility of an A.A. chairman to be absolutely sure the minority opinion is expressed, no matter how unpopular that opinion may be.

A chairman may utilize a few phrases to keep a meeting moving smoothly. One is "If there is no objection, we will . . ." When it is apparent there is *real* unanimity among members, the phrase "If there is no objection" is a call for a unanimous vote. If there is an objection, the chairman may proceed with the discussion. Another phrase is "If there is no further discussion, we will . . ." Repeated two or three times, this is a reminder that time is passing and a vote could be taken. It is not always necessary to have a motion to vote. If it becomes obvious that discussion is fin-

ished, the chairman may call for the vote.

Perhaps the most important job is to be sure motions are stated clearly. If a member cannot phrase a motion clearly, the chair has the *obligation* to rephrase it. He then should ask the member to concur with the phrasing.

A group conscience can come only from individuals expressing opinions in an atmosphere of loving but structured sharing. It is the responsibility of the chair to encourage that attitude.

Cliff Roche (San Diego, California)

The A.A. group

The local group is sovereign

"Traditionally, two or more alcoholics meeting together for purposes of sobriety may consider themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they are self-supporting and have no outside affiliation."

After agreeing that the above statement (from our A.A. directories) pretty well defines an A.A. group, Conference members shared experience on about a dozen questions concerning hometown or neighborhood A.A. groups. No formal report-back was made, but here's a summary of material compiled by workshop reporters.

All agreed that nonalcoholics are welcome at open A.A. meetings, that showing of non-A.A. films at meetings is not advisable, and that guest (non-A.A.) speakers are rarely appropriate, except Al-Anon members at special functions.

The proliferation of new groups was generally approved. It was

attributed to C.P.C. and P.I. work, plus increasing acceptance of alcoholism as a disease.

Repeatedly, it was emphasized that each A.A. group is autonomous; nevertheless, groups have certain challenges (and solutions) in common. All agreed groups work better when members hold office in only one group, attend meetings regularly,



do Twelfth Step work, place group welfare above selfish personal interest, participate in service work, and feel financially responsible toward the group.

Disruptive (drunk or sober) persons may be firmly but compassionately removed from a meeting (this does not cancel their membership in A.A., of course). The consensus was that a new member sobered up at a treatment center should be treated exactly like any other newcomer, without arguments.

People with problems besides alcohol can be urged by their sponsors to discuss primarily their drinking problem at A.A. meetings. Usually, group officers who have slips or otherwise abuse mood-changing drugs are replaced.

Only local conditions can determine which works better: one group with several weekly meetings or many separate groups that meet once a week.

Queries Call for Sharing of Information and Ideas

Responding to unsigned questions placed in the Ask-It Basket, Conference members shared their experience in two Thursday sessions chaired by regional trustee Stan Wilsey (Pacific U.S.). Questions that could not be covered within the time allotted were considered later by G.S.O. staff members.

A.A. directories

Q. Would it be possible to once again have one directory for the U.S. and Canada?

A. A recent study showed the cost of consolidating the three directories and distributing them to all groups would triple the budget. For this reason, we are not planning any change at this time.

Q. Wouldn't it be feasible to remove names and addresses in our directories and give only numbers of a central phone or an

individual's? This may discourage or even stop the junk mail.

A. The best way to discourage junk mail is to write to the company, telling them why you do *not* appreciate the mailing and do *not* buy the product.

Q. Would you reaffirm our position on listing of gay groups?

A. The 1974 Conference reaffirmed that all A.A. groups should be listed in the A.A. directories.

Q. My area is international (partly in Canada) and interstate (partly in Idaho). Most of the area is the state of Washington. I have received complaints from some in our Idaho and Canada groups that their G.S.O. contributions are not properly recorded in our area. G.S.O. says only states or provinces are used in compiling these statistics. Should we change this and organize along area lines? We also had difficulty with the directory printout sheets.

A. G.S.O. is well aware of the problem and hopes eventually to solve it with the help of the new computer.

Discussion topic on directories: pp. 18-19

Floor Action: 6, p. 43

Central offices

Q. Should a central office be located in a club?

A. It is suggested that in order to keep club operations and group activities separated, a central office not be located in a club (see Central Office Guidelines).

Conferences and conventions

Q. While conventions, conferences, roundups, etc. are non-profit, there often is a profit. Why shouldn't part of the profit go to a central or intergroup office as well as to G.S.O. and/or local general service committees?

A. This is a matter for the convention committee to decide.

Q. Should A.A. as a whole (G.S.O., area, intergroup) accept contributions and Grapevine listings for roundups that aren't held in accordance with the Preamble, Steps, Traditions, and spirit of A.A.? Some are run by self-appointed, self-perpetuating committees responsible to no A.A. entity, taking to themselves rule-making authority (requirements for attendance, etc.).

A. G.S.O. and the Grapevine list these roundups merely for information and are not in a position to research each one.

Finances

Q. How much royalty is paid on each of Bill's books, on "Living Sober," and on "Came to Believe"?

A. "Living Sober" and "Came to Believe" were not written by Bill, and thus no royalties are paid. The royalties paid on the books written by Bill are reported on the G.S.O. income statement (see p. 47).

Q. In layman's terms, please explain what will happen with the money that is being acquired over and above a prudent reserve.

A. It was suggested the money be used for the development of Conference-approved audiovisual aids.

Advisory Actions on finance: p. 44

General Service Board

Q. As A.A.'s, we are not supposed to vote in a bloc. But the U.S. trustee vote did seem to go that way. How, then, can a small A.A. population in a state ever elect a trustee?

A. On the first ballot, each delegate usually votes for the candidate from his own area. After that, it is always hoped that those voting will vote for the person best qualified to serve as trustee, regardless of where he comes from.

General Service Conference

Q. Would it be convenient or perhaps beneficial to everyone to

hold the Conference outside the metropolitan area?

A. This has been looked into in the past, and it is not practical. There are great advantages to being close to G.S.O. in case anything is needed. Also, transportation for the G.S.O. staff and in-town trustees would be an extra expense.

Q. Is there a possibility that portions of the Conference could ever be used in a future film about A.A. (backs of heads, of course)?

A. In the new filmstrip "Circles of Love and Service" (see inside back cover), there is a section that depicts meetings at a Conference.

Q. In 1971 and 1972 Advisory Actions, the Report and Charter Committee recommended that the Literature Committee consider printing Ask-It Basket questions and answers and/or Advisory Actions in the form of a handbook as a salable item to groups and members. Will this be done?

A. Summaries of both are available on request from G.S.O. The Ask-It Basket questions and answers are simply A.A. sharing, and answers at one Conference can contradict those at another.

Q. When an Ask-It Basket question gets an answer as the result of a motion, moved and seconded, is it then a Conference Action?

A. Answers to Ask-It Basket questions are not Advisory Actions unless a Conference member presents one in the form of a motion. It is suggested, however, that Advisory Actions come from committee recommendations or Floor Actions, as the Ask-It Basket is an informal session for sharing.

Q. The statement "No Conference Action is binding on succeeding Conferences" has been made vocally many times. Is it written in any book or pamphlet? If not, should there be some kind of Conference action taken to attest to its validity?

A. In 1962, the question "Does one Conference have a right to make suggestions to its successor Conference?" came up, and the answer was yes. However, traditionally, recommendations of one Conference are not binding on succeeding Conferences.

General Service Office

Q. Don't you think employing A.A. members who understand more about groups in the Records Department would help to resolve group problems in record-keeping?

A. The problems in Records are independent of that issue. Some of it is just bad data, with no relationship to whether or not employees are recovering alcoholics or A.A. members.

Q. What can we do individually to help Records in maintaining correct and up-to-date group and G.S.R. listings?

A. Return the original printouts with the correct information.

Q. Why doesn't G.S.O. prepare a form that could be filled out when new G.S.R.'s, committee members, etc. are elected?

A. This is being done.

Q. We have trouble getting films from G.S.O. We must wait too long! Can we buy the film for a particular state and then distribute the film ourselves to districts or groups?

A. No. The film is copyrighted and cannot be sold. It is possible for areas to lease films on a long-term basis.

Grapevine

Q. There are two regional trustees on the A.A.W.S. board. Why are there none on the Grapevine Corporate Board?

A. Having two regional trustees on the A.A.W.S. board is for regional representation and is relatively new. Since the Grapevine is written by people from all around the world, it already has such representation. However, the Grapevine board might eventually consider this.

Group Affairs

Q. Some groups in our area meet in savings and loan buildings—which cannot by law accept any rent or service from the group. Would this violate Tradition Seven?

A. When it is impossible to pay rent or make a contribution, perhaps some piece of equipment could be donated (fan, furniture, etc.).

Q. In closed meetings, there sometimes are people who have drug problems other than alcohol, by their own admission, and no problem with alcohol—yet they do disrupt meetings. How do we handle this with diplomacy?

A. Explain to them that closed meetings are for alcoholics only. Open meetings are available to these people. They should not be alienated.

Q. What can we do as responsible A.A. members in stopping the increase in vulgar and profane language used at open speaker meetings?

A. Some groups have signs on the podium that say, "This group does not approve of obscenity. Please refrain from using it."

Q. "The A.A. Group" lists an "open discussion" type of meeting, stating, "Anyone may participate." I would suggest this type clearly identify its purpose so all attending are aware of its function. Are there many of these meetings?

A. Many A.A. groups have open discussion meetings, and it would be the responsibility of the group to announce what kind of a meeting is to be held.

Q. Does holding raffles for money at open meetings violate Tradition Seven by accepting money from outsiders?

A. Yes, but what can we do about it except discourage it in every way we can? It was the sense of the meeting that such raffles are not a good idea.

Q. How do we handle a group that is formed to operate socials and spectacular events like alkathons? Money is collected under the A.A. name, yet there is no accounting of these funds.

A. It would depend on whether these alkathons are being sponsored by local groups and members. If they are run by A.A.'s for A.A.'s, there would not seem to be anything wrong with them.

Q. Can either an open meeting or a closed discussion meeting be restricted to either female or male?

A. There are many stag and women's groups, but traditionally any alcoholic is welcome at any A.A. meeting.

Q. Are there any suggested ways to deal with members of A.A. who insist they are not a *group*, but are merely holding a *meet-*

ing, and hence have no financial responsibility as a group?
A. All contributions from A.A. groups and members are voluntary.

Q. When a member appointed to a service job does not comply with his responsibilities, what should be done?

A. The group could find out whether or not the A.A. understood his responsibilities and is willing to fulfill them. If not, someone else should be given the opportunity.

Q. Is it good practice for A.A., Al-Anon, and Alateen to meet in the same building on A.A. closed meeting nights, mingling before and after their respective meetings?

A. This is a common practice in many parts of the country and is not contrary to A.A. tradition.

Q. Many A.A. groups are being asked by churches to pay sizable increases in rent, predicated on increased fuel and lighting costs. With the rapid growth of A.A., meeting facilities are becoming scarce. If a group cannot move, it must cut back on other commitments, such as contributions to general service and intergroups and expenditures on literature. How do groups cope with this situation?

A. Costs are going up in many areas. It is the members' responsibility to increase their contributions, so the group can meet its commitments as the cost of living rises.

Q. A group handed out three donations of \$50 each to three unemployed members at Christmastime. Is this wrong?

A. Please see "44 Questions," p. 31.

Q. Our group has been asked to help in the services of the church we meet at (i.e., paint floors, mow lawn, and other maintenance work). Is this getting too involved?

A. If the church does not accept a group contribution, the group might "pay the rent" by providing these services. This would be on a voluntary basis.

Q. If an A.A. member who is not an elected trusted servant volunteers to serve as chairman of an area committee (i.e., convention, meeting list, public information, etc.), does this member have a vote in the area assembly?

A. It is a matter of local autonomy.

Q. Should alternate G.S.R.'s and alternate D.C.M.'s attend all meetings or only when the G.S.R. or D.C.M. is missing?

A. It is up to local autonomy.

Presentation on alternates: p. 10

Institutions

Q. What does the Conference think about giving or selling area directories (local meeting lists) to treatment centers for A.A. contacts upon discharge?

A. It was the sense of the meeting that decisions about this be made locally. It was suggested that if the directories do not contain names, but only group addresses and meeting times, there would be no problem with anonymity.

Q. What are the Conference feelings on state or provincial general service committees' purchasing (from group contributions), and making available to A.A. and non-A.A. people in institutions work, non-A.A. films and tapes?

A. It was the sense of the meeting that A.A. funds should not be used to purchase outside films for institutional or other use.

Literature

Q. Why were the words "Recovery, Unity, and Service" removed from the triangle-and-circle symbol on the literature?

A. It was an action of the 1956 Conference that the words "General Service Conference" were to be used in the symbol on all Conference-approved literature.

Advisory Action related to the above question: 33, p. 45

Q. Could we republish the quotation from Bill W. concerning the difference, or lack of difference, between "defects" and "shortcomings" in the Steps?

A. Some years ago, we received many letters asking the difference between these terms. Bill said he did not want to use the same word twice.

Q. Would it be feasible to print the first 11 chapters of the Big Book in a small size to be easily carried in purse or pocket? Could be useful for Big Book study groups.

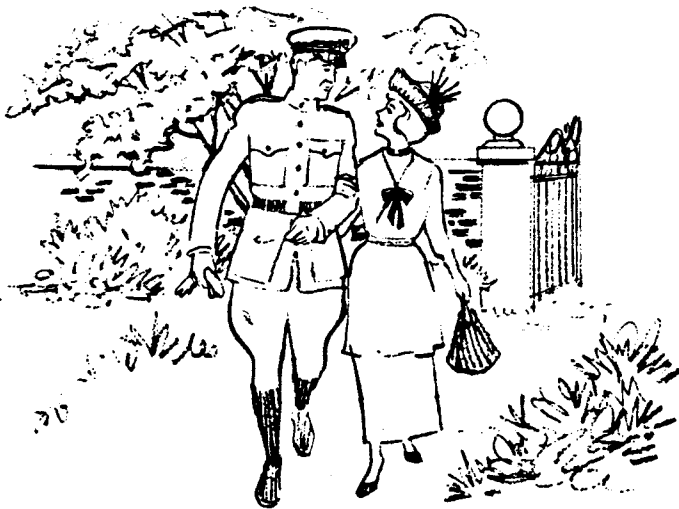
A. It was the sense of the meeting that such a publication is not desirable at this time.

Q. Could "A.A. Comes of Age" be reproduced in a smaller paperback edition, either in addition to or taking the place of the hardback edition? My area would be interested in this paperback. They feel it would have wider circulation; more G.S.R.'s would be apt to buy it and carry it with them.

A. It was the sense of the meeting that the Conference was not in favor of this suggestion at this time.

Q. Is consideration being given to a concordance for the Big Book and "Twelve and Twelve"?

A. There is not sufficient demand for it at present.



Q. Will Lois W.'s autobiography be distributed by G.S.O.?

A. If such a book is written, it will be distributed by Al-Anon.

Q. Do we need more movies that will help A.A. members grow in the program? Why don't we have more visual aids?

A. The trustees' Literature Committee has appointed a subcommittee to look into the possibility of this sort of material.

Q. We have the problem of A.A. members' wanting the "24-Hour Book" read aloud at closed meetings. If a suggested format for a meeting was made part of the "A.A. Group" pamphlet, this might help alleviate our problem. Could this be done?

A. Suggested formats for A.A. meetings can be found on p. 21 of "The A.A. Group."

Q. Could G.S.O. publish a guideline to the Fourth Step in pamphlet form? Some outside agencies are doing this.

A. This has been reviewed by the Literature Committee over the last four years, and it was found that there was not sufficient need.

Q. Could the suggested 60-30-10 plan for disbursement of group funds (in excess of their own needs) be included on p. 13 of "The A.A. Group" next time it is printed? It would be a good place to include individual contribution plans, too.

A. This will be done. Thank you for the suggestion.

Q. Can't we get a discount on the "Bill W." book if we make it Conference-approved and distribute it with our other books?

A. It would be theoretically possible. However, Conference approval might be difficult to obtain, since "Bill W." is published for profit by a commercial publishing house and also since the author receives a royalty. This year, the Conference authorized A.A.W.S. (Advisory Action 37, p. 45) to proceed with a joint biography of Bill and Dr. Bob, which would be more A.A.-oriented than "Bill W." and would be published by A.A. for A.A.

Q. Why does G.S.O. supply other agencies and publishing companies with our literature for resale at a profit?

A. As a publishing company, we are obligated to sell our literature to anyone who wishes to purchase it, and we cannot tell them how much to charge for it.

Q. Does the large amount of literature sold to outside agencies conflict with our tradition of being self-supporting?

A. Sales to everyone outside of A.A. combined are less than 5% of our total sales.

Public Information

Q. Did an "official representative" of A.A.—from G.S.O.—repudiate the Rand report? It has been claimed that a radio report quoted Dr. Jack Norris as the official voice of A.A. on this subject.

A. G.S.O. and A.A. as a whole took the position that any repudiation would mean dragging A.A.'s name into public controversy, and so issued none, leaving that to other agencies. Before newspapers made this a public controversy, reporters called a number of people for comments, including Dr. Jack. He attempted to answer in a noncontroversial manner: "The experience of thousands of people in A.A. . . ." The manner in which he was interpreted by reporters made him sound as if he was repudiating the report. Dr. Jack received a number of phone calls and said that he was speaking as a physician only.

Reports on Area Service Highlights

Highlights

Alabama/Northwestern Florida: We recently elected a new institutions chairman with a knack for getting members to follow the Guidelines. Also, we are getting our C.P.C. committee under way. More of our groups are utilizing the experience in the pamphlet "The A.A. Group." I am concerned, though, because many members, after being around awhile, don't feel the need to participate. The mental obsession returns, and they have no effective mental defense against drinking, so they are prone to increase the already excessive turnover in many groups. We might rid ourselves of selfishness by engaging in self-sacrifice and constructive action. —*Warren Kelly*

Arkansas: Two years' experience reflects a tremendous increase in service awareness among the groups, as well as individual A.A.'s. In October, we held our first two-day assembly. Each assembly has a theme, with sharing sessions and small group workshops. We now have to conduct our assemblies in a hotel with facilities to accommodate 100 G.S.R.'s and their spouses. We have never had a written service structure in Arkansas — a top priority this year. Slowly but surely, service work is becoming more effective and more attractive to A.A.'s in Arkansas. —*Allan Phillips*

British Columbia/Yukon: Over 750,000 square miles pose a problem for personal contact, but by use of the alternate and many weekends away from home, we cover as many districts as possible. We hold three committee meetings annually and an area assembly—not as well attended as they could be, but there has been marked improvement. We have started district mini-assemblies, service workshops, and a C.P.C. committee. Membership has increased much faster than I think was anticipated, so we are redistricting. We had to add many new D.C.M.'s. We have approximately 362 groups and 39 D.C.M.'s. —*Tom Sinclair*

California (Northern Coastal): Fourteen of our 17 districts hold regular monthly meetings (average attendance 20); our area committee meets monthly (average, 50). Officers now visit all district meetings on a rotating basis, so over 300 G.S.R.'s and D.C.M.'s meet regularly, providing year-round Conference activity. In addition, many districts now hold "service days," with panel discussions and workshops. We hold three assemblies yearly. We have an enthusiastic P.I./C.P.C. committee, and 14 district P.I./C.P.C. committees. District P.I. committees generally are jointly sponsored by local intergroups and district G.S. committees, greatly enhancing unity between these two service bodies. —*Dean Kirkham*

California (Southern): Within our area lie seven central offices and five institutions committees. We have initiated a Southern California A.A. archives, financed by proceeds from our annual oldtimers night. A two-day G.S.R. workshop is held in conjunction with the March assembly to discuss Conference agenda items. Court programs send new members; sometimes meeting rooms are too small. Educating groups on service structure is one of our more important tasks. Groups without G.S.R.'s are groups with the most difficulty. Just one little link with the service structure makes the difference. —*Dick Sutherland*

Colorado: Getting people to speak with each other of their differences, instead of *about* each other—that's still a problem of people and principles. This area has great strength and growth in two areas: public information and hospitals and institutions. The H & I chairman has channeled H & I responsibilities through D.C.M.'s to persons appointed to service groups and individual members. Currently, they are structuring an "after-

care temporary sponsor" program. Our P.I. chairman has been tireless, making himself available for area meetings to explain public information at community and district levels. —*Reed Edgar*

Connecticut: We had 86 new groups listed in 1976, and current activity shows that most have G.S.R.'s. Informed A.A.'s are active A.A.'s, and informed groups are active. Our annual roundup is instrumental in getting A.A.'s aware of activities beyond the home group. Our C.P.C. people are holding seminars in our eight districts. Our institutions and public information committees are very active. We have growing pains, but when we bring our thinking back where it belongs (our primary purpose), the road smooths out. —*Bob Gilman*

District of Columbia: We are experiencing growing pains, due to new groups and increasing community interest. Our assembly voted to give financial assistance to assembly members and others who attended the Northeast Regional Forum in March. It was hoped members from less affluent groups would be able to attend along with the affluent. We hope our assembly will remain imperfect, so it can continue to improve in spiritual value. —*Garrett Taylor*

Florida (Northern): Our groups have more than doubled over the past few years. We have grown from seven to 15 districts. We have an active P.I. committee and an institutions committee devoted to getting literature and Step meetings into our prisons and road camps. We hold four assemblies each year. Interest in gratitude meetings has grown. They help teach new people what gratitude means and what A.A. is all about. Since we send the collections to G.S.O., newcomers become more aware of our Tradition of self-support and of the services G.S.O. provides. —*Barbara Scharla-Nielsen*

Florida (Southern): We continue to grow; a committee member is added for each eight groups. We hold quarterly area meetings, with a workshop (on Traditions or on some aspect of service from "The A.A. Service Manual") preceding the business meeting. These meetings rotate throughout the area, with the host district autonomous in planning other weekend activities. Traditions and the manual are used by D.C.M.'s for brief presentations to newer G.S.R.'s. In groups, many closed discussion meetings are based on Traditions all year round. —*Harriet Rawls*

Hawaii: In the last year, we have begun to mature, and A.A. service is now a going function here. Districts were established along with our area committee in 1975. Our first Hawaii assembly was in January, and we held three more during the year. Our districts are functioning, with four on Oahu and one on Maui. We have area H & I and P.I. committees with cooperating district committees. After much agonizing, we divided our Intergroup, Clubs, and Area Committee, and all three now live in harmony. Aloha, and come to see us. —*Vic Blair*

Illinois (Chicago): Biggest thing going right now is the increasing interest in Step study groups. Many groups are using the Big Book and discussing the Traditions and service structure. There has been a big trend upward in detox and treatment centers, with a definite increase in A.A. involvement, including meetings and volunteer programs. We will host our first regional forum in May. Our state conference is moving north this year, and it is hoped this will create larger participation. I have noticed in my travels that rural areas are much more attracted

to conferences than are metropolitan. —*Tom Dougherty*

Illinois (Southern): In the past five years, our membership has increased considerably. When older G.S.R.'s tell of potluck dinners, anniversary cakes, chips, and conferences, enthusiasm is passed on and picked up by newer ones. For the first time, we sponsored a New Year alkaathon, which went over very well. In the past six months, most of our groups have been taking the time to read, not only our Steps, but also our Traditions. —*Dean Young*

Indiana (Northern): When my Higher Power led me to this program a few 24 hours ago, I felt as inadequate as I do now. In my district, we have grown from ten to 69 weekly meetings. When I came in, we didn't have anyone going to assembly meetings. Elected G.S.R., I started attending, and it widened my view of A.A. I began to understand why we must maintain unity if our Fellowship is to continue. We now have an information service, in its second year, after many trials and errors. —*Lew Wilder*

Iowa: I need service activity to enhance my sobriety. We have approximately 3,600 members and 186 groups. In 1976, 20 new groups started. The area is experiencing growing pains, and there is much concern over keeping A.A. unity. Participation and communication at the state level are very good. We are updating the Iowa directory. We feel a need for better sponsorship and more recognition of how vital the Traditions are. We need participation by outgoing delegates, committee members, and G.S.R.'s, so the cycle of learning will continue and more members will become interested in world services. —*Don Hart*

Louisiana: Recently, the number of groups active in our quarterly workshops and assembly meetings has more than tripled. We hold committee meetings before each workshop. Communications have improved, since we now publish a monthly newsletter. We encourage all A.A.'s to attend our service conference, especially new members. Al-Anon holds workshops separately but simultaneously with ours, resulting in greater attendance of both A.A.'s and Al-Anons. All A.A. members in our area will participate in being your hosts for the 1980 International Convention. —*Robert Hawkes*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Our area committee is sponsoring a "Literature in Prisons" project. Boxes or cartons are placed at meetings, and old Grapevines and other A.A. publications are collected. The Institutions Committee distributes them among prisons and hospitals. We sponsored a gratitude dinner during November (Traditions month), with proceeds sent to help support G.S.O. Many districts sponsor roundups, usually starting at noon and lasting until 9:00 p.m. The Steps, Traditions, service, history of A.A., courts, women, sponsorship, industry, hospitals, institutions, and the Three Legacies are among the subjects covered. —*Paul Joachim*

Michigan (Central): When I was first elected G.S.R., my knowledge about our Third Legacy was very limited. Since then, I've been privileged to serve in many areas of the Fellowship—the most rewarding experience of my life. We've added more committee members to improve communications between D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s. Sponsorship is a major concern. With numerous referrals from outside agencies, we've had to expand ourselves in this area. Workshops and sharing sessions have been informative and are well attended. Future sessions are planned at the district level. —*LeRoy Iszler*

Michigan (Southeastern): A 1976 workshop in our area on general service work, with 100 people present, had the theme "Our Leaders Are But Trusted Servants." Each registrant was given a packet of literature and an "A.A. Service Manual." It was a shared learning experience on the Third Legacy. We had wide participation in discussion, and table leaders did a great job. Our area has several hundred groups. It includes metropolitan Detroit, suburban areas, and small cities. Many ethnic groups are represented. A main problem is communication. —*Jessie Parks*

Minnesota (Southern): After my first seven months of sobriety, the group appointed me G.S.R. I had to get "The A.A. Service Manual" to find out *what* I was. After four years, the district elected me D.C.M. There wasn't very much going on then in Southern Minnesota. In 1970, we got the district organized and started monthly meetings. Other districts followed suit, and we have come a long way in the past six years. We now have workshops, assemblies, conferences, and area meetings all year long, keeping people interested in service. —*Donald Heilman*

Missouri (Eastern): We have implemented a monthly service bulletin to stimulate interest and provide needed information. Our annual state roundup is a joint project of the Eastern and Western Missouri Areas. Every two years, we publish an area service directory, which has proved most helpful. This is confidential, not available outside the Fellowship. Districts hold periodic meetings of their G.S.R.'s, with increasing attendance. Our public information and institutions committees are active and growing. —*Albert Ashmanskas*

Missouri (Western): We have made good progress in functioning of districts and D.C.M.'s. We now have eight districts holding monthly G.S.R. meetings, open meetings, or round robins. We hold four assemblies per year. We established a Conference Committee of past delegates, resulting in better conferences and state conventions. Our Institutions Committee was divided in-



to north and south sections, resulting in more participation. We hold workshops for groups on carrying the message to institutions. —*Ray Anderson*

Nevada: In 1973, we decided to meet for our assembly annually in Tonopah, which we think of as "centrally isolated." There were no A.A.'s in Tonopah in 1973. But by 1975, a Loner had moved to Tonopah from southern Nevada, and Butch was the "host group" for our state meeting. In 1976, he introduced the other half of the Tonopah Group, a newcomer with six months. Later, at dinner, another customer asked what kind of group we were. He was an A.A., who had just come to Tonopah to work in the hospital! So Tonopah had three members. Now there are five, with a couple more looking the situation over. Is this a Highlight? For me, it is. It shows

what one member can do. Someone who is willing. —*Jim Dickens*

New Jersey (Northern): Our panel consists of 532 groups. We have set up a committee to reactivate our newsletter, to inform each group what is going on in all groups. Thanks to our court referral program, we have four new members sober over four months and doing very well. Last year, we held a luncheon to explain to members what we in service work are doing. G.S.O. sent a fine speaker, and many people who came now at least know there is a General Service Office and what it does. We will have our second luncheon some time in May. —*Albert Regeling Sr.*

New York (Central): Our monthly area meeting is attended by an average of 100 A.A.'s, most of whom are G.S.R.'s, representing 250 groups. The area has reduced its number of districts, but retained the same number of committee members, in an attempt to have one D.C.M. for each 20 groups. This has helped obtain closer service ties. An attempt has been made to set up a realistic budget, with expenses for the delegate included. Our present problems are: (1) concern over the effect of new alcoholism facilities on members of A.A.; (2) difficulties in convincing local intergroups they should work within the service structure. —*Bob Wall*

New York (Southeastern): I became interested in service when elected G.S.R. Prior to this, I was involved in group activities and found them very rewarding. As D.C.M., I became more active in area affairs, including local and state conventions. There was, and still is, a great need for more activities in the area. We hold five assemblies a year and 11 district committee meetings. We started holding mini-assemblies a few years ago, and these have become very popular. We are trying to get all districts involved in this activity, which will mean having more people involved. —*Jim Shannon*

North Carolina: We hold quarterly area committee meetings and semiannual assemblies, with G.S.R.'s representing approximately 70% of the groups. We started having presentations before workshops at the assemblies, using topics from the Conference agenda or suggestions from committee members. Participation and sharing have been outstanding. Our P.I. Committee distributed 241 copies of the Big Book and "A.A. Comes of Age" to libraries all over the state, and Grapevine subscriptions were donated to them. The project was made possible by group contributions. —*Harry Dorsett*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Labrador is not easily accessible, but in Nova Scotia we have monthly meetings of G.S.R.'s in five districts. Problems and opinions of each group are discussed. Meetings are held in different localities each month to equalize traveling. I try to get to as many of those as possible, but during the winter traveling can be hazardous. In Newfoundland, one district is doing fine, because of good work by committee officers. They hold regular monthly G.S.R. meetings, and I receive a copy of their minutes. We have institutions committees, intergroups, and answering services in some places. —*Mike Flemming*

Ohio (Central and Southeastern): Because of our past committee, our area is in good shape. A few years back, we lost an important link in the line of communications—the use of D.C.M.'s. Most groups have had a G.S.R., but the district system was lost. Our past committee started to reorganize the area, and our concern is to complete this important task, to return to

the unity we enjoyed when I first came into the Fellowship. We are working toward a panel system for D.C.M.'s. We are also stressing that a G.S.R. should be a person willing to serve. Communications will go to the G.S.R.'s through the D.C.M.'s. Our area will host the Third East Central Regional Conference, in July. —*Bob Hiebel*

Ohio (Northeastern): We held our first two-day mini-conference in December in Cleveland, with 184 registrations at \$3.00 each. Total cost was almost \$1,200. It was modeled after the annual Conference here, with the theme "Sharing, the Basis of A.A. Service." Presentations on "The A.A. Service Manual," the Concepts, and the Traditions were made, followed by workshops on each, and a question-and-answer period. In 1976, we went from 19 districts to 38. In Akron, they have four D.C.M.'s elected at a meeting for all four districts. The unity there is something to see, in the place where A.A. started. Members are there for a service job, not an ego trip. —*Fred Boyd*

Oklahoma: Our area committee has been strong and active. It sponsors and funds an H & I committee for all mental hospitals and receptive correctional institutions, and a P.I. committee working with all media and supplying qualified speakers for non-A.A. groups. The area committee gave to public and school libraries 250 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous." The Oklahoma School of Medicine asked for A.A. literature. This was provided, along with opportunity to attend open meetings. Every medical student desiring it is assigned an individual A.A. member to answer questions and accompany him or her to open meetings. Of 177 students, 80 requested this service. —*Elizabeth Erhard*

Ontario (Eastern): My area has ten districts, with approximately 300 groups and 6,000 members. Institutions and P.I. committees are doing well, with the help of grateful members. Cooperation with the professional in our area is outstanding. We have full support from our clergy, doctors, and industrial management. The non-A.A. professional plays a big role in



helping us carry the message. Contributions to general service are not adequate for the membership recorded here. I'm also concerned about attendance at group and district business meetings and assemblies. I pray my concerns will soon become my highlights. —*Rolly Provost*

Ontario (Northeastern): When my name was drawn from the hat after the fourth ballot, I felt closer to my Higher Power than at any other time. I got interested in service work through my sponsor. My area, 400 miles long and 300 miles wide, consists of 120 groups in six districts. I cover each dis-

trict once a year to give my report. Our conference is held on Thanksgiving weekend and moves among North Bay, Sudbury, and Sault Ste. Marie. The assembly meets twice per year, usually in February and September. The delegate and alternate meet twice a year with other Ontario delegates and alternates. —*Ken Dolliver*

Ontario (Northwestern): We have six districts. I am pleased that Conference material is being sent out in duplicate, as my alternate delegate lives 230 miles from me. Our annual service conference and assembly were a great success. Some G.S.R.'s had their mileage and rooms paid by their groups—a first in our area. One district now has alternate G.S.R.'s and alternate committee members, with voting privileges. This seems to get more people active in service. Assembly meeting minutes are exchanged among areas, so we all know what the whole province is doing. —*Marv Brisson*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): We are concerned with dispelling the notion that the area committee is a secret society. We are anxious for groups to understand that we are merely members of A.A. engaged in specific jobs, with identifying titles applying only to the nature of the job at hand. A new local meeting addresses itself "to those recovering members who are interested in learning more about the many areas of service available within the Fellowship." Each speaker tells of a particular aspect of service that has aided personal recovery. It is gratifying to watch faces light up with the excitement of newfound knowledge. —*Lenore Jefferson*

Pennsylvania (Western): My understanding of the service structure of A.A. was primarily the result of a great deal of reading. When I was chosen delegate, I felt it a great privilege, but also realized what a tremendous responsibility I had been given, for it is very important that we have strong, informed, service-minded people. At our general service meetings, we have begun study of "The A.A. Service Manual." We are forming new districts in the north and rural areas, to get more people involved in general service work. —*Ken King*

Quebec (Northeastern): Our area is structured as described in "The A.A. Service Manual." We have 170 groups in ten districts. The area committee holds a monthly meeting, and G.S.R.'s meet four times a year in a different district each time. At our last general area meeting, a workshop on sponsorship was very successful. Topics and workshops at our next will be the same as our agenda here. We plan a G.S.R. school in the coming year. —*Gerry LaPointe*

Quebec (Southeastern): We have been going through the districts with "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," in French, on acetates. Our members are now *seeing* the Traditions with renewed interest. This year, we will make another round with the illustrated Traditions. We explained to our members changes that have taken place in the Quebec General Service Office, with decentralization for better regional service to the groups. I will give my report on the 1977 Conference in Drummondville on May 1. —*Robert Rosa*

Texas (Northeastern): We are redistricting. D.C.M.'s now have monthly workshops with G.S.R.'s. Each central office is being briefed by a P.I. committee, suggesting better-informed speakers to school, church, and civic groups. The committee has also sent to TV and radio stations participants who are thoroughly informed on our anonymity policy. We now have 12 members

very capable of giving Tradition and service talks. We also have our first C.P.C. committee. —*David Aronofsky*

Texas (Southeastern): Our group devotes our Thursday-night meeting to the Steps and Traditions, 30 minutes on each. Area committee members meet once a month at the intergroup office, usually after our general service sharing session or our quarterly meeting, both of which are well attended. Some of us reactivated the A.A. meeting at the city prison farm. I served twice as group secretary, then G.S.R., committee member, and chairman of the assembly. Now I'm delegate (out of the hat). The runner-up is alternate delegate. To say I feel inadequate for this job is putting it mildly. —*Skeeter Hayes*

Utah: In 1975, our first assembly was held. Presentations and discussions dealt with the Three Legacies. Attendance exceeded expectations. In 1976, the assembly grew. Workshops were used to make members more aware of the duties of D.C.M.'s and G.S.R.'s. TV spot announcements from G.S.O. were shown on three stations. Local people were interviewed during sessions of the Utah School on Alcoholism. Efforts should be made, the committee agreed, to make more use of the talents of women in Third Legacy work. —*Jack Wilson*

Virginia: My service work started 14 years ago, as G.S.R. Our area has grown from eight districts to 20, with 361 groups. At our quarterly committee meetings and spring and fall assemblies, attended by most G.S.R.'s, we have workshops and sharing sessions on all phases of service. I plan to travel all over our area to establish better communication between groups and the area committee, also better understanding of the Conference and the service it gives our Fellowship. —*Bob Britt*

Washington: Since personal desire to serve is not always matched by personal funds, the area's decision to grant substantial sums to three area committees (P.I., Grapevine and literature, and H & I) and to provide reasonable travel expenses to co-chairpersons has proved a powerful aid. The agreement to send all area money over a \$1,500 prudent reserve to G.S.O. ("lest problems of money, property, and prestige . . .") has cut down on discussion of funds. During our last assembly, 270 voters were in attendance from over 300 groups. —*Fran Polek*

West Virginia: Structure within the guidelines of "The A.A. Service Manual" has progressed steadily in our area. The area committee has 17 members. We have institutions, Grapevine, and P.I. committees. Some groups are separated by up to 100 mountainous miles, while in more populated areas there are 20-25 groups within a 20-mile radius. We have a two-day assembly prior to the Conference in April, and a two-day fall assembly, with 75-80% group participation. More district workshops are being held to inform present and future G.S.R.'s of the importance of service structure, and groups are being urged to stress and maintain the Traditions. —*Grace Day*

Wisconsin (Southern): I came into our Fellowship in 1968 at a halfway house. I became G.S.R. after about six months. With the help of G.S.O., I learned of our Third Legacy. When I became area chairman, I urged monthly meetings of D.C.M.'s. We started a school for G.S.R.'s and have gone through "The A.A. Service Manual" and the Concepts. I've also stressed the importance of our group listings in the A.A. directory and of all information the G.S.R. gets from G.S.O. We have an institutions chairman who is active and a P.I.C. chairman who has gotten our Preamble on local TV (all channels). —*John Gans*

Reports From G.S.O., the General Service Board, and Trustees' Committees

G.S.B. and
G.S.O. reports

General Service Board

Our numbers keep rising, but costs are held down

Trustees' report: The problems of Alcoholics Anonymous seem few and minor. Brought up most at regional forums are those of internal communications and external relations—with professionals, treatment centers, court programs, and problems other than alcohol. The important thing is to keep from pushing the panic button or the mad button, and keep reminding ourselves that to do the best job of carrying the message, we must work together. We have made great progress.

We must keep the doors of A.A. open, keep our own minds open, and "be friendly with our friends." There is a great deal of Fellowship experience to be shared, in the literature, in the Guidelines, and in day-to-day experience in one area that may be helpful to another. A.A. is protected from ills that plague other segments of society—protected by our indisputable success (the sick *do* get well here!), by our Traditions, and by the spiritual basis of our program.

All indicators in A.A. are up. Number of groups, estimated

membership, literature sales, contributions, and Grapevine circulation all reached record high levels in 1976.

One reason for A.A.'s financial health is that G.S.O. and the Grapevine have kept operating costs down. Despite steady A.A. growth, the G.S.O. staff is no larger than it was three years ago, and the total of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine employees has increased only slightly.

Trustees have participated in regional forums in Western Canada (Vancouver, B.C.) and the Northeast U.S. (Springfield, Mass.). We benefited greatly from meeting G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, and other service-minded members, to share our thoughts and concerns face-to-face.

Trustees also met delegates from 18 countries at the conclusion of the World Service Meeting in New York last October. The W.S.M. still receives substantial financial support from our own board. This is a mutually stimulating experience, opening our eyes to the way A.A. is growing overseas.

Austin MacCormick, our beloved Class A trustee, resigned in November. The board asked him to continue as a "trustee emeritus." I indicated my own intention to step down as chair-

Literature distributed — 1976

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	181,744
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	93,276
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	22,129
A.A. Comes of Age	13,500
As Bill Sees It	22,329
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish edition	2,675
As Bill Sees It — Spanish edition	799
Total	336,452

Booklets

Living Sober	97,386
Came to Believe	26,844
Total	124,230

Pamphlets

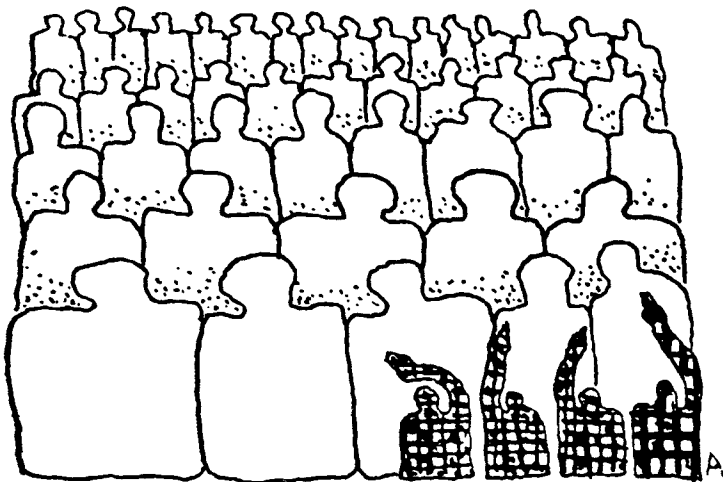
The Alcoholic Husband (discontinued)	110,800
The Alcoholic Wife (discontinued)	94,200
A.A. — a Community Resource	68,700
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	48,500
A.A. and the Armed Services	53,700
A.A. and the Medical Profession	53,900
A.A. for the Woman	130,900
A.A. — 44 Questions	257,200
The A.A. Group	59,900
A.A. in Hospitals	28,700
A.A. in Prisons	23,600
A.A. in Your Community	96,200
The A.A. Member and Drug Abuse	109,300
The A.A. Service Manual	13,600
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	41,000
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	15,600
Alcoholism Is a Management Problem	45,000
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	202,400
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	41,200
The Co-Founders of A.A.	35,000
Do You Think You're Different? (new)	69,400
The Fellowship of A.A. (discontinued)	49,800
G.S.R.	64,500

How A.A. Members Cooperate	30,000
How It Works	152,200
If You Are a Professional	46,900
Inside A.A.	61,400
Is A.A. for You?	377,300
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life? (new)	50,900
It Happened to Alice	90,400
The Jack Alexander Article	73,000
The Last Talks of A.A.'s Co-Founders	42,800
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	26,500
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	93,200
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	86,000
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	40,500
Problems Other Than Alcohol	78,800
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	133,700
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	29,000
This Is A.A.	311,900
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	48,100
Twelve Concepts for World Service	6,600
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	50,400
Understanding Anonymity	83,000
What Happened to Joe	82,200
Young People and A.A.	207,300
Foreign Translations	104,300
Total	4,019,500

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards — two-fold	539,100
Wallet cards — I Am Responsible	89,800
Wallet cards — Anonymity	42,300
Parchment — scrolls	3,869
Placards	830
Guide for Leading Beginners Meetings	1,949
Group Handbook	3,573
Wire racks	923
Cassettes	566
A.A. Publication Information Manual	1,260
Hanging displays	708
Fact Files	2,885

man of the board following the 1978 Conference. Bob Hitchins, chairman of General Services, will retire at the end of this year. Bob's contributions to the Fellowship have been many. I shall



particularly remember his meticulous determination and patience, when chairing the Conference, to make sure the rights of the minority were scrupulously observed.

John L. Norris, M.D., chairman

A.A.W.S.

Literature prices reduced

Directors' report: A.A.W.S. is, in effect, a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. Meetings of its directors are held monthly. We establish prices on new literature and other material. The directors also approve or disapprove requests for permission to reprint A.A. literature. There are nine A.A.W.S. directors, of whom five are also trustees, including one nonalcoholic and two regional.

Broadening the base of group support—We recommended reducing the price of the Big Book by 60¢, liberalizing the discount structure, and increasing the distribution of no-charge literature. The directors stressed that increased group participation through increased contributions is necessary if the reduced cost of literature to the Fellowship is to be maintained.

Literature distribution center, Central America—We agreed to finance the printing of our literature (up to \$18,000) for a new center for Costa Rica, Guatemala, Honduras, and Nicaragua. We hope El Salvador will eventually join.

Brazil G.S.O.—We approved the printing in Brazil of \$8,000 worth of Portuguese literature, inventory to be owned by A.A.W.S.

Biography of Dr. Bob—We approved the expenditure of \$5,000 for research on this project.

Publication of G.S.O. salaries—We approved a suggested salary table to be distributed to trustees for information and/or approval.

Publishing—In 1976, distribution of books, pamphlets, and mis-

cellaneous items reached 5,167,900 units. Free literature sent to service groups and to inform the public amounted to 433,000 individual pieces; inventory value, \$20,700.

The Accounting Department is composed of nine clerks, a bookkeeper, an assistant bookkeeper, and an accounts receivable clerk. Plans for a computer are moving smoothly.

The File Department has three people, who file over 1,000 pieces of material weekly.

The Mail Department is relatively new. Mailings of free material, incoming and outgoing correspondence, mimeographing, and maintenance of the Scriptomatic file are handled here.

The Records Department prepares the six directories and maintains G.S.O.'s mailing lists. It is composed of eight people.

The Shipping Department, with 12 men, handles all cash orders mailed from G.S.O. and maintains quarterly inventories. This year, up-to-date equipment was installed to increase efficiency in handling orders.

The Stenographic and Clerical Department is composed of 16 women, ten of whom work with the G.S.O. staff, preparing correspondence, typing bulletins, and serving as recording secretaries.

Walter Murphy, chairman

Archives

Memoirs of A.A.'s early days by Ruth Hock

G.S.O. report: The year's activity has been concentrated in four areas: microfilming, card cataloging, interviewing (oral history), and a new selection of material for compatible taping.

We offered assistance to researchers (who had secured permission for access); prepared and coded duplicate sets of audio tapes and microfilms for our storage facility; answered requests for information from office staff and outside callers and writers; provided individual A.A.'s and professionals with copies of published archival material for special projects; compiled listings and indexes covering A.A. events, dates, and topics. Over the past year, about 40 people (A.A.'s and nonalcoholics) were interviewed on tape for the archives, including Dr. John L. Norris, Ruth Hock Crecelius, Marty Mann, and Austin MacCormick.

Nearly every day, we continue to receive from groups and individuals (both A.A. and nonalcoholic) a wonderful variety of historical material: films, tapes, state and local histories, photographs, scrapbooks, books, pamphlets, magazines, letters, and other records.

Around the U.S. and Canadian groups, there is an exciting trend toward establishing local archival and/or tape centers. Since the number of first-generation or original 100 members is decreasing almost daily, it's necessary to obtain from them as many firsthand personal stories and reminiscences as possible. Local archives centers and interested A.A.'s have been most helpful in securing tapes and manuscripts from these older members and sharing the results with us, and we are grateful.

A constant objective is to obtain ever more data on Dr. Bob and Anne Smith, not only to have this available permanently in the archives, but to have it as a ready research source.

Over the past year, we have been improving the appearance of our archives rooms. The suite now has three rooms, with space for a long-needed copying machine.

Our archives family continues to increase. Frank Mauser, who succeeded Midge McFadden as secretary of the Archives Committee, oversees our whole operation. Sheila Talcott joined Harriet Gillen and me last spring. We all join in saying, "Please come up and see us some time!"

Nell Wing, archivist

Trustees' committee: During the past year, we met three times. We reviewed classifications of archival material for comprehensive and permanent coding. The goal was to remain as open as possible to serious researchers and allow A.A. members free access to their historical legacy, while protecting the material itself from damage or loss and assuring the complete privacy of all individuals, in keeping with A.A. traditions.

It was decided that basically a three-category system best suits our needs: A—general; B—classified; and C—confidential. The A—general category was subdivided into A-1 for public use, and A-2 for material open to A.A.'s under supervision. This will allow much additional material to be available within the Fellowship. All classifications will be reviewed regularly.

The review of the classification status of the minutes of the Alcoholic Foundation/Works Publishing Board meetings and related matters has been completed for 1938-1955. This material is B—classified.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., chairman

Conference

Correspondence and questions affect agenda

Staff report: The Conference secretary, a point of contact among Conference members, corresponds with past delegates and all those serving on the area general service committees. Our mailing list now totals nearly 3,000, including 730 past delegates, 1,993 district committee members, 85 area committee chairmen, 78 area committee secretaries, and 85 area committee treasurers, plus others involved in service. We receive minutes of most area assemblies and committee meetings. Circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs, these are very helpful in keeping us up with A.A. activities around the U.S. and Canada.

Any A.A. may send in suggestions for the Conference agenda, usually through the delegate. Suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference and Conference Agenda Committees for approval, then shared with everyone in the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary agenda mailed in January.

The Conference secretary collects items for the Conference theme and agenda; serves as secretary of the Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee; corresponds with

all delegates; works with the general manager, the office manager, and the staff in planning and coordination of the Conference; schedules and routes all material for Conference Manuals, Early Bird edition of Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*; prepares Conference Advisory Actions and summaries of Ask-It Basket questions; and reviews all communications received from area committees and district committee members.

Mary Ellen Welsh

Trustees' committee: We review ways of improving the Conference and consider themes and agenda topics.

As a result of the 1976 Conference questionnaire, the committee agreed that Area Service Highlights be cut to two minutes each, and the number of workshops and presentations be reduced.

The 1977 Conference agenda has been arranged to allow for: (1) committee reports on Thursday and Friday; (2) opening dinner and A.A. meeting on Sunday evening; (3) delegates' dinner and meeting on Tuesday; (4) an A.A. meeting in mid-week; and (5) more time for regional luncheons.

The 1976 Conference included three alternate delegates who served on very short notice. So thought was given to better communications with G.S.O., by providing each delegate with two copies of all Conference mail, in the hope that one will be given to the alternate.

The delegates' meeting had requested that no restrictions be placed on discussion topics at the delegates' meeting. A letter to the delegate chairman pointed out that matters to be brought before the Conference floor should be discussed by *all* Conference members, not just by the delegates, who comprise only two-thirds of the Conference membership.

Since delegates on a new panel do not take office until January 1, it was suggested the preliminary agenda not be circulated until early in January, but agenda topics will be distributed to delegates in November.

The committee recommended that directors of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine be active participants in workshops and other Conference sessions, and approved several suggestions for improving workshops.

John Waterfield, chairman

Cooperation with the professional community

Professionals' interest in A.A. steadily increases

Staff report: Over the past year, staff and committee members have participated in: (1) the annual conference of the National Council on Alcoholism (N.C.A.) in Washington, D.C.; (2) the Summer School of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University; (3) a program at Long Island Hospital in Brooklyn, N.Y. (sponsored by the Brooklyn Committee on Alcoholism), on "How A.A. Serves as a Community Resource"; (4) the 27th annual meeting of the Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America (A.D.P.A.) in New Orleans; (5) the sixth annual Conference on Alcoholism at the University of Delaware, co-sponsored by the Delaware Council, Inc., and the University of

Delaware; (6) the first Conference on Alcoholism and the Hispanic Community, at Prospect Hospital in the Bronx, N.Y.; and (7) the second annual John F. Smith Memorial Seminar on alcoholism at St. Peter's Hospital, Albany, N.Y.

During the World Service Meeting, in October, we arranged for several delegates, at their request, to visit Smithers Institute, Beth Israel Halfway House, Columbus Hospital, and the New York Times Employee Assistance Program.

An International Lawyers Group in A.A., listing some 70 members, now meets annually.

About A.A., our newsletter to professionals, was mailed in December.

Cornell medical students attend our Friday A.A. meeting about every six weeks.

In January, G.S.O. held a luncheon for the commissioner of a new New York State agency on Alcoholism and Substance Abuse. We discussed our Traditions of nonaffiliation and non-endorsement and stressed our eagerness to cooperate within these Traditions.

The A.A. Guidelines on Industry Programs have been updated.

Phyllis Masback

Trustees' committee: There continues to be increasing interest in carrying the A.A. message to professionals in the field of alcoholism.

At the recommendation of the Conference, a paper for prospective members from, and administrators of, court programs and other referral agencies and treatment facilities has been prepared.

Your chairman has attended two meetings of the Association of Anti-Poverty Alcoholism Programs in Connecticut. A chapter on A.A. by Dr. John L. Norris and a committee member will appear in a five-volume encyclopedia on alcoholism in 1977. Dr. Norris has also written "Management of the Chronic Alcoholic," for a W. B. Saunders publication entitled "Controversy in Psychiatry."

The committee feels we should continue to address ourselves to: (1) attitudes, A.A. knowledge, and behavior of A.A. members working in the field, and the image of A.A. they project; and (2) the way A.A. is presented to new members by professionals in treatment facilities.

Robert Macpherson, chairman

Correctional Facilities

Plan new pamphlet for inmates

Trustees' committee: In October, the first Correctional Facility Subcommittee meeting was held.

A new illustrated pamphlet, tentatively named "It Sure Beats Hell Out of Sitting in a Cell," will be written in three parts:

"What We Did Behind the Bars," which gives 13 suggestions for staying sober while inside; inmate stories; and "What We Did on the First Days Out."

Eight corrections officers sent evaluations of A.A. at their facilities to trustee emeritus Austin MacCormick. These will replace testimonials currently in "A.A. in Prisons."

Holding separate meetings in correctional facilities for non-English-speaking A.A.'s was discussed. It was felt this situation is primarily up to the local institutions committee to decide, with the administration of the institution.

Ways to inform A.A. members and A.A. groups of the spiritual rewards of carrying the message behind the walls, and thus to increase their interest, were discussed. Here are suggestions that have proved successful:

- 1 Make speaking at institutions a privilege.
 - 2 Let institutions committee members speak at closed meetings to inform "outside" A.A. groups about the spiritual rewards of speaking to "inside" groups, and the purpose and needs of inside A.A. groups.
 - 3 Suggest that outside A.A. groups elect institutions representatives and book speakers for inside meetings.
 - 4 Encourage A.A.'s who have been on the inside to speak at institutions.
 - 5 Hold institutions special events meetings and/or institutions workshops in conjunction with Conferences. If possible, have inmates tell what is most helpful for those on the inside to hear.
- We recommended that suggestions for members speaking in prisons be made available in leaflet form.
- We plan to review Austin MacCormick's survey data to find out where A.A. is working best, and what is making those areas successful.
- Both trustees' Institutions subcommittees expressed love and gratitude to Austin MacCormick for his many years of friendship and work in behalf of A.A.

Bill Dunkin, chairman

Correctional Facilities is now a full trustee committee. See the Treatment Facilities report (p. 41) for explanation.

Finance

Hopes rest on the A.A. group

Trustees' committee: Until last year, G.S.O. increasingly depended on literature income, because group contributions did not carry their fair share of service expenses. Recognizing this, the 1976 Conference asked the board to take action to broaden the base of group support. Anticipating increased group support, the Conference recommended reducing the Big Book price, liberalizing bulk discounts on literature, and increasing distribution of free literature.

These recommendations were put into effect September 15, 1976. So far, everything seems to be fine. Contributions finished the year \$139,300 ahead of 1975, and sales income for the fourth quarter of 1976 decreased accordingly.



However, to continue to make this policy work and further reduce the price of A.A. literature, the groups must further support the cost of group services. To do this, the *percentage* of groups contributing — a dangerously low 56% for 1976 — must be increased.

A.A. growth continued to be reflected in increased G.S.O. activity. Literature sales for the year totaled \$2,244,200, an increase of \$320,600 over 1975. (Part of this represents a year of sales at revised prices effective May 1, 1975, less some adjustment due to the decrease in the Big Book price and other Conference recommendations.)

Contributions amounted to \$946,600, a 17% increase over the previous year. Total G.S.O. income, representing publishing gross profit, contributions, and interest generated by cash flow, was over 1975 by \$348,100 and 6% over budget. Total G.S.O. expenses exceeded those of 1975 by \$196,700, almost 1% *under* budget. To sum up: Net expense of the General Fund, \$249,800, was offset by publishing net income, \$776,700; this resulted in a net income for G.S.O. in 1976 of \$526,900.

The board's Finance Committee approved the 1977 budget. Sales income, allowing for a 60-cent reduction in the Big Book price and modification of the bulk discount structure, is budgeted 7.8% higher than 1976. Allowing for an increase in group support, contributions are budgeted 12.2% greater than 1976. Total expenses (excluding one-time costs of installing the data processing system) are budgeted 7% over 1976. Net income from all G.S.O. operations is expected to total \$402,200 as compared to last year's \$526,900.

Arthur Miles, chairman

Group services coordinator

Guidelines, films, handbooks, directories

Staff report: The group services coordinator supervises production of all service materials, updating of Guidelines and listings, distribution of films, literature displays, Group Handbooks, and other material.

Each month, she conducts a meeting in which the service assign-

ment of each staff member is discussed and suggestions for improvement and/or change are offered.

Our three handbooks now are the new Group Handbook, the new Prison Group Handbook, and the new Hospital Group Handbook. Each new group in the United States and Canada receives a Group Handbook (groups already established may purchase one) and a complimentary supply of literature. New groups receive *Box 4-5-9*, as well as the appropriate A.A. directory. The four directories now published annually are: Eastern U.S., Western U.S.; Canadian, and International. The directories of A.A. groups in Hospitals and Rehabilitation Centers and in Correctional Facilities were prepared in 1975 and will be issued again in 1977.

There are now 12 Guidelines.

Two 16-mm color films available are "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions." The new filmstrip about G.S.O., "P.O. Box 459," is also available.

Material pertaining to the various services is available on request. For example, we have a listing of A.A. members who like to exchange tapes on a sale basis or may wish to correspond. We also have listings of Loners, Internationalists, armed services groups, etc. Literature kits for special purposes are sent on a complimentary basis or in response to orders.

The group services coordinator is secretary of A.A. World Services, Inc. All our Conference-approved literature is copyrighted. Permission for any of it to be quoted can be granted only by A.A. World Services, Inc.

Waneta New

Group services assistant

Bulletins, reports, updated literature

Staff report: New projects are a new filmstrip about A.A. structure, "Circles of Love and Service," and a literature survey mailed to 1,000 groups.

This assignment also involves preparation, production, editorial supervision, and distribution of many publications.

G.S.O. bulletins—We sent out over 325,548 bulletins and reports in 1976, including *Box 4-5-9* every other month, with French and Spanish editions following. Our mailing lists can be more accurate when they are computerized.

	Mailing list	Issues per yr.
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (English)	40,000	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (French)	1,141	6
<i>Box 4-5-9</i> (Spanish)	5,883	6
<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i>	2,228	6
<i>P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin</i>	1,643	4
<i>Institutions Bulletin</i>	4,510	3
<i>Quarterly Report</i>	2,919	3*
<i>About A.A.</i>	3,177	1

*The *Conference Report* takes the place of the fourth issue.

Pamphlets—We update old pamphlets and prepare new ones, dis-

plays, leaflets, and other service materials. In production now is "Too Young?," a cartoon pamphlet for teenagers. Two completely rewritten are "Your A.A. General Service Office" and "G.S.R. (may be the most important job in A.A.)."

Books, booklets—We have reprinted the Big Book (third edition), "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," and "As Bill Sees It" (new cover).

Susan Daly

Institutions

A.A. helps more and more patients and prisoners

Staff report: We provide services to 1,285 groups in treatment facilities and 1,230 groups in correctional facilities. Over 147 institutions committees serve these facilities.

G.S.O. helps carry the message to those in treatment and correctional facilities in the following ways:

- 1 Correspondence is carried on by the institutions staff member and through the institutions correspondence service.
- 2 A Group Handbook, a copy of the Big Book, and complimentary literature are sent to new groups.
- 3 We provide the appropriate updated institutions directories every two years.
- 4 Each institution group receives *Box 4-5-9*, and three times yearly the *Institutions Bulletin*.
- 5 Discount packages of A.A. literature are available to "inside" groups and institutions committees.
- 6 Guidelines for A.A. members interested in institutions work are on Institutions Committees and on Cooperating with Court, A.S.A.P. and Similar Programs.
- 7 The films "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" and the G.S.O. filmstrip, "P.O. Box 459," are lent without charge to institutions groups.

After a recommendation from the 1976 Conference, we surveyed institutions committees on the contents of the institutional discount packages. Results indicated contents should remain about the same, but the number of copies for some pamphlets should be increased.

Sarah Pierce

Trustee committee reports: See *Correctional Facilities* (p. 34) and *Treatment Facilities* (p. 41).

International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

Committee given new forum responsibilities

Staff report: Two regional forums have been held since the 1976 Conference — one in Western Canada in September, and

one in the Northeast U.S. in March. They are held on the invitation of the region, and plans are made with the regional trustee, the region's delegates, and the G.S.O. staff.

Board personnel have attended both regional forums held so far, including four or five trustees, plus staff members (G.S.O. and Grapevine). Hotel, meal, and travel expenses of board personnel are paid by the board, and expenses of people in the region are handled either by the individuals themselves or by area committees, as in any other A.A. function.

The coordinator plans meetings with the regional trustee, delegates, and the general manager of G.S.O.; makes arrangements with host-city contact and the hotels; makes travel and hotel arrangements for trustees and G.S.O. staff; sends regional mailings to current delegates, with questionnaire regarding agenda plans, and to all G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committee officers, past/present delegates, past/present trustees, and central offices. The coordinator also arranges for conference boards and sample literature.

Reports of regional forums are mailed to all participants and to all trustees and current delegates.

Cora Louise Belford

Trustees' committee: In 1976, the committee name was changed, and our function was expanded to include assistance with regional forums.

International Convention—We reviewed the report of the Ad Hoc Inspection Committee and recommended that the General Service Board approve New Orleans as the site of the 1980 International Convention. We recommended that the Host Committee chairman be appointed by the board at its July 1978 meeting.

Regional forums—The following recommendations were made:

- 1 That forums be held on the invitation of a region; the regional trustee and current delegates help in planning.
- 2 Invitations be sent to G.S.R.'s, D.C.M.'s, area committee officers, past/present delegates and trustees, and central offices. Any A.A. is welcome to attend.
- 3 The regional trustee with whom planning has been done should chair the forum; a newly elected trustee would not act as a forum chairman until after his or her second board meeting.
- 4 No A.A. meetings or talks be on the agenda of a forum, but participants may schedule midnight meetings if they wish.
- 5 Flyers describing regional forums should not be included with mailings.
- 6 We should continue unstructured programs for forums and the use of questionnaires to delegates in planning.
- 7 The board should not assume financial responsibility for taping forum sessions. The host-city contact will be asked to make arrangements with a local A.A. member to tape the sessions, and the board will purchase two complete sets of tapes. Tape sales to individuals will be the responsibility of those involved, not of the board.

8 A participating trustee might share the chairing of sessions with the trustee of the host region.

Dave Cooke, chairman

Internationalists

610 seagoing messengers

Staff report: Internationalists have always started A.A. groups. New ones were started the past year in Sardinia, Italy, and Izmir, Turkey.

Approximately 610 Internationalists (seagoing A.A.'s) carry the message around the world. We help them keep in touch with one another and G.S.O.

A package of A.A. material is sent to all who join this service. Every other month, Internationalists, Port Contacts, and Internationalist groups receive *Loners-Internationalists Meeting*, our newsletter sharing correspondence received at G.S.O. Box 4-5-9 is sent them bimonthly.

Yolanda C. Lazo

Literature

Third edition of Big Book leads off busy year

Trustees' committee: Cooperating with the Conference Literature Committee, we have worked on the following:

- 1 "Alcoholics Anonymous," third edition (completed May 1976).
- 2 "Do You Think You're Different?" (sold close to 150,000).
- 3 "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?" (sold close to 150,000).
- 4 "The Co-Founders of A.A." and "The Last Talks of A.A.'s Co-Founders" are to be combined this year when reprinted.
- 5 "Too Young?" (teenage cartoon pamphlet) is now ready for production.
- 6 We recommended that "A.A. Comes of Age" be left as it is, but compiling a history of A.A.'s first 50 years for distribution in 1985 should be considered.
- 7 We also recommended to A.A.W.S. funds be allocated to:
 - a Begin compiling material for the history book.
 - b Gather material on Dr. Bob for archival use while it is still available from those who knew him.
- 8 We recommended adding the short form of the Concepts to unity and service literature where feasible.
- 9 We decided to ask the 1977 Conference Literature Committee for its views on a proposed publication sharing experience of longer-sober members.

10 We recommended a subcommittee be established to explore audiovisual material for A.A.

11 We approved a literature survey, mailed March 1, 1977.

12 We accepted the recommendation to add to "The A.A. Group" how a group can contribute as in "A Penny a Day for Sobriety."

13 We decided not to ask the 1977 Conference Literature Committee to consider a pamphlet for agnostics/atheists at this time.

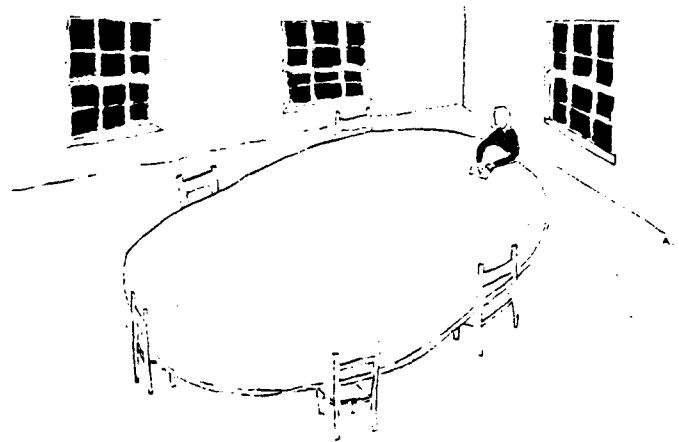
14 We rejected a recommendation from the Policy Committee that the long form of the Twelve Traditions be added to "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," as the long form can be read in the Big Book, pp. 565-568.

15 We discussed each request for a new pamphlet or a change in a present pamphlet. Our answers included:

a *Masculine-language usage in reference to God* – Changing a single word of the Steps would involve a mail poll to all A.A. groups worldwide. Because this issue is too complex and controversial, involving A.A. as a whole in religious matters, it was declined.

b *Masculine language in A.A. pamphlets* – Pamphlets are being reworded gradually as they are reprinted.

Gordon Patrick, chairman



Loners

Loners start A.A. groups

Staff report: We encourage each Loner to seek another alcoholic and start an A.A. group. During the past year, new groups were started in Mexico, Saudi Arabia, and Spain.

Approximately 300 Loners, with no access to meetings, stay sober by sharing experiences through correspondence.

Lone Members receive complimentary A.A. literature, a list of Loners, and a list of Internationalists. *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* and Box 4-5-9 are sent on alternate months. In addition to the appropriate directory, a mimeographed sheet of

ideas on how to stay sober, drawn from the experience of other Loners, is mailed to new Lone Members.

Over 700 Loner Sponsors correspond with Lone Members.

Yolanda C. Lazo

Nominating

Qualifications of trustees, directors screened

Trustees' committee: We discussed special qualifications needed for the general service trustee—U.S. to be elected in 1977. Since the board has the responsibility of indicating qualifications needed in a trustee to provide balance in business experience, profession, age, sex, etc., this suggestion was made: The notification letter should point out that, with the rotation of the present general service trustee—U.S., there will no longer be a woman or younger person serving on the board.

The committee approved Don Daly and Kitty Kiernan as new directors of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

The committee reviewed possible replacements for Austin MacCormick, who has resigned. As the correctional field is important to A.A., it should continue to be represented on the board. W. J. Estelle Jr., director of the Texas Department of Corrections, was nominated.

The committee approved Jerry Danzig and Martin Le Boutillier for general service trustees (New York), Jerry to replace Walter Murphy following the April meeting, and Martin to replace Robert Macpherson following the July meeting of the board.

The committee approved as eligible all candidates for general service trustee—U.S., and all candidates for regional trustee from the Southeast and East Central Regions.

The committee approved John Bragg to serve as a director of A.A. World Services, Inc., following the July meeting.

The committee recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation to the 1977 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	John L. Norris, M.D.
John D. Bealer, M.D.	Gordon M. Patrick
Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.	(one vacancy)
Arthur J. Miles	

Class B

N. M. Cheater	Mike Rainbolt
Cecil E. Corrigan	Edward J. Small
Charles H. Hanson	John E. Waterfield
*Robert Macpherson	Peter A. G. Watters
Don Nicolson	Stanley R. Wilsey
Two regional trustees: S.E. U.S., E. Cent. U.S.	
Two general service trustees: New York	
One general service trustee—U.S.	

The committee approved the following slate of officers for elec-

tion at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April:

<i>Chairman</i>	John L. Norris, M.D.
<i>First vice-chairman</i>	Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
<i>Second vice-chairman</i>	Mike Rainbolt
<i>Secretary</i>	Cecil E. Corrigan
<i>Treasurer</i>	Arthur J. Miles
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	Beth Kuhlmann
<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Dennis I. Manders

The committee recommended that the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., be presented to the 1977 General Service Conference in April:

John D. Bealer, M.D.	**Robert Macpherson
John Bragg	Robert Pearson
Jerry Danzig	Jacquelyn Solomon
Beth Kuhlmann	John E. Waterfield
Martin Le Boutillier	Peter A. G. Watters

The committee recommended the following directors of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., be presented to the 1977 General Service Conference in April:

Donald F. Daly	Jack Morley
Charles H. Hanson	John Ryall
Kathleen Kiernan	Fred Sengstacke
Austin MacCormick	Edward J. Small
Polly Marsh	

The committee discussed the duties of the chairman of the board and what steps should be taken in looking for a replacement for Dr. Norris, who has indicated his intention to step down as chairman in April 1978.

Charles Hanson, chairman

**Serves through the August board meeting. Replacement takes office following the August board meeting.*

***Serves through the July A.A. W.S. meeting, after which his replacement takes office.*

Overseas

A.A. mushrooms globally

Staff report: Response to our directory information mailing to overseas G.S.O.'s, central offices, and groups indicates a 23% increase over last year's figures on the number of groups. A.A. continues to grow around the world. (See p. 6.)

Outside the U.S. and Canada, 28 literature distribution centers provide new groups with complimentary literature in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (Flemish and French), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, El Salvador, Finland, France, Germany, Guatemala, Holland, Ireland, Mexico, Norway, South and South-West Africa, Sweden, and Switzerland (French and German). G.S.O. has established guidelines for literature distribution centers, and we work closely with both newly emerging and established centers.

We continue to work with A.A. members in other countries where there are not yet general service boards or literature dis-

tribution centers. After five years, the Icelandic Intergroup in Reykjavik completed the translation and publication of the Big Book in Icelandic. Also, 26 Japanese-speaking A.A. groups have sprung up in Tokyo, and members there have translated several pamphlets into Japanese.

Some highlights of A.A.'s growth the past year:

Argentina—The Publishing Committee issues a whole line of Conference-approved literature, except "The A.A. Service Manual," which is being adapted to their service structure with permission of A.A.W.S. Their G.S.O. receives some voluntary contributions, but they have had to reduce services this year due to an incredible 600% inflation. In spite of this, Argentina has begun to provide some services to A.A.'s in Uruguay and Paraguay.

Brazil—The growth rate is tremendous, with over 250 new groups in the last year. Brazilian A.A.'s have a General Service Conference and Board. Their publishing company has established a target of publishing one new Conference-approved pamphlet every two months, because they feel providing literature is their most important service. Brazil was seated for the first time at the Fourth World Service Meeting.

Colombia—Inflation has caused a 50% increase in the sale price of literature. They have added "A.A. Comes of Age" and "A.A. in Prisons" to their publications. They are translating "The A.A. Service Manual," with an appendix describing their present service structure.

Finland—A consistent 10% yearly growth in membership is reported. They will host the Fifth World Service Meeting, in Helsinki in 1978.

France—Groups outside Paris now outnumber Paris groups, indicating A.A. is growing in France. French A.A.'s have been meeting with French-speaking A.A.'s in Belgium and Switzerland in an effort to build an International Committee of European French-Speaking A.A.

Mexico—was forced, by increased cost of material, to increase literature prices by 25%. They hope to have the first issue of a monthly magazine, similar to the Grapevine, out some time in 1977.

South Africa—This G.S.O. is now manned by one full-time and two part-time employees, and literature sales continue to increase. "What Happened to Joe" is being produced in English, Zulu, and Sesoto.

United Kingdom—A.A.'s growth rate is accelerating in the U.K.; literature sales are increasing. In 1975, they held two national conventions. Their monthly magazine, *Share*, reports a circulation in excess of 3,500.

Betty Liddle, Yolanda Lazo

Policy

Spirituality, anonymity, A.A. 'spokesmen'

Trustees' committee: It was resolved in 1955 that a general Policy Committee should be authorized to deal with problems

of external policy of the General Service Board and with policy matters affecting A.A. as a whole.

Since the 1976 Conference, the committee has considered these matters:

- 1 Preparation of a basic text of all A.A. material (Guidelines, pamphlets, and service material) was felt not to be timely, but local groups might be encouraged to prepare their own.
- 2 It was agreed to continue using the term "Conference-approved" on A.A. material.
- 3 G.S.O. received from an editor a letter questioning our statement that A.A.'s speak as individuals and no one speaks for A.A., when we do have a public information desk. People who call A.A. or interview an A.A. do feel the person is speaking for A.A. Since there isn't any cut-and-dried answer to the question of who speaks for A.A., we should continue to be guided by the concept that there really aren't any official spokesmen for A.A.
4. Guest speaker Dr. Ernest P. Noble, director of the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, discussed cultural attitudes toward drinking and steps taken by N.I.A.A.A. to increase the liquor industry's awareness of its social responsibilities, with particular reference to advertising. He expressed concern about the Rand report. N.I.A.A.A. feels that total abstinence is still the best solution.
- 5 There was discussion as to whether or not there is as much talk in A.A. today about spirituality as there used to be. Opinions were divided.
6. There was also discussion about anonymity within the Fellowship. Some sense a trend toward a more rigid interpretation of anonymity within A.A. Years ago, almost all speakers used their full names. Today, this is seldom done. Perhaps this represents a basic misunderstanding of the anonymity Tradition. It may be each A.A.'s responsibility to tell others about anonymity on a one-to-one basis.

Margaret Carlson, chairman

Public information

Media interested in A.A.

Staff report: In 1976, we answered 9,809 requests for information about A.A. from newspapers, magazines, radio, and TV. We processed 5,484 press clippings. Many good articles written by other than A.A. members were included. An especially good syndicated article by William Buckley described a friend's recovery.

We distributed 98 radio and 256 TV spots. We learned of 96 anonymity breaks.

Forty-three "A.A.—a Community Resource" displays were sent to health fairs and local county and state meetings.

We now list 232 P.I. committees and 306 P.I. contacts. They receive the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin* and much other material.

When the "Brief Guide" pamphlet is rerun, it will be revised to avoid the exclusive use of masculine pronouns.

June Russell

Trustees' committee: The January 1976 Grapevine ran a nine-page symposium on doctors. We mailed 500 copies to medical directors and science writers and sent offset copies to large newspapers, A.P., U.P.I., and other news services.

A selection of good newspaper stories and editorials about A.A. was sent to local P.I. committees as idea starters.

The A.A.W.S. board approved an expenditure of \$1,000 for sending TV spots to the ten largest cities. Letters were sent to 55 TV stations, and we sent a 30- and a 60-second spot to each. We also wrote local P.I. committees and intergroup offices of our plans. The response was positive. One station in Dallas wrote, "We seldom have time for 60's, but I felt these so important, I cleared and have used both."

A press release on the third edition of the Big Book was sent to wire services, book trade magazines, book editors of major dailies in the U.S. and Canada, and local P.I. committees.

The annual anonymity letter was mailed to area delegates and the media in November. The pamphlets "Understanding Anonymity" and "A.A. in Your Community" were enclosed. A similar letter for treatment facilities using A.A. as an adjunct to their programs was mailed in December.

A press release was sent to the New Orleans Tourist and Convention Bureau announcing that city as the site of the 1980 A.A. International Convention.

A survey to determine names and quantities of pamphlets most frequently used in P.I. activities was enclosed with a P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin, and results were published in the first 1977 issue.

A human-interest story describing A.A.'s self-support may be placed with a syndicate service or Sunday supplements, and will be mailed to P.I. committees.

One of our biggest projects is the 1977 survey. The last was done in 1974. Questions will probably refer to slips, service work, and sponsorship.*



The committee is updating audiovisual material. Thirty-second TV spots are more desirable than 60-second. A tag line will be added to radio spots stating how a person may contact A.A.

Working with members of the C.P.C. Committee, we are exploring ways of carrying the message to the medical profession. Some suggestions are:

1 Inform P.I. committees that a town doctor who has been helpful to drunks might be used as a starting point in carrying the A.A. message to others in the medical field.

2 Prepare guidelines on "How to Carry the Message to the Medical Profession in Your Community."

3 Make up a package of helpful hints to intergroup and P.I. committees. This would be a joint P.I.-C.P.C. effort. The sub-committee will make up a model kit.

The committee is preparing a question-and-answer sheet about A.A., to be sent in response to requests for information about A.A. from non-A.A. sources. So information may be kept up-to-date, it will be mimeographed.

Walter Murphy, chairman

**Reporting to the Conference on Tuesday morning, Walter Murphy summed up the results of the 1974 survey and stated the threefold purpose of the 1977 survey: (a) to update the findings of previous surveys (1968, 1971, and 1974) and note changes in the composition of the typical A.A. meeting; (b) to provide the public with a realistic appraisal of the effectiveness of A.A. in arresting the disease of alcoholism; (c) to develop a new understanding of the characteristics of the typical member attending an A.A. meeting.*

It was noted that the distribution of the survey questionnaires would again be entrusted to Conference delegates, working with committee members and G.S.R.'s. Results will be processed and made available late this year.

A sample copy of the questionnaire to be used in the 1977 survey was sent to delegates April 4. A condensed version of it follows. (The actual questionnaire covers two pages, with spaces to check answers and blanks to be filled in.)

**A.A. Survey - From General Service Office of A.A.
This is an anonymous survey - please do not sign**

In holding out the hand of A.A. to those who still suffer from the disease of alcoholism, it has become increasingly important for us to find out more about ourselves. Your cooperation in this survey of A.A. members (anonymously, of course) can be of vital importance in helping us learn more about our Fellowship, and carry the A.A. message to more people, more effectively. If you have filled out this questionnaire at another meeting this year, do not fill it out again.

- 1 I first came to A.A. in --.
- 2 I had my last drink in --.
- 3 I attended my first meeting before this one (fill in one only)---days, weeks, months, or years ago.
- 4 I normally attend A.A. meetings (fill in one only)---times a week, month, or year.
- 5 Which two of the following do you feel were most responsible for your coming to your first A.A. meeting? Please number them 1 (most important) and 2: newspaper, magazine, radio, television, A.A. literature, family, doctor, clergyman, employer, A.A. member, counseling agency, treatment facility, correction facility, Al-Anon member, fellow worker, non-A.A. friend or neighbor, on my own, other (please specify).
- 6 My age is --.

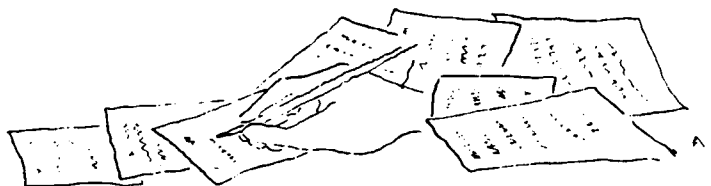
- 7 I am male --; female --.
- 8 What is the *general* nature of your employment now? (Please check one.) Business, professional, skilled labor, semiskilled labor, agriculture, office/clerical, housewife, military, retired, unemployed, other.
- 9 Do you belong to an A.A. group? Is it the group at which you are filling out this questionnaire? Did you ever have an active sponsor? Do you have an active relationship with your sponsor now? Were you ever an active sponsor? Do you actively sponsor someone now?
- 10 This question refers to treatment or counseling *other than A.A.*: i.e., medical, psychological, spiritual, etc. Did you receive such help before coming to A.A.? What was the most important type of such help? Did it play an important part in directing you to A.A.? Have you had such help since coming to A.A.? What was the most important type? Did it play an important part in your recovery from alcoholism?
- 11 Were you addicted to any drug other than alcohol?
- 12 Do the following know of your A.A. membership? Did you yourself tell them? Family, friends, clergyman, doctor, co-workers, supervisors.
- 13 If you did not get sober immediately upon coming to A.A., did you try controlled drinking? What was the longest period of time (in weeks) that you got away with it.

Thank you for helping to carry the message.

Staff coordinator

Over 24,000 letters answered

Staff report: The staff answers correspondence received at G.S.O. During 1976, over 24,000 letters were answered individually. Each staff member handles mail from a specifically



assigned area. The staff coordinator keeps a calendar of vacations, trips scheduled, and days off in order to make sure the office is covered at all times.

Nine* staff members are employed at G.S.O. All have specific assignments, and some carry responsibility for specific bulletins. Staff members are also secretaries to board and Conference committees, with special responsibilities. Work is apportioned as follows:

Staff coordinator

Quarterly Report; assistant secretary to board of trustees; secretary to the trustees' Policy Committee and Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions
Box 4-5-9 (English and French); secretary of trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees; co-secretary, trustees' International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee
Box 4-5-9 (Conference issue), *Conference Report*; secretary to Conference Agenda Committee and trustees' Conference Committee
About A.A.; *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*; secretary to trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees

Group services coordinator and A.A. regional forums

Conference

Cooperation with the professional community

Public information

Overseas, World Service Meeting, International Convention (1980)

Institutions

Loners, Internationalists, Spanish correspondence

P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin; secretary to trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees
World Service Meeting Report; secretary to World Service Meeting; secretary to trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; co-secretary, trustees' International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee
Institutions Bulletin, P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin; secretary to trustees' Correctional Facilities and Treatment Facilities Committees and Conference Institutions Committee
Loners-Internationalists Meeting; *Box 4-5-9* (Spanish)

A rewarding part of staff work is the invitations from A.A. conventions, assemblies, and state and provincial get-togethers. During these trips, staff members acquaint A.A.'s with services provided by G.S.O., and obtain information concerning local problems and activities to help us serve groups better.

In 1976, more than 1,400 visitors came to G.S.O. Each staff member gets to meet visitors and chat about A.A. activities in their home areas.

Weekly folders of answers to correspondence are circulated to the staff and the Grapevine, also a folder of publications and newspaper clippings mentioning A.A.

Staff meetings are held three times a month. Minutes are circulated to all concerned.

Beth Kuhlmann

**The normal complement is ten. At Conference time, one staff member had just retired. Another was on a leave of absence, and her responsibilities as group services assistant were temporarily assumed by other staff members.*

Treatment Facilities

Attention focused on A.A. in treatment centers

Trustees' committee: In accord with a Conference recommendation, the trustees' and Conference Institutions Committees divided into two subcommittees each, one for correctional facilities and one for hospitals and other treatment facilities. Trustee committee members expressed preference for the subcommittee on which they would like to serve.

We met first as a subcommittee, in October. Our purpose and goals include carrying the message to the alcoholic in treatment facilities and stimulating communication among institutions committees. We discussed the importance of A.A. members' sponsoring A.A.'s in treatment facilities and after release.

An ad hoc committee recommended that consideration be given to replacing "A.A. in Hospitals" with two new pamphlets: one directed to professionals working in hospitals; the other, to A.A. members doing Twelfth Step work in treatment facilities.

We recommended that the Spanish institutions discount pack-

age be included on the discount package form sent to institutions committees and groups.

Another ad hoc committee will explore the current hospital discount package and also the possibility of an inexpensive giveaway sheet in large type and simple language, which would explain exactly what A.A. does and does not do.

In January, it was recommended that the two Institutions subcommittees be made into two full trustee committees. This recommendation was referred to the board and passed on February 1, 1977.

Ed Small, chairman

World Service Meeting

A.A. problems are universal

Trustees' report: The Fourth World Service Meeting was held in New York in October 1976, with Argentina, Australia, Belgium, Brazil, Central America (Northern and Southern Zones), Colombia, Finland, France, Germany, Ireland, Mexico, New Zealand, Norway, South Africa, Sweden, United Kingdom, and United States/Canada represented.

The theme was "Working With Others." Hugh Montgomery, New Zealand, stated in the keynote address, "A.A. can never be a closed shop. We must always be ready to extend the hand of cooperation to our friends. We have nothing to fear from non-A.A. activity. It can only help us to reach out to the still-suffering alcoholic, and for that 'I am responsible.'" Problems encountered in carrying out this responsibility are the same in every language and in every country.

Workshops were held on "How A.A. Works in Institutions Around the World" and "Building a Service Structure Around the World." The four committees — Agenda, Finance, Literature/Publishing, and Policy/Admissions — were concerned with many subjects familiar to us on a national level, but taking on a new aspect on a world level.

Following are some recommendations and suggestions made by the meeting:

1 Agreed to maintain the English-language requirement and to defer consideration of instantaneous translations until the meeting is self-supporting.

2 Recommended that the sixth meeting be held in New York

City in July of 1980, rather than October, so delegates may participate in the 1980 International Convention in New Orleans.

3 Recommended that "Recovery, Unity, and Service — World-wide" be the theme for the fifth meeting; that workshops on sponsorship and on the Traditions and discussions on "Money in A.A. (the Spiritual Value of Giving)" and on public information work be scheduled at the fifth.

4 Recommended the W.S.M. delegate fee be increased from \$400 to \$500.

5 Recommended that drafts for new literature continue to be sent to the World Service Meeting Literature/Publishing Committee. However, individual countries should be encouraged to originate new literature ideas.

6 Recommended to A.A.W.S. that if a new or revised edition of a publication is in the works, A.A.W.S. give other countries six months' notice prior to this change, to make it easier for them to utilize existing copies.

7 Recommended that reductions in costs of U.S. literature not be published until other general service offices have been notified, to avoid conflict.

8 Suggested that as translations are made in each country, they be sent to A.A.W.S. for copyright permission immediately, so as not to hold up the production process.

9 Suggested more communications between countries speaking the same language, so translations are not duplicated.

10 Suggested that A.A.W.S. consider doing a biography of Dr. Bob.

Bob Hitchins gave the closing talk, saying, "The A.A. world stretches far beyond the walls of our group or state or nation. No one will ever see the whole of it — but it can be perceived from within this room. We have shared a unique experience — one shared by fewer than 150 of our more than 1,000,000 members around the world. We, too, have 'worked with others.'"

N. M. (Mac) Cheater, Fourth World Service Meeting delegate (U.S./Canada)

Grapevine reports: See presentation, pp. 12-14.



A.A. Groups Speak Through Their Conference

Conference Advisory (to the board) Actions arise mostly out of Conference committees. But in some instances, at the will of the Conference, they are results of subjects brought up on the floor when all Conference members are present. Motions are then made and discussed, and votes are taken.

The following Advisory Actions were approved by the 27th General Service Conference and the General Service Board.

Floor Actions

- 1 That the A.A. membership survey be conducted in June 1977 with the cooperation of the area delegates.
- 2 The World Service Meeting report be accepted.
- 3 The publication of a facsimile of the first edition of the Big Book should not be undertaken, as it would destroy the sentimental value of the actual first edition.
- 4 The following Class B regional trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board: Virginia Hallman, East Central U.S. (four years); Sam Smith, Southeast U.S. (four years).
- 5 The following Class B general service trustee—U.S. be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board: Ruth Hartshorn (four years).
- 6 A.A. directories
 - a States and provinces should be listed alphabetically rather than by region.
 - b The recommendation of the 1974 General Service Conference be reaffirmed, that is: "Only full names and phone numbers that may be used for Twelfth Step referral and meeting information from any source be published. This will be clearly indicated on the group information sheet."
 - c Each group's service number (used for G.S.O. records) should be listed with other information.
 - d Group contributions continue to be listed.
- 7 It was agreed that, as recommended by the General Service Board, it would not be in the best interest of the Fellowship to relocate the General Service Office at this time.
- 8 After discussion, it was decided that there was no substantial unanimity regarding the showing of the 1960 International Convention film at regional forums, and it was also decided that the subject should be discussed in the areas before a final decision is made. It was also suggested that an additional print be obtained and safeguarded.
- 9 It was suggested that A.A. groups be discouraged from selling literature not distributed by the General Service Office and the Grapevine.

Presentations related to Floor Action 4: pp. 15-16
Discussion topic related to Floor Action 6: pp. 18-19
Discussion topic related to Floor Action 9: pp. 20-22

Agenda

Chairman — Jerry Frolich (Mid-Southern California)

10 That the format of the A.A. meeting be reviewed every year. It was further recommended that in 1978 the A.A. meeting be chaired by a G.S.O. staff member with three delegate speakers.

11 The following be subjects for presentations at the 1978 Conference: finance; "Let's Carry the A.A. Message"; "How Our General Service Office Serves Us"; "The Participation of the G.S.R., the Vital Link Between the A.A. Group and the General Service Conference."

The following be subjects for discussion at the 1978 Conference: "Are We Letting Others Do Our Work?"; "Who Establishes Policy in A.A.? You, That's Who."



The following be topics for workshops at the 1978 Conference: "A.A. — What We Can Do for the Alcoholic"; "Working With Others Inside and Outside of A.A."

The theme for the 1978 Conference be built around "The Individual and the Group: Growth Through Participation." It was further recommended that the Twelve Steps, with emphasis on the Twelfth Step, be incorporated into the 1978 Conference agenda.

12 All Conference mailings and the monthly letter to delegates also be sent to alternate delegates.

Presentation related to Advisory Action 12: p. 10

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Chairman — Jim Jones (Rhode Island)

13 That, in the spirit of cooperation, we respond to all calls for help with information about A.A. whether the call comes from the alcoholic or from the professional who is calling for his patient or client. As members of A.A., it is our responsibility

to try to carry our message of recovery wherever we can.

14 We reaffirm the 1976 Conference C.P.C. Committee's recommendation to "Recognize the necessity of meeting the new member where he presently is, listen to him, try to determine what he really knows about the A.A. program," and we reaffirm, not only this agenda item, but the entire 1976 Conference C.P.C. Committee report.

15 A joint meeting of the Conference and trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Institutions* would not be practical. However, the committee recommended that the General Service Board consider the possibility of holding a joint meeting (between the 1977 and 1978 Conferences) of the trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Institutions. It was the committee's feeling that while there is bound to be some overlapping of the responsibilities of the three [now four] committees, more specific guidance on who does what is needed. It was also felt that we should do all we can to eliminate any competition so that each can function in unity and do the job of carrying the message in the best way possible.

16 In the interest of communication and cooperation, reports of all three [now four] trustees' committees be distributed to the delegate members of the three [now four] corresponding Conference committees after each trustees' committee meeting.

*See Advisory Actions 27, this page, and 41, p.45, and the Treatment Facilities report, p. 41.

Presentations related to Advisory Action 16: pp. 14-15

Finance

Chairman – Joe Kraus Jr. (Tennessee)

17 That a prudent reserve be established equal to the preceding year's operating expense of the combined expenses of the General Service Board of A.A., A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. (with the exception of extraordinary expenses); and that the auditing firm be requested to review and comment annually on the availability, feasibility, and adequacy of this reserve.

18 After review of the board's proposal to return discounts donated to the group, it was recommended that the cost of the employees' retirement plan be charged to general operating expenses and that the selling price of books be reduced by those amounts previously used for the retirement plan.

19 A suggested prudent reserve for a group be dependent on local needs; and that a suggested prudent reserve for central offices, intergroups, and area committees preferably be one to twelve months' operating expense, depending on local needs.

Conference Report and Charter

Chairman – Gene Daniel (Southwestern Texas)

20 That the Conference Report and Charter Committee continue to exist.

21 A revision be made in the text of Article 5 on page 24 of "The A.A. Service Manual" so that it conforms with current

A.A. structure; and that the committee consider at the 1978 Conference any necessary updating of the first 11 articles of the Conference Charter.

22 Preparation of "The A.A. Service Manual" in looseleaf form not be considered at this time.

23 No recommendations be made at this time regarding a suggested procedure for the filling of midterm vacancies on area committees.

Presentations related to Advisory Action 21: pp. 16-18

Grapevine

Chairman – Bud Grondahl (North Dakota)

24 That delegates be responsible for establishing area Grapevine committees, using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group.



25 One copy of the Grapevine, along with a Grapevine order form, be included in every kit mailed out to new groups by G.S.O.

26 The Grapevine continue to publish the "About Alcoholism" section, along with the disclaimer.

Presentations on the Grapevine: pp. 12-14

Institutions

Chairman – Turk Lassiter (Wyoming)

27 That the Institutions Committee be dissolved and two new committees—one dealing with Correctional Facilities and one with Treatment Facilities—be formed.

28 It was not practical to hold a joint meeting of the Conference and trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Institutions, but that the quarterly highlights of the trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities be sent to all members of these Conference committees.

29 There is no need for the institutional groups to receive the A.A. directory at this time.

30 It is not within A.A.'s province to define a rehabilitation facility.

31 The committee will review the outline of the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Hell Out of Sitting in a Cell," and also the two pamphlets "A.A. in Prisons" and "A.A. in Hospitals."

Literature

Chairman — Joe Fuller (Alaska)

32 That a story be added to the pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" under the title "My name is — and I am an alcoholic (with a language barrier)," and that the emphasis in the story should be on feeling the barrier rather than on the particular language, for example, Spanish, French, or whatever.

33 The Conference-approved seal on A.A. literature remain as it is.



34 The proposal on "Living Sober Longer" not be pursued further, as there is not sufficient need for such a pamphlet.

35 The Responsibility Declaration not be changed, as it was made at the 1965 International Convention in Toronto.

36 Literature survey results will be mailed to all delegates within a few months.

37 A.A.W.S. proceed with the project of a joint biography of Dr. Bob and Bill.



Conference Policy/Admissions

Chairman — Marge Kemp (Northern Interior California)

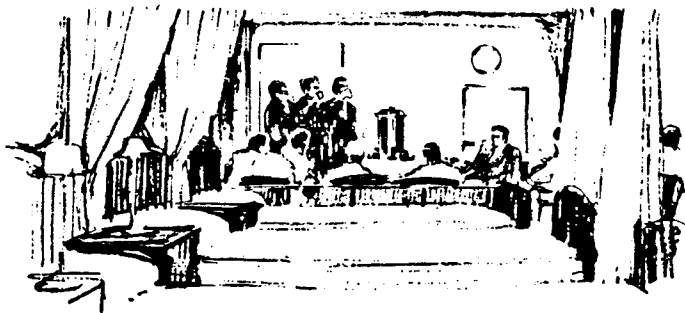
38 That current general service board and staff members from foreign countries be granted admission as observers, upon request,

to the annual General Service Conference of U.S. and Canada; not to exceed one representative per country, at their own expense; and that the request be made through the General Service Office in New York.

39 The recommendations of the Conference Report and Charter and Agenda Committees to retain the Conference Report and Charter Committee as is be approved, with the additional recommendation that: All Conference committees reevaluate their purpose and function during 1978 and report back to the 1979 Conference.

40 When a situation arises which prevents the trustee committee chairperson from chairing the joint meeting, a Conference committee chairperson be delegated to chair the joint committee meeting at the Conference until a new trustee chairperson can be appointed.

41 The current Conference Institutions Committee be replaced by two committees to be called Committee on Correctional Facilities and Committee on Treatment Facilities.



Public Information

Chairman — Cliff Roche (San Diego)

42 That 30-second TV and radio spots are more desirable than 60-second. New TV spots are not needed at this time. It is suggested there be wider distribution of our current spots. It

was further recommended our TV spots be shown to all delegates at future Conferences.

43 G.S.O. prepare a one-sheet flyer about A.A. In addition to distributing the flyer to local P.I. committees, students, and civic groups, it would be helpful to distribute it to general service representatives and group secretaries.

44 The trustees' Public Information Committee prepare public service announcements in print form and that these announcements be sent to local P.I. committees, and placed in Background Editorial Material in the Public Information Kit.

45 A joint meeting of the Conference and trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Institutions would not be practical. However, the committee recommends there be a joint meeting of the Conference P.I. and C.P.C. Committees at the 1978 Conference. The committee accepts the fact of an existing overlapping of responsibilities between the two committees. It is felt a joint meeting will be helpful in this regard.

46 The 1976 recommendation of sending the P.I. Kit annually to members of the Conference P.I. Committee prior to the Conference be reaffirmed, and that the following be added to the P.I. Kit:

a. Information paper on Alcoholics Anonymous, recently prepared by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee.

b. Included in the Background Radio/TV Material, a brief description of existing TV and radio spots.

47 All material in the P.I. Kit reflect current membership figures.

Committee on Trustees

Chairman – Stan Cameron (Saskatchewan)



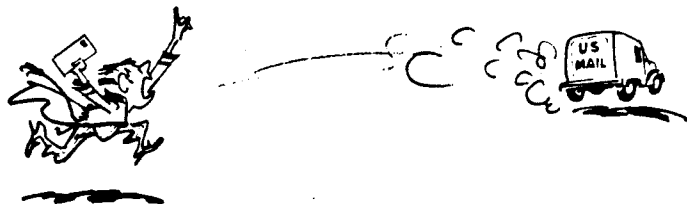
For a brief biography of new nonalcoholic trustee William J. Estelle Jr., see p. 54.

48 That the following persons be elected as trustees of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see p. 38; Conference and board approved the slate presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee]; and that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting [see p. 38; slate of officers also approved].

49 William J. Estelle Jr. be elected as a Class A trustee at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board.

50 Jerry Danzig and Martin Le Boutillier be elected Class B general service trustees (New York) at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board.

51 The résumés for trustee candidates be sent to G.S.O. by the area delegates as soon as possible after the elections, but no later than *January 1*. Any résumé received at G.S.O. after the January 1 deadline will be returned to the delegate in the submitting area.



52 A delegate not be eligible as a trustee candidate until *one year after* his or her last Conference, commencing with the 1978 election.

53 The 1973 Conference action that résumés of trustee candidates be sent to G.S.O. by the area delegate be reaffirmed, and that consideration be given to the use of a special coded envelope for this purpose.

54 The committee reaffirmed the action taken by mail poll to change the wording in "The A.A. Service Manual" (page 98, paragraph 3, first sentence) from: "Delegates and committee *members* . . ." to: "Delegates and committee *officers* in regions scheduled to select regional trustee candidates will be informed by G.S.O. in August mailing."

55 The mailing regarding the selection of regional trustee candidates continue to be sent to delegates and committee officers.

56 The trustees' Nominating Committee consider and determine the role and purpose of the general service trustee – U.S./Canada and the responsibility of the general service trustee – U.S./Canada; and that some clearer terminology be used in "The A.A. Service Manual" authorizing the board to determine such additional qualifications or requirements in a candidate as the board may require.

57 The trustees' Nominating Committee review résumé forms for Class B trustees, reconsider the question of employment in the alcoholism field, and refer recommendations to the Conference Committee on Trustees by mail.

58 The committee would like to go on record as favoring the continuance of having a Class A trustee serve as chairman of the board.

'The only circus in town'

The foregoing record of decisions thoughtfully reached by the 1977 Conference explains just what Jim Smith, delegate chairman, meant when he said at the closing brunch, "The only circus in town is the one across the street." (Ringling Bros.-Barnum & Bailey happened to be at Madison Square Garden that week.) Before 1951, there were fears that a bunch of conferring ex-drunks might put on quite a show. But 27 productive annual meetings attest to A.A. responsibility.

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

Financial statements

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1976

INCOME	1976	1975
Net sales, after book discounts waived of \$133,767 in 1976 and \$132,096 in 1975	\$2,244,212	\$1,923,612
Less: Cost of printing	591,161	570,833
Royalties	263,670	224,651
Gross profit from literature	1,389,381	1,128,128
Contributions – A.A. groups and members	946,633	807,287
Interest income	41,838	11,373
40th Anniversary Convention	–	82,991
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>2,377,852</u>	<u>2,029,779</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	899,711	858,220
Rent	97,680	92,615
Box 4-5-9	45,153	40,777
A.A. directories	63,562	58,136
Other General Service Office printing	48,801	47,874
Shipping and mailing	193,115	176,450
Other office expenses	196,969	150,551
Insurance and payroll taxes	85,185	82,929
Professional services	24,086	22,716
Board, committee, staff meetings	36,324	26,151
1976 World Service Meeting	26,301	–
Writing, research	5,143	6,169
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	33,384	29,715
General Service Conference	64,717	53,932
E.D.P. system development	9,146	–
Regional forums and other expenses	16,671	7,999
Office relocation study	5,000	–
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>1,850,948</u>	<u>1,654,234</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>526,904</u>	<u>375,545</u>

NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION

Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	\$ 776,670	\$ 578,767
General Fund – General Service Board	(249,766)	(203,222)

CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS – 1976

	Reserve	Pension
Balance, January 1, 1976	\$ 354,707	\$ 180,080
Book discounts		133,767
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		3,500
Transfer from General Fund	100,000	
Investment income	26,030	6,895
Less: Current funding costs		(97,052)
Past service costs		(175,000)
Actuary fee		(6,997)
Balance, December 31, 1976	<u>480,737</u>	<u>45,193</u>

() denotes red figures.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. – Notes to Financial Statements, December 31, 1976

Note A – Purposes and Restrictions of Different Funds

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 by transfer from the GENERAL FUND of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the board of trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

(continued)

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1976

	1976	1975
INCOME – from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$483,515</u>	<u>\$417,067</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries	\$ 56,148	\$57,043
Printing	102,376	95,822
Mailing – Service	28,405	22,486
– Postage	20,948	12,640
Other printing costs	4,029	3,336
Calendar costs	18,278	15,528
Best Cartoons	–	2,949
Occupancy costs	9,605	9,149
Telephone	1,367	1,147
Office supplies and expenses	3,438	2,838
Other editorial expenses	3,284	4,379
Office cleaning	<u>2,511</u>	<u>2,030</u>
Total	250,389	229,347
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	61,056	59,422
Data processing costs	19,409	17,478
Stationery and supplies	3,397	3,056
Occupancy costs	9,605	9,148
Telephone	1,367	1,147
Other office expense	1,189	2,382
Selling expense	16,071	17,151
Postage	10,989	7,811
Office cleaning	2,511	2,030
Bad debts	<u>557</u>	<u>914</u>
Total	126,151	120,539
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Transition salaries	37,544	–
Insurance	4,539	3,700
Legal and accounting	5,100	5,400
Payroll taxes	9,469	6,862
Meetings and conferences	727	557
Furniture and equipment	550	1,498
Contribution to Retirement Plan	<u>3,500</u>	<u>3,500</u>
Total	<u>61,429</u>	<u>21,517</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>437,969</u>	<u>371,403</u>
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	45,546	45,664
Interest earned	<u>23,717</u>	<u>17,556</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u><u>69,263</u></u>	<u><u>63,220</u></u>

(continued)

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the Retirement Plan for the benefit of the employees of A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., prior to transfer to the trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

The GENERAL FUND, which comprises those assets not included in any of the other funds and which may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

(continued)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

Financial statements

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1976

	December 31, 1976		December 31, 1975	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
ASSETS				
Cash	\$ 142,938	\$112,283	\$ 488,710	\$111,020
Savings accounts and certificates	1,166,691	274,483	171,222	190,766
Marketable securities	—	125,144	—	125,144
Accounts receivable	90,355	4,711	80,481	5,646
Due from Grapevine	30,000	—	25,000	—
Inventories	321,700	2,502	440,700	4,894
Prepaid expenses	37,713	16,986	34,109	17,894
Total Assets	1,789,397	536,109	1,240,222	455,364
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and accruals payable	122,729	39,667	143,595	35,901
Due Pension Fund	10,254	—	7,117	—
Due Reserve Fund	100,000	—	—	—
Prepaid subscriptions	—	349,221	—	301,505
Reserve for Retirement Plan payments	—	7,000	—	7,000
Total Liabilities	232,983	395,888	150,712	344,406
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	1,089,510	110,958	682,465	72,738
Net income for year (Exhibits A and B)	526,904	69,263	375,545	63,220
Contribution received (paid)	40,000	(40,000)	25,000	(25,000)
Transfer from (to)				
Reserve Fund	(100,000)	—	—	—
Convention Guaranty Fund	—	—	6,500	—
Total Net Worth	1,556,414	140,221	1,089,510	110,958
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,217,401		\$ 940,731	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	339,013		148,779	
Total Operating Funds — as above	1,556,414		1,089,510	
Reserve Fund	480,737		354,707	
Deferred Pension Fund	45,193		180,080	
Total Net Worth	2,082,344		1,624,297	
RESERVE AND DEFERRED PENSION FUNDS				
	Reserve		Deferred Pension	
Cash	\$ 480		\$ —	
Savings accounts and certificates	10,887		34,939	
Due from A.A.W.S.	—		10,254	
Due from General Fund	100,000		—	
U.S. Treasury obligations	219,936		—	
Government Agency and Corporate Bonds	140,148		—	
Accrued interest	9,286		—	
Balance, December 31	480,737		45,193	

() denotes red figures.

(continued)

Note B — After transfers of \$500,000 in 1976 and \$300,000 in 1975 from Publishing to General Fund.

The financial statements and foregoing notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountants.

1977 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. – PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$2,420,200, allowing for a 60¢ reduction in the Big Book price and liberalization of the bulk discount structure. Taking A.A. growth into consideration, the net increase in sales over 1976 is expected to be 7.8%. During 1977, it is anticipated that A.A.W.S., Inc., will distribute 199,000 copies of "Alcoholics Anonymous," 102,600 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" – regular edition, 24,300 "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" – pocket edition, 14,800 "A.A. Comes of Age," 24,600 "As Bill Sees It," 136,500 booklets, and 5,500,000 pamphlets and miscellaneous items. After deducting \$1,040,800 – the cost of producing the literature and the royalties paid on book sales – the gross profit from sales is estimated to be \$1,379,400.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$786,200. Excluding the cost of one-time electronic data processing expense, such as the systems design, programming, consultant's fee, and peripheral equipment, all other expenses are budgeted to be 13.7% over 1976. Net publishing income after operating expenses is expected to be \$593,200.

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

Income: Against the cost of servicing groups, contributions have been budgeted at \$1,060,500. This is a 12% increase over the year 1976 and anticipates a broader base of group support in line with reduced sales income.

Expenses: Total expenses, representing the cost of group services that are charged against group contributions, are expected to be \$1,144,100. Included in this portion of the G.S.O. budget is the cost of the General Service Conference, totaling \$73,400. Total service expenses are budgeted to be \$83,600 greater than contribution income. This deficit will be funded out of the net income of the publishing operation.

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$116,400, less interest earned on day-of-deposit-to-day-of-withdrawal account. These expenses represent the cost of the quarterly trustee meetings, the expenses of the Public Information Committee and the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, the cost of regional forums, and legal and auditing expenses, plus other special board projects such as filmstrips. The net expense, totaling \$107,400, will also be paid out of the income from the publishing operation.

After budgeted deficits in the amount of \$191,000, the total net income for the General Service Office is anticipated to be \$402,200.

1977 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Estimated income, from subscriptions and other sales, is budgeted at \$513,600, an increase of \$30,100 or 6.2%.

Total expenses: Editing and printing expense is budgeted \$26,700 higher than 1976; circulation and business expense, \$28,000 higher; and general and administration expenses, \$14,200 lower than 1976. All expenses totaled are expected to be \$478,500, an increase of 9.5%.

Income from operations is budgeted at \$35,100, and net income (which includes interest), at \$60,100.

The budget for 1977 operations of G.S.O. activities is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$2,420,200*
Less: Cost of products	1,040,800
Gross profit from sales	1,379,400

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	786,200
	593,200

*Based upon the sale of:

199,000 books – "Alcoholics Anonymous"	
102,600 books – "Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions" (Reg.)	
24,300 books – "Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions" (Pocket)	
14,800 books – "A.A. Comes of Age"	
24,600 books – "As Bill Sees It"	
and	
Pamphlets, booklets, and miscellaneous items	

GENERAL FUND – GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$1,060,500
---------------	-------------

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of income (expense)	1,144,100**
	(83,600)

**Includes cost of General Service Conference – \$73,400

GENERAL FUND – OTHER EXPENSES

INCOME

Interest	\$ 9,000
----------	----------

TOTAL EXPENSE

Excess of income (expense)	116,400***
	(107,400)

***Board meetings, P.I.C. expense, C.P.C. expense, legal and auditing fees, regional forums, special projects

The publishing activity will contribute \$191,000 to offset the budgeted deficits.

1977 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales	\$513,600
Estimated expense	478,500
Net income from operations	35,100
Interest from investments	25,000
Net income	60,100

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alabama	127	70	55.1%	10	14.3%	\$ 4,905.73	1,888	\$2.59
Alaska	58	36	62.1	5	13.9	2,832.80	618	4.58
Arizona	232	113	48.7	26	23.0	10,447.69	3,035	3.44
Arkansas	133	72	54.1	12	16.7	4,411.39	1,882	2.34
California	2,454	1,227	50.0	416	33.9	92,202.90	66,533	1.38
Colorado	291	158	54.3	38	24.1	14,306.16	4,104	3.48
Connecticut	467	230	49.3	35	15.2	16,767.50	8,667	1.93
Delaware	73	49	67.1	7	14.3	3,771.60	1,115	3.38
Dist. of Columbia	76	56	73.7	19	33.9	6,612.10	2,299	2.87
Florida	652	380	58.3	122	32.1	55,485.14	11,846	4.68
Georgia	273	195	71.4	66	33.8	14,230.69	4,128	3.44
Hawaii	82	45	54.8	5	11.1	4,887.06	1,435	3.40
Idaho	76	31	40.7	2	6.4	1,268.90	767	1.65
Illinois	870	493	56.6	114	23.1	31,832.09	21,720	1.46
Indiana	339	214	63.1	49	22.9	16,492.03	5,072	3.25
Iowa	200	122	61.0	11	9.0	11,040.75	3,606	3.06
Kansas	185	115	62.2	20	17.4	9,143.59	3,514	2.60
Kentucky	208	120	57.6	19	15.8	12,626.57	2,595	4.86
Louisiana	166	112	67.5	22	19.6	7,028.17	2,435	2.88
Maine	103	68	66.0	8	11.8	3,241.68	1,382	2.34
Maryland	441	258	58.5	70	27.1	19,062.63	6,204	3.07
Massachusetts	589	292	49.5	96	32.9	24,965.30	13,672	1.82
Michigan	628	341	54.3	89	26.1	33,591.76	13,167	2.55
Minnesota	556	329	59.2	60	18.2	32,103.54	15,769	2.03
Mississippi	86	50	58.1	4	8.0	3,097.87	1,143	2.71
Missouri	333	196	58.8	47	24.0	12,248.93	4,747	2.58
Montana	107	63	58.8	2	3.2	3,696.40	1,198	3.08
Nebraska	176	124	70.5	35	28.2	10,385.99	2,715	3.82
Nevada	86	50	58.1	19	38.0	2,882.52	1,181	2.44
New Hampshire	103	62	60.2	18	29.0	3,751.96	1,643	2.28
New Jersey	518	312	60.2	97	31.1	25,680.28	8,923	2.87
New Mexico	86	58	67.4	9	15.5	2,823.27	1,046	2.69
New York	1,147	604	52.7	208	34.4	53,854.38	23,228	2.31
North Carolina	275	196	71.3	32	16.3	14,653.71	4,041	3.62
North Dakota	94	61	64.8	5	8.2	4,538.06	1,360	3.33
Ohio	725	349	48.1	52	14.9	21,173.79	14,065	1.50
Oklahoma	179	142	79.3	65	45.8	10,075.37	2,292	4.39
Oregon	188	108	57.4	33	30.6	10,937.23	2,292	4.77
Pennsylvania	628	396	63.1	118	29.8	33,310.83	11,145	2.98
Rhode Island	78	46	58.9	14	30.4	3,015.12	1,136	2.65
South Carolina	115	70	60.8	14	20.0	4,861.61	1,743	2.78
South Dakota	89	60	67.4	7	11.7	4,056.78	1,434	2.82
Tennessee	160	90	56.3	11	12.2	5,487.41	2,187	2.50
Texas	598	325	54.3	99	30.5	35,420.22	14,688	2.41
Utah	88	52	59.1	15	28.8	2,703.37	1,017	2.65
Vermont	60	38	63.3	4	10.5	2,296.65	683	3.36
Virginia	309	216	69.9	56	25.9	16,378.83	4,891	3.34
Washington	390	220	56.4	76	34.5	20,744.41	5,685	3.64
West Virginia	90	53	58.8	13	24.5	3,361.25	1,149	2.92
Wisconsin	440	251	57.0	54	21.5	15,321.19	5,982	2.56
Wyoming	46	28	60.8	3	10.7	1,353.15	510	2.65
Commonwealth of P.R.	72	46	63.8	10	21.7	2,515.12	1,174	2.14
Canal Zone	3	2	66.6	-0-	-0-	257.00	70	3.67
Bahama Islands	6	-0-	-0-	-0-	-0-	-0-	72	-0-
Virgin Islands of U.S.	3	2	66.6	1	50.0	370.00	20	18.50
TOTAL for U.S.	16,577	9,396	56.7%	2,442	26.0%	\$764,510.47	320,913	\$2.38

CANADA

	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
Alberta	220	116	52.7%	11	9.5%	\$ 13,981.93	2,475	\$5.64
Atlantic Provinces								
New Brunswick	88	45	51.1	5	11.1	3,373.75	967	3.48
Nfld. & Lab.	35	17	48.5	2	11.7	748.24	351	2.13
Nova Scotia	90	67	74.4	4	6.0	4,339.17	1,080	4.01
Prince Ed. Island	26	17	65.4	-0-	-0-	1,034.04	407	2.54
British Columbia	364	206	56.6	27	13.1	20,939.47	5,080	4.12
Manitoba	110	62	56.4	8	12.9	6,523.68	2,347	2.77
N.W. Territories	9	5	55.5	-0-	-0-	203.25	70	2.90
Ontario	711	435	61.2	111	25.5	79,810.94	10,751	7.42
Quebec	834	333	39.9	76	22.8	27,403.80	21,608	1.26
Saskatchewan	193	115	59.6	8	7.0	8,917.98	2,624	3.39
Yukon Territory	3	1	33.3	-0-	-0-	303.00	83	3.65
TOTAL for CANADA	2,683	1,419	52.9%	252	17.7%	\$167,579.25	47,843	\$3.50
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	19,240	10,815	56.2%	2,694	24.7%	\$932,089.72	368,756	\$2.53

FOREIGN AND OTHER

Foreign	\$ 5,456.00
International Doctors in A.A.	250.00
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.	600.00
Hospital groups	7,119.10
Prison groups	229.75
World Hello	112.55
Internationalists	452.37
Internationalist groups	243.65
GRAND TOTAL	\$946,553.14

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 1976-1975

	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. contrib.	% of Gps. contrib.	# of Gps. on R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib. per capita
U.S. 1976	16,557	9,396	56.7%	2,442	26.0%	\$764,510.47	320,913	\$2.38
U.S. 1975	15,308	8,583	56.1	2,481	28.9	683,158.04	292,646	2.33
Increase								
(Decrease)	1,249	813	.6%	(39)	(2.9%)	\$ 81,352.43	28,267	\$.05
Canada 1976	2,683	1,419	52.9%	252	17.7%	\$167,579.25	47,843	\$3.50
Canada 1975	2,511	1,327	52.8	228	17.2	112,044.87	43,903	2.55
Increase								
(Decrease)	172	92	.1%	24	.5%	\$ 55,534.38	3,940	\$.95
U.S. and Canada 1976	19,240	10,815	56.2%	2,694	24.7%	\$932,089.72	368,756	\$2.53
U.S. and Canada 1975	17,819	9,910	55.6	2,709	27.3	795,202.91	336,549	2.36
Increase								
(Decrease)	1,421	905	.6%	(15)	(2.6%)	\$136,886.81	32,207	\$.17

1977 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

- **Jerry Frolich, Mid-S. Calif.
- George McKerral, N.W. Que.
- Jim Rouse, W. Mich.
- ***Jerry Sullivan, Kans.
- Cecil Williams, Mont.

Grace Day, W. Va.
 Fran Polek, Wash.
 Harriet Rawls, S. Fla.
 Lewis Wilder, N. Ind.

Secretary: Mary Ellen Welsh

Conference Report and Charter

- **Gene Daniel, S.W. Tex.
- Al Engstrom, Idaho
- Dick Foster, S.W. Ohio/N. Ky.
- ***Paul Wright, Md.

Tom Dougherty, Chicago
 Paul Joachim, E. Mass.
 Robert Rosa, S.E. Que.
 Barbara Scharla-Nielsen, N. Fla.
 Bob Wall, Cent. N.Y.

Secretary: Frank Mauser

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- Bill Cochran, Del.
- Leonard DeWitt, N. Wis./Upper Mich.
- John Gillespie, N.W. Tex.
- **Jim Jones, R.I.
- ***Gordon Matkin, Alta.

Jim Dickens, Nev.
 Ken Dolliver, N.E. Ont.
 Bob Hiebel, Cent. & S.E. Ohio
 Jack Wilson, Utah

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

Finance

- Marvin Karmann, Nebr.
- **Larry Klocppel, N.M.
- **Joe Kraus Jr., Tenn.
- Bill Tarjanyi, N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.

Dave Aronofsky, N.E. Tex.
 Vic Blair, Haw.
 Warren Kelly, Ala./N.W. Fla.
 Ken King, W. Pa.
 Dean Young, S. Ill.

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Grapevine

- **Bud Grondahl, N.Dak.
- Jim McCullough, W. N.Y.
- ***John Rose, W. Ont.
- Allan Royston, Ga.

Albert Ashmanskas, E. Mo.
 Mike Flemming, N.S./Nfld./Lab.
 *LeRoy Iszler, Cent. Mich.
 Dean Kirkham, N. Coastal Calif.
 Allan Phillips, Ark.

Secretary: Ann Warner

Institutions

- ***Hank Cleaveland, Me.
- **Turk Lassiter, Wyo.
- Jeronimo Reyes, P.R.
- Jim Smith, Ariz.
- Charles Wysocki, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire

Harry Dorsett, N.C.
 John Gans, S. Wis.
 Bob Gilman, Conn.
 Donald Hart, Iowa
 Lenore Jefferson, E. Pa.

Secretary: Sarah Pierce

Literature

- ***Ken Dunphy, N.B./P.E.I.
- **Joe Fuller, Alsk.
- Mary Jane LeBlanc, N.H.
- Percy Rogers, Ky.
- Joan Ullom, S.Dak.

Fred Boyd, N.E. Ohio
 Bob Britt, Va.
 Reed Edgar, Colo.
 Jim Shannon, S.E. N.Y.

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Conference Policy/Admissions

- Maurice Haase, S. Ind.
- **Marge Kemp, N. Int. Calif.
- ***Don Shipp, Miss.
- Nancy Thomas, Vt.

Leo Hayes, S.E. Tex.
 Donald Heilman, S. Minn.
 Gerry LaPointe, N.E. Que.
 Jessie Parks, S.E. Mich.
 Al Regeling Sr., N. N.J.

Secretary: Beth Kuhlmann

Public Information

- Jean-Luc Bergevin, S.W. Que.
- Maggi Bolton, S. N.J.
- *Doug Ligertwood, Man.***
- Joe Kirby, S.C.
- **Cliff Roche, San Diego

Ray Anderson, W. Mo.
 Marv Brisson, N.W. Ont.
 Bob Hawkes, La.
 Garrett Taylor, D.C.

Secretary: June Russell

Committee on Trustees

- **Stan Cameron, Sask.
- Earle McNutt, N. Ill.
- Vern Radke, N. Minn.
- ***Colette Ross, W. Mass.
- Leonard Truitt, Oreg.

Elizabeth H. Erhard, Okla.
 Rolly Provost, E. Ont.
 Tom Sinclair, B.C./Yukon
 Dick Sutherland, S. Calif.

Secretary: Cora Louise Belford

New chairmen and alternate chairmen

Meeting during the Conference, each committee elected from among its Panel 27 members the following, who took office immediately after the Conference:

Committee	Chairman	Alternate chairman
Conference Agenda	Grace Day, W. Va.	Harriet Rawls, S. Fla.
Conference Report and Charter	Paul Joachim, E. Mass.	Tom Dougherty, Chicago
Cooperation with the Professional Community	Bob Hiebel, Cent. & S.E. Ohio	Ken Dolliver, N.E. Ont.
Correctional Facilities	Donald Hart, Iowa	Bob Gilman, Conn.
Finance	David Aronofsky, N.E. Tex.	Ken King, W. Pa.
Grapevine	Dean Kirkham, N. Coastal Calif.	Albert Ashmanskas, E. Mo.
Literature	Fred Boyd, N.E. Ohio	Bob Britt, Va.
Conference Policy/Admissions	Donald Heilman, S. Minn.	Gerry LaPointe, N.E. Que.
Public Information	Ray Anderson, W. Mo.	Robert Hawkes, La.
Treatment Facilities	Harry Dorsett, N.C.	Lenore Jefferson, E. Pa.
Committee on Trustees	Elizabeth Erhard, Okla.	Dick Sutherland, S. Calif.

*Alternate delegate

**Chairman

***Alternate chairman

1977 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., *chairman*
 Lee Belford, Ph.D.
 Margaret J. Carlson
 George N. Gordon, Ph.D.
 Nell Wing, *archivist/librarian*
 Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

John E. Waterfield, *chairman*
 Margaret J. Carlson
 N. M. (Mac) Cheater
 Don Nicolson
 Mary Ellen Welsh, *secretary*

Cooperation with the Professional Community

Robert Macpherson, *chairman*
 Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
 John D. Bealer, M.D.
 David T. Cooke
 Hal Marley
 Walter J. Murphy
 Don Nicolson
 Gordon M. Patrick
 Ross Von Wiegand
 Barry Leach, *consultant*
 Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

William Dunkin, *chairman*
 Cecil E. Corrigan
 Tim Danaher
 Lucas Gonzalez
 Ray Leary
 Jeanette Spencer
 Sarah Pierce, *secretary*

Employee Retirement

Arthur J. Miles, *chairman*
 Martin Le Boutillier
 Robert Macpherson
 Fred Sengstacke
 Michael Alexander, *legal consultant*
 Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
 Robert E. Hitchins, *secretary*
 Dennis I. Manders, *assistant secretary*

Literature

Gordon M. Patrick, *chairman*
 Fan Content
 David T. Cooke
 Cecil E. Corrigan
 Jack Morley
 John Ryall
 Edward J. Small
 Jacquelyn Solomon
 Frank Trippett
 Janet Graves, *consultant*
 Barry Leach, *consultant*
 Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Nominating

Charles H. Hanson, *chairman*
 Peter A. G. Watters
 John D. Bealer, M.D.
 Walter J. Murphy
 Mike Rainbolt
 John E. Waterfield
 R. Bruce Wight
 Stanley R. Wilsey
 Cora Louise Belford, *secretary*

Finance

Arthur J. Miles, *chairman*
 Michael Alexander
 John D. Bealer, M.D.
 N. M. (Mac) Cheater
 Donald F. Daly
 Martin Le Boutillier
 Robert Macpherson
 Don Nicolson
 Fred Sengstacke
 R. Bruce Wight
 Owen J. Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
 Dennis I. Manders, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

David T. Cooke, *chairman*
 Cecil E. Corrigan
 Mike Rainbolt
 Peter A. G. Watters
 Stanley R. Wilsey
 Cora Louise Belford, *co-secretary*
 Betty Liddle, *co-secretary*

Policy

Margaret J. Carlson, *chairman*
 Michael Alexander
 John D. Bealer, M.D.
 N. M. (Mac) Cheater
 David T. Cooke
 Cecil E. Corrigan
 Charles H. Hanson
 Robert Macpherson
 Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D.
 Arthur J. Miles
 Walter J. Murphy
 Don Nicolson
 John L. Norris, M.D.
 Gordon M. Patrick
 Mike Rainbolt
 Edward J. Small
 John E. Waterfield
 Peter A. G. Watters
 Mary Ellen Welsh
 R. Bruce Wight
 Stanley R. Wilsey
 Beth Kuhlmann, *secretary*

Public Information

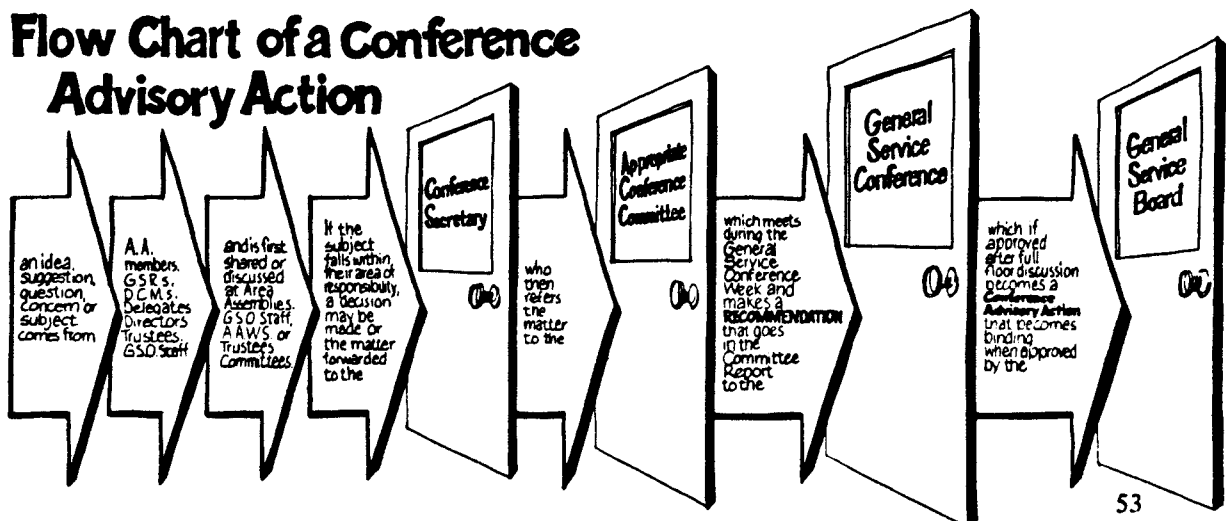
Walter J. Murphy, *chairman*
 John Bragg
 Bill Croke
 Denison Demac
 Janet Graves
 Charles H. Hanson
 Lou Huston
 Fay Stanley Shulman
 Edward J. Small
 Jerry A. Danzig
 Dee Powell
 June Russell, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

Edward J. Small, *chairman*
 N. M. (Mac) Cheater
 Hal Harmon
 Henry Hudson
 Ray O'Keefe
 Robert Pope
 Emily Rayford
 Jerome Thompson
 Yolanda Lazo, *secretary*

Robert E. Hitchins, John L. Norris, M.D., and Robert Pearson are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



1977 Conference Members

Nonalcoholic (Class A) trustees

John L. Norris, M.D. (Box 251, New London, NH 03257), is chairman of the General Service Board and the General Service Conference. He is also a member of the Nominating Committee and was elected to the board in January 1951. Before his retirement, "Dr. Jack" was associate medical director of Eastman Kodak Co., Rochester, N.Y. He is former chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism and former president of the Industrial Medicine Association and the American Academy of Occupational Medicine.

Michael Alexander (150 East 69th St., New York, NY 10021) was elected a trustee in 1976 after 20 years as legal adviser to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, P.C., Mike was long an associate of the late Bernard Smith — so significant in the history of A.A. He is a director of the British American Chamber of Commerce, a trustee of the Foundation for International Child Health, and a director of the Ireland-U.S. Council for Commerce and Industry. Mike is a member of the Finance and Policy Committees and a nonvoting consultant on the Employee Retirement Committee.

John D. Bealer, M.D. (3639 Emerson Circle, Bethlehem, PA 18017), elected to the board in April 1971, is assistant medical director of Bethlehem Steel Corp. He has long been interested in the problem of alcoholism in industry and is a member of the American Medical Society on Alcoholism and a director of the National Council on Alcoholism. Dr. John serves on the Policy, Nominating, and Finance Committees and on the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, and is a director of A.A.W.S.

***W. J. Estelle Jr.** (director, Texas Department of Corrections, Box 99, Huntsville, TX 77340) was named a trustee in April 1977. He was born in Indiana but educated in California, where he began his 17-year career in corrections. He then spent two years as warden of Montana State Prison. Estelle has taught courses in corrections in two California colleges and is a member of seven professional societies concerned with criminal justice, corrections, and services to children and youth.

Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D. (3300 Carpenter Rd. S.E., #25, Olympia, WA 98503), was elected to the board in April 1971. Before his retirement in 1975, he was professor of sociology in the Center of Alcohol Studies at Rutgers University, New Brunswick, N.J. From 1965 through 1973, he was also executive director of the Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies. He serves on the Policy Committee and is chairman of the Archives Committee and co-chairman of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

Arthur J. Miles (Dime Savings Bank of New York, Fifth Ave. and 48th St., New York, NY 10017) was elected to the board in 1970. He is an executive vice-president and treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of New York and is on the board of trustees of the Cultural Institutions Retirement System. He is also a member of the New York Society of Security Analysts and the National Association of Business Economists. He is chairman of the Finance and Employee Retirement Committees, treasurer of the G.S. Board, and a member of the Policy Committee.

Gordon M. Patrick (Box 94, Lyndhurst, Ont. K0E 1N0, Canada),

elected to the board in 1975, is manager of the Ontario Government Employee Alcoholism Program. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he is a member of the Association of Labor-Management Administrators and Consultants on Alcoholism and serves the Alcohol and Drug Problems Association of North America as vice-chairman of its Occupational Program Section, which he helped to found. He is chairman of the Literature Committee and a member of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community and the Policy Committee.

Alcoholic (Class B) trustees

****Margaret J. Carlson** (218 Regency Park Dr., Regency Park Apts., Agawam, MA 01001) was elected to the board as a general service trustee—U.S. in April 1973. She has had continuous sobriety since 1959 and has been interested in P.I. institutions, honor court, and general service activities. Margaret was area delegate chairman in 1971. She is employed as administrator of the Alcoholism Detoxification Center of Greater Springfield. Margaret is chairman of the Policy Committee, co-chairman of the Literature Committee, and a member of the Conference and Archives Committees.

N. M. ("Mac") Cheater (5 Frost Ave., Winnipeg, Man. R3K 0E1, Canada) was elected general service trustee—Canada in 1975. He had his last drink in 1956. A Panel 12 delegate, Mac introduced Big Book study sessions in his province. He chaired the first winter conference in Manitoba. Mac is sales manager of a television station. He serves on the Conference, Finance, Treatment Facilities, and Policy Committees.

****David T. Cooke** (229 Dublin Rd., Raleigh, NC 27609) was elected in 1974 as Southeastern U.S. regional trustee for a three-year term. Dave had his last drink in 1957. He was Conference delegate in 1967-68 and was delegate chairman. He has been a high school teacher and is now a highway engineer for a state department. Dave is chairman of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee, a member of the Committees on Literature, Policy, and Cooperation with the Professional Community, and a director of A.A.W.S.

Cecil ("Cec") E. Corrigan (655 Boulevard Drive, Prince Albert, Sask., Canada S6V 2L9) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in 1976, with 24 years' sobriety. He was a Panel 8 delegate. Cec has had two decades of experience in management of ladies' wear and fur businesses, and also has interests in real estate. He serves on the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, Correctional Facilities, Literature, and Policy Committees.

***Jerry A. Danzig** (993 Park Ave., New York, NY 10028), after ten years' sobriety, became a general service trustee in April 1977. From 1972 to 1976 he was an officer of A.A.W.S., and for five years, a member of the trustees' Public Information Committee. He served the New York Intergroup P.I. Committee two years. Jerry has been officer of a broadcast network and special assistant to two New York governors. He is a partner in a management consultant firm.

***Virginia C. Hallman** (4304 North Alpine Ave., P.O. Box 11507, Shorewood, WI 53211) was elected East Central U.S. regional

trustee in April 1977, after 24 years' sobriety. She was secretary of the Milwaukee Central Office four years and was a delegate (Panel 23). She has also been active as a volunteer in behalf of a recovery home for women and a local alcoholism council. She is officer manager of a manufacturing concern.

Charles H. Hanson (42 Puritan Rd., Fairfield, Conn. 06430) was elected general service trustee in 1975. He is chairman of the Grapevine Corporate Board and the Nominating Committee, and serves on the Public Information and Policy Committees. Chuck had his last drink in 1966. He is a frequent Grapevine contributor, and is now president of an advertising agency, after supervisory duties in three of the best-known Madison Avenue firms.

***Ruth K. Hartshorn** (190-18 89th Ave., Hollis, NY 11423) was elected general service trustee—U.S. in 1977 after 17 years of sobriety. She became a G.S.R. in 1961, has worked on all state and local conventions since 1963, was a Panel 23 delegate, and helps local intergroups. She is active in her church and is treasurer of a realty company.

***Martin Le Boutillier** (1165 Fifth Ave., New York, NY 10029) started his general service trusteeship in April 1977, after ten years of sobriety. He is a former president of New York Intergroup. He has been a director of A.A.W.S. since 1974, and serves on the Finance and Employee Retirement Committees. Martin is an officer of a large Wall Street firm.

*****Robert Macpherson** (Rocktree Apts., P.O. Box 192, Pleasant Valley, CT 06063) was elected to the board in July 1973. Bob had his last drink in 1947. He was a member of the first Connecticut General Service Assembly in 1951 and a Panel 9 delegate. His business life was in office management and accounting. Bob is retired, with a small accounting and tax practice. He serves on the Policy, Finance, and Employee Retirement Committees, is chairman of the Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, and is an A.A.W.S. director.

****Walter J. Murphy** (401 E. 81st St., New York, NY 10028) was elected general service trustee in 1973. He has been active in A.A. for 17 years. He is chairman of A.A.W.S. and the Public Information Committee and a member of the Nominating, Policy, and Cooperation with the Professional Community Committees. He is public relations counsel for N.C.A., its New York City affiliate, and the Smithers Alcoholism Center.

Don Nicolson (1015 5th Avenue North — #12, Moorhead, MN 56560), elected West Central regional trustee in 1976, had his last drink in 1948. He was a Panel 21 delegate. He lectures in the alcoholism treatment unit of a hospital. Don is partner in a company holding 35 franchised food stores in nine states. He serves on the Conference, Cooperation with the Professional Community, Finance, and Policy Committees.

Mike Rainbolt (P.O. Box 248, Cordell, OK 73632) was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in 1975, with 28 years' sobriety. After group and area service, he was a Panel 15 delegate and later chaired his state P.I. committee. Mike has a background in real estate and land titles and is a petroleum landman, operating his own oil and gas exploration firm. He serves on the Policy, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Nominating Committees.

Edward J. Small (99 E. 4th St., Apt. 1-G, New York, NY

10003) began serving as a general service (New York) trustee in August 1976. He had his last drink in 1965. After stints at all group jobs, including G.S.R., Ed served New York Intergroup and became a regular Grapevine contributor. He is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board and the Literature, Policy, and Public Information Committees, and is chairman of the Committee on Treatment Facilities. Ed directs a health program for a large publishing firm and belongs to several professional societies interested in alcoholism.

***Samuel E. Smith** (820 N.W. 87 Ave., Apt. 203, Miami, FL 33126), 11 years sober, was elected from the Southeastern Region in April 1977. Active in the Third Legacy since 1968, Sam served as a delegate on Panel 25. He has also twice been chairman of a gratitude dinner and his local intergroup banquet, and has been active in local P.I. He has been an attorney 23 years.

John E. Waterfield (2900 Adams Mill Road N.W., Washington, DC 20009) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in 1975, with 18 years' sobriety. John was a Panel 23 delegate, having served previously in many group, intergroup, and G.S. area capacities. He set up a one-to-one "sponsorship" program for informing medical students about A.A., and originated the mini-conference idea. John has his own creative advertising and marketing business. He is chairman of the Conference Committee and also serves on the Nominating and Policy Committees.

Peter A. G. Watters (Box 384, Oakville, Ont. L6J 5A8, Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in 1974. Pete has been sober since 1960. He was chairman of Toronto Intergroup 1956-66, Conference delegate 1967-68, and chairman of the Ontario G.S. Committee. He has been on advisory committees to local recovery and addiction-research facilities. Pete is vice-president and owner of an education products distributorship. He is co-chairman of the Nominating Committee and a member of the Policy and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

****R. Bruce Wight** (2336 North Lewis Ave., Waukegan, IL 60085) was elected in 1974 to a three-year term as East Central U.S. regional trustee. Bruce had his last drink in 1951. He was Conference delegate on Panel 14, and is still on his area G.S. committee. He is president of a manufacturing corporation. Bruce is on the Policy, Finance, and Nominating Committees, and is an A.A.W.S. director.

Stanley R. Wilsey (110 Toyon Drive, Fairfax, CA 94930) had been sober 23 years when elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in 1974. Stan has been a Conference delegate and editor of *Good News*, local A.A. newspaper, and was advisory co-chairman of the 1960 International A.A. Convention in Long Beach. He is a consultant for vehicle dealers in the San Francisco Bay area. Stan is a member of the Policy, Nominating, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

**New trustee
**Retiring as of April 1977*

****Retiring as of August 1977*

1977 Conference Members

A.A. World Services directors

Walter Murphy, *chairman*
Robert E. Hitchins, *president*
John D. Bealer, M.D., *first vice-president*
Beth Kuhlmann, *second vice-president*
Robert Macpherson, *treasurer*
David Cooke
Martin Le Boutillier
Jacquelyn Solomon
R. Bruce Wight

A.A. Grapevine directors

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Jack Morley, *vice-president, secretary*
Donald F. Daly, *treasurer*
Kathleen Kiernan
Austin MacCormick
Polly Marsh
John Ryall
Fred J. Sengstacke
Edward J. Small

General Service Office staff

Robert E. Hitchins, *chairman, General Services*
Robert G. Pearson, *general manager*
Frank Mauser, *administrative assistant*
Cora Louise Belford
Beth Kuhlmann
Yolanda Lazo
Betty Liddle
Phyllis Masback
Sarah Pierce
June Russell
Mary Ellen Welsh

Grapevine staff

Jack Morley, *editor*
Kathleen Kiernan, *circulation manager*
Ann Warner, *associate editor*
Retha Gresham

Others attending Conference (not as voting members)

Non-A.A.

Austin MacCormick, *trustee emeritus*
Donna Berkowitz, *office manager*
Charles Columbia, *assistant controller*
Al Cryan, *supervisor, Shipping Department*
Edward Gordon, *assistant controller*
Shirley Grant, *supervisor, Steno/Clerical Department*
Haywood Hicks, *supervisor, Mail Department*
Kleina Jones, *department coordinator/personnel manager*
Wilma Joseph, *supervisor, File Department*
John Kirwin, *supervisor, Accounting Department*
Lena Machado, *supervisor, Records Department*
Dennis Manders, *controller*
Dorothy McGinity, *assistant to the Conference secretary*
Nell Wing, *archivist*
Owen J. Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*

A.A.

Janet Graves, *production, Conference Report*
Barry Leach, *editor, Conference Report*
Two observers from trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community
Two observers from trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities
Two observers from trustees' Finance Committee
Two observers from Grapevine Editorial Board
Two observers from trustees' Literature Committee
Two observers from trustees' Public Information Committee
Two observers from trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities

Area delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 27th Conference includes Panel 26 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 27 (new delegates).

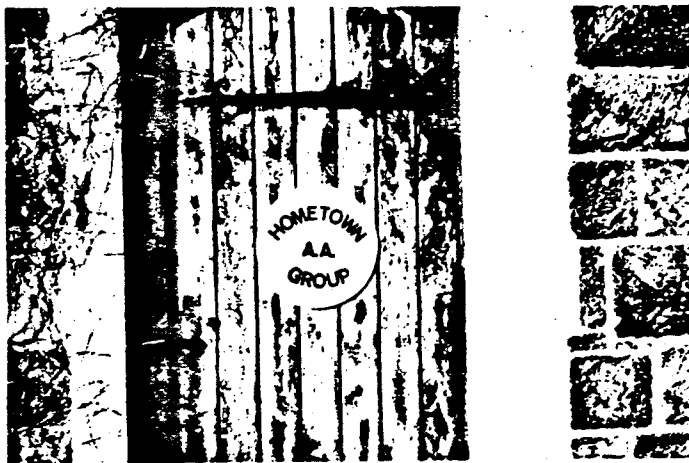
State	Panel
Alabama & N.W. Florida	(27) Warren Kelly, P.O. Box 180, Theodore, AL 36582
Alaska	(26) Joseph L. (Joe) Fuller, 1438 Medfra, Anchorage, AK 99501
Arizona	(26) James W. (Jim) Smith, 3443 N. Central Ave., Suite 1015, Phoenix, AZ 85012
Arkansas	(27) Allan Phillips, P.O. Box 626, Springdale, AR 72764
California	(27) Southern - Dick Sutherland, 5021 Laguna St., Bakersfield, CA 93306 (27) Northern Coastal - Dean Kirkham, 3800 Lyon Ave., Oakland, CA 94601 (26) Northern Interior - Margaret Kemp, 809 Kagle Ave., Broderick, CA 95605 (26) San Diego - Cliff Roche, 602 Brooks St., Oceanside, CA 92054 (26) Mid-Southern - Gerald (Jerry) Frolich, 6472 Weber Circle, Huntington Beach, CA 92647
Colorado	(27) J. L. Reed Edgar, 1119 Detroit St., Denver, CO 80206
Connecticut	(27) Robert (Bob) Gilman, 33 Sunset Rd., West Haven, CT 06516
Delaware	(26) William A. (Bill) Cochran, 134 E. 2nd St., New Castle, DE 19720
District of Columbia	(27) Garrett Taylor, 50 55th St., S.E., Washington, DC 20019
Florida	(27) Northern - Barbara Scharla-Nielsen, 205 7th Ave., Indialantic, FL 32903 (27) Southern - Harriet P. Rawls, 6580 S.W. 38th St., Miami, FL 33155
Georgia	(26) E. Allen (Al) Royston, 3255 Artesia Dr., Clarkston, GA 30021
Hawaii	(27) V. P. (Vic) Blair, 46-283 Kahuhipa St., Apt. 901, Kaneohe, HI 96744
Idaho	(26) Alvin (Swede) Engstrom, Box 294, Ucon, ID 83454

State	Panel	State	Panel
Illinois	(27) Chicago – Tom Dougherty, 900 Shermer Rd., Glenview, IL 60025	Nebraska	(26) Marvin L. Karmann, 1550 E. Dodge St., Fremont, NE 68025
	(26) Northern – Earle McNutt, P.O. Box 380, Chicago, IL 60617	Nevada	(27) James (Jim) E. Dickens, P.O. Box 2876, Reno, NV 89505
	(27) Southern – Dean Young, 102 Chestnut, Bondville, IL 61815	New Hampshire	(26) Mary Jane LeBlanc, Box 70, Derry, NH 03038
Indiana	(27) Northern – Lewis Wilder, 52626 Hasting St., South Bend, IN 46615	New Jersey	(27) Northern – Albert (Al) H. Regeling Sr., 117 Hamburg Turnpike, Riverdale, NJ 07945
	(26) Southern – Maurice Haase, 310 Maple Lane, Mooresville, IN 46158		(26) Southern – Margaret (Maggi) Bolton, 3100 Chapel Ave., Cherry Hill, NJ 08002
Iowa	(27) Donald D. Hart, 1204 Bluff St., Cedar Falls, IA 50613	New Mexico	(26) Lawrence (Larry) Kloeppel, 509 Tascosa, N.W., Albuquerque, NM 87107
Kansas	(26) Jerry L. Sullivan, P.O. Box 544, Ulysses, KS 67880	New York	(27) Central – H. Robert (Bob) Wall, 384 Front St., Owego, NY 13827
Kentucky	(26) Percy Rogers, R.R. 1, Box 185, Vine Grove, KY 40175		(26) Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire – Charles Wysocki, 345 Spring Ave., Troy, NY 12180
Louisiana	(27) Robert H. Hawkes, 152 Albert Ave., Shreveport, LA 71105		(27) Southeastern – Jim Shannon, 3150 Bailey Ave., Bronx, NY 10463
Maine	(26) Henry F. (Hank) Cleaveland, Box 41, New Sharon, ME 04955		(26) Western – James (Jim) McCullough, 640 Tionesta Ave., Kane, PA 16735
Maryland	(26) Paul Wright, 1553 Harford Square Dr., Edgewood, MD 21040	North Carolina	(27) Harry R. Dorsett, 1216 Brookwood Rd., Shelby, NC 28150
Massachusetts	(27) Eastern – Paul Joachim, Box 112, 7 Crown St., Billerica, MA 01866	North Dakota	(26) M. T. (Bud) Grondahl, P.O. Box 1303, Fargo, ND 58102
	(26) Western – Colette Ross, 47 Mayfair St., East Longmeadow, MA 01028	Ohio	(27) Central & Southeastern – Bob Hiebel, 27 Custer Rd., Heath, OH 43055
Michigan	(27) *Central – LeRoy Iszler, Rte. 3, 10615 Frost Rd., Portland, MI 48875		(27) Northeastern – Fred Boyd, 1622 Shannon Rd., Girard, OH 44420
	(27) Southeastern – Jessie Parks, 13933 Brest Rd., Southgate, MI 48195		(26) N.W. Ohio/S.E. Michigan – William J. (Bill) Tarjanyi, 364 Crestway Dr., Oregon, OH 43616
	(26) Western – James Rouse, 10790 Kenowa, N.W., Sparta, MI 49345		(26) S.W. Ohio/N. Kentucky – Richard Foster, 145 West Main St., Williamsburg, OH 45176
Minnesota	(26) Northern – Vern Radke, 512 Eighth Ave., S.W., Grand Rapids, MN 55744	Oklahoma	(27) Elizabeth H. Erhard, 1804 S. Quaker Ave., Tulsa, OK 74120
	(27) Southern – Donald E. Heilman, Lot 15, Summit Park, St. Peter, MN 56082	Oregon	(26) Leonard Truitt, P.O. Box 83, Warrenton, OR 97146
Mississippi	(26) Donald G. (Don) Shipp, 402 School St., Clarksdale, MS 38614	Pennsylvania	(27) Eastern – Lenore V. Jefferson, 72 Drummers Lane, Wayne, PA 19087
Missouri	(27) Eastern – Albert Ashmanskas, 1045-D Mersey Bend Dr., St. Louis, MO 63129		(27) Western – Ken M. King, 333 Peach St., Erie, PA 16507
	(27) Western – A. Ray Anderson, 1610 TBN Bldg., 1125 Grand Ave., Kansas City, MO 64106	Rhode Island	(26) James Jones, P.O. Box 3562, Cranston, RI 02910
Montana	(26) Cecil Williams, P.O. Box 2712, Missoula, MT 59801		

**Alternate delegate*

1977 Conference Members

State	Panel	Canada	Province	Panel
South Carolina	(26) Joseph A. (Joe) Kirby, P.O. Box 146, St. George, SC 29477	Alberta	(26) Gordon Matkin, 430 27th St., Lethbridge, Alta. T1J 3R9, Canada	
South Dakota	(26) Joan Ullom, Aurora, SD 57002	British Columbia/ Yukon	(27) Thomas (Tom) E. Sinclair, 712 Pine St., Victoria, B.C. V6C 2L8, Canada	
Tennessee	(26) Joe Kraus Jr., P.O. Drawer G, Lawrenceburg, TN 38464	Manitoba	(26) *Doug Ligertwood, 103 Kingston Row, Winnipeg, Man. R2M 0S7, Canada	
Texas	(27) Northeastern - David H. Aronofsky, 2503 W. Jefferson, Dallas, TX 75211	New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	(26) Kenneth L. (Ken) Dunphy, 115 Humphrey St., Moncton, N.B. E1C 6P2, Canada	
	(26) Northwestern - John Gillespie, P.O. Box 3493, Borger, TX 79007	Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/ Labrador	(27) Michael A. (Mike) Flemming, P.O. Box 133, New Waterford, N.S. B1H 4K4, Canada	
	(27) Southeastern - Leo (Skeeter) Hayes, 7030 Harrisburg, Houston, TX 77011	Ontario	(27) Eastern - Rolly Provost, 155 University Ave. E., Cobourg, Ont. K9A 1E2, Canada	
Utah	(26) Southwestern - Eugene C. (Gene) Daniel, 207 Laramie, San Antonio, TX 78209		(27) Northeastern - Ken Dolliver, 37 Elmhurst Crescent, Sudbury, Ont., Canada	
Vermont	(27) Jack Wilson, 2197 West 5075 South, Roy, UT 84067		(27) Northwestern - Marv Brisson, Box 11, Site 24, R.R. 2, Dryden, Ont., Canada	
Virginia	(26) Nancy Thomas, 109 High St., St. Albans, VT 05478		(26) Western - John Rose, 1-15 Orchard Heights, Chatham, Ont. N7M 3G5, Canada	
Washington	(27) Robert (Bob) Britt, 418 Painter St., Norfolk, VA 23505	Quebec	(26) Southwestern - Jean-Luc Bergevin, 1761 des Amarantes, Ile Goyer, Co. Chambly, Que. J3L 3P9, Canada	
West Virginia	(27) Fran J. Polek, 2301 E. 61st Ave., Spokane, WA 99203		(27) Southeastern - Robert Rosa, 516 Notre Dame, Box Off. 961, Ste. Marie, Co. Beauce, Quebec G0S 2Y0, Canada	
Wisconsin	(27) Grace Day, P.O. Box 5242, Charleston, WV 25311		(27) Northeastern - Gerry LaPointe, 946 Dumas, St-Jean Chrysostome, Co. Levis, Que., Canada	
	(26) N. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan - E. Leonard DeWitt, 406 North St., Ishpeming, MI 49849		(26) Northwestern - George McKerral, 99 - 11th St., Laval des Rapides, Laval, Que. H7N 1T2, Canada	
	(27) Southern - John M. Gans, 2820 W. Wells, Milwaukee, WI 53208	Saskatchewan	(26) Stanley N. (Stan) Cameron, 1513 Hilliard St., Saskatoon, Sask., Canada	
Wyoming	(26) Larry W. (Turk) Lassiter, River Rte., Box 34, Basin, WY 82410			
Puerto Rico	(26) Jeronimo Reyes Jr., Q19 Las Mercedes St., Villa Espana, Bayamon, PR 00619			



A new kind of A.A. filmstrip

"Circles of Love and Service," previewed in not quite finished form at the 1977 Conference, is now completed and available from G.S.O. Exploring a subject that is brand-new for A.A. filmstrips, it tells the story of how one small A.A. group performs a service for the entire Fellowship through its G.S.R. In photographic scenes, a fictional hometown group is portrayed by nonalcoholic actors. Color sketches depict activities of an area assembly and the General Service Conference, and lively graphics show how the parts of the A.A. service structure all fit and work together — from the home group to the General Service Board. The filmstrip is in full color, with sound track on either cassette or record.

Each area delegate receives "Circles of Love and Service" free, but any group or member may order one from G.S.O. at \$6.50. Specify whether you want the sound track on cassette or record.